

Cosmological Collider Signatures from Right-Handed Neutrino Loop

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ABSTRACT:

We study cosmological collider (CC) signatures generated by right-handed neutrino loops in the setup of inflation combined with neutrino seesaw mechanism. We formulate the inflaton interaction with the right-handed neutrino through a unique dimension-5 operator respecting shift symmetry, which induces an effective chemical potential in the slow-roll background, leading to helicity-dependent right-handed-neutrino production and enhancing the CC signatures. The right-handed neutrino is described by two-component Weyl spinor with Majorana mass term. Using the Schwinger-Keldysh (SK) formalism, we derive a set of seed integrals for fermion propagators of the right-handed Majorana neutrino. With these we compute the factorized nonlocal contributions to the three-point inflaton correlator generated by the right-handed-neutrino triangle loop. We show that the chemical potential can substantially soften the heavy-mass Boltzmann suppression and amplify the oscillatory non-Gaussianity signatures associated with the dominant helicity mode. These provide a systematic framework for analyzing the fermion loop signatures in the cosmological collider physics and demonstrate that the heavy right-handed neutrinos associated with seesaw mechanism may leave observable imprints in the primordial non-Gaussianities.

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1 Introduction

Recent studies have highlighted the inflationary universe and its quantum fluctuations [1–5] as an important arena for probing high-energy particle interactions. Unlike terrestrial experiments that are limited by achievable center-of-mass energies, inflation is sensitive to particles with masses comparable to the Hubble scale H . If such heavy states are present and interact with the inflaton, they can leave characteristic imprints on primordial curvature perturbations and the corresponding correlation functions. In particular, higher-point correlators of primordial fluctuations may exhibit non-analytic momentum-dependence in special kinematic limits, thereby encoding direct information about the masses, spins, and couplings of the particles present during inflation. This observation underlies the program of *cosmological collider physics* [6–18], in which the primordial non-Gaussianities [19–22] are used as a spectroscopic probe of ultraviolet physics in the early universe. Current CMB measurements have already placed constraints on the non-Gaussianity parameter at the level of $f_{\text{NL}} \lesssim O(10)$, depending on the shape of the non-Gaussian signal. Future observations of large-scale structure may push this sensitivity down to $O(1)–O(0.1)$, and potentially to $O(0.01)$ with 21cm tomography [21–24].

A central prediction of cosmological collider physics is that massive fields can generate oscillatory or non-analytic power-law signals in momentum-space correlators of primordial fluctuations. Schematically, in the squeezed limit $k_L \ll k_S$, one expects the 3pt correlator of the primordial curvature perturbation ζ to take the form [7, 9, 10],

$$\langle \zeta^3 \rangle \simeq B_\zeta(k_L, k_S) \sim \mathcal{A}(k_L, k_S) \left(\frac{k_L}{k_S} \right)^{\alpha+i\omega} + \text{c.c.}, \quad (1.1)$$

where the oscillation frequency or power-law exponent set by ω is determined by the heavy-particle spectrum. Such non-analytic dependence on the momentum ratio k_L/k_S cannot be generated by local effective interactions of light fields alone, and thus constitutes a distinctive signature of particle production and propagation during the inflation. For this reason, these features are often referred to as the *cosmological collider signals* or *clock signals*. Hence, the detection of such cosmological collider signals would open up a new window to probing physics at energy scales far beyond those accessible in the laboratory experiments.

Realizing the goal of quantitatively probing physics at the inflation scale requires theoretical control over the relevant inflationary correlators. Similar to flat-space scattering amplitudes, inflationary correlators can be computed perturbatively with a Feynman-diagram expansion. In recent years, much progress has been made in analytic treatments of scalar-mediated cosmological-collider signals. These developments mainly rely on a detailed understanding of scalar integrals associated with bulk scalar propagators. The tree-level processes were first tackled with a differential-equation-based approach [25–28], and the full tree-level solutions have been found later [29–32]. At the loop level, some new techniques have been developed for analytic integration, with a focus on the oscillatory signals, including partial or complete Mellin-Barnes representations [33–36], spectral decomposition [37, 38], dispersion relations [39, 40], and the factorization theorems and cutting rules for nonlocal

signals [41–44]. These developments have improved both the conceptual understanding and the computational method of scalar cosmological collider observables.

In contrast, the studies on computing fermion-loop contributions remain very limited. This is because fermion loops involve nontrivial spinor structures, helicity dependence, and a more intricate analytic structure than scalar loops. These make the quantitative treatment of fermion loops highly challenging. Some previous studies investigated heavy-fermion loop contributions to the primordial non-Gaussianity [45–49], but these calculations often rely on strong assumptions that oversimplify the complexity of fermion-loop integrals. In particular, existing estimates often adopt a saddle-point approximation for the hard internal propagator and infer the loop contribution from its characteristic nonanalytic soft-momentum scaling, rather than evaluating the full loop integral explicitly. While such approximations might capture the exponential parametric dependence, the associated power-law behaviors are still poorly understood. Hence, a more precise treatment of the fermion-loop integrals is necessary for reliable signal predictions. In this work, we perform a computation of the cosmological collider signal from the three-point inflationary correlator induced by fermion loops. With a systematic treatment of the spinor and helicity structures and combining the recent techniques of scalar-loop integrals, we derive a controlled formula including both the exponential dependence and associated power-law dependence on the mass and chemical potential.

In addition to the technical difficulty, there is also an important question regarding the observability. For a heavy state with mass $m \gtrsim H$, the particle production in the de Sitter space is typically suppressed exponentially, and this suppression is inherited by the nonlocal signal through an approximate Boltzmann factor,

$$\exp(-\pi m/H). \quad (1.2)$$

As a result, even when heavy particles generate distinctive oscillatory signatures, the overall amplitude could be too small to be observable if their production rate is strongly suppressed. A particularly interesting possibility for fermions is that this suppression can be substantially reduced in the presence of a *chemical potential* [35, 45–47, 49–57]. In an inflationary background, derivative couplings between the inflaton and heavy fields can induce an effective chemical potential through the time-dependent inflaton background. For fermions, such a coupling may schematically take the following form,

$$\frac{1}{\Lambda} \partial_\mu \phi J^\mu, \quad (1.3)$$

where J^μ is a chiral fermionic current and Λ denotes the cutoff scale of the effective inflaton-fermion interaction. Once the inflaton develops a homogeneous slow-roll background, $\dot{\phi}_0 \neq 0$, this interaction generates an effective chemical potential,

$$\lambda \sim \frac{\dot{\phi}_0}{\Lambda}. \quad (1.4)$$

Physically speaking, the chemical potential induces helicity-dependent fermion production: one helicity state can be exponentially enhanced, while the other is suppressed. For

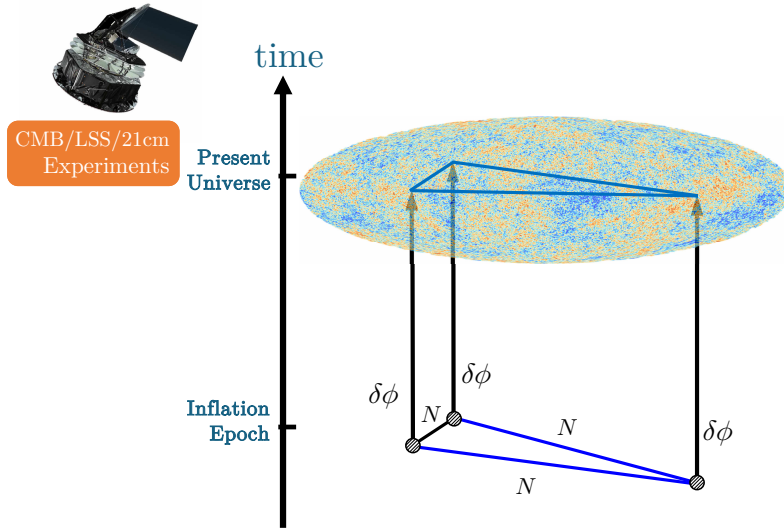


Figure 1: Illustration of the primordial non-Gaussianity observable from the three-point inflaton correlator as generated by the heavy-neutrino triangle loop during the inflation epoch and as (to be) measured in the present universe.

sufficiently large λ , production of the dominant helicity mode can be significantly amplified, weakening the usual Boltzmann suppression and thereby enhancing the observational prospects for fermionic cosmological collider signals.

To demonstrate how this possibility is explicitly realized, it is important to identify a well-motivated new physics candidate of heavy fermions from particle physics. In this work, we take the heavy right-handed neutrinos with the canonical seesaw mechanism [58–61] as a compelling new physics benchmark for this approach, where the seesaw mechanism naturally explains the tiny masses of the light neutrinos as observed by the neutrino oscillation experiments and the right-handed neutrinos provide the last missing piece in the structure of the Standard Model (SM) of particle physics. We note [62, 63] that the scale of the canonical neutrino seesaw is naturally of $O(10^{13-14})\text{GeV}$, lying around the upper range of the inflation energy scale. When the heavy right-handed neutrinos couple to the inflaton through a unique derivative operator of dimension-5 [45, 50, 62, 63], the rolling inflaton background can induce a chemical potential for the right-handed neutrinos and enhance their production during inflation. In this way, the right-handed neutrinos (with the canonical seesaw mechanism) serve as a unique heavy fermion candidate and can be tested by studying the cosmological collider physics.

This setup also provides an important complement to the commonly studied bosonic cosmological collider signals. The heavy fermion signals originate from the propagation of heavy fermions in the loop and manifest themselves through non-analytic structures in appropriate kinematic limits of the cosmological correlator. The oscillation frequency probes the heavy-fermion mass spectrum, whereas the overall oscillation amplitude depends on the strength of the inflaton coupling and the size of the induced chemical potential. Hence, the loop-induced fermionic cosmological collider signals can encode the information

about both the heavy fermion mass-spectrum and their underlying interaction dynamics.

With these motivations, in this work we study the cosmological collider signatures generated by heavy right-handed neutrino loops through the inflaton-right-handed-neutrino interaction, where the right-handed neutrinos join to realize the canonical neutrino seesaw mechanism. We will analyze how the right-handed neutrino loops modify the primordial correlation functions through their interaction with the inflaton. A key ingredient of our analysis is the chemical potential induced by the slow-roll inflaton background. We demonstrate that this chemical potential can exponentially enhance the production of one of the fermion helicity states and significantly amplify the resultant oscillatory signals in the primordial non-Gaussianity. Our analysis uses the two-component Weyl spinors and the Schwinger-Keldysh formalism, together with a factorized treatment of the loop diagram and a set of seed integrals for the fermion propagators. This provides a general framework for heavy fermion loop signals in cosmological collider physics and demonstrates that the heavy right-handed neutrinos (whose masses set the seesaw scale) may leave observable imprints in the primordial non-Gaussianity, as illustrated in Fig. 1.

In general, the full clock signal can receive both nonlocal and local contributions. The nonlocal contribution originates from the long-distance propagation of gravitationally produced massive particles between separated bulk vertices and gives a characteristic non-analytic dependence on the external momenta in the soft limit. The local contribution arises from the short-distance part of the bulk dynamics. Although it may also contain oscillatory clock dependence, its coefficient and phase are controlled by short-distance dynamics and local interactions. In the three-point squeezed limit, these two contributions can provide the same oscillatory momentum dependence and thus may interfere at the level of the total amplitude. For the computational part of this work, we perform an improved computation of the nonlocal contributions from the fermion loops, including computation of each factorized hard subdiagram and bubble-loop subdiagram. These improvements show the importance of reliable control over the power-law parametric dependence in the final results, which can lead to order-of-magnitude changes from the previous estimates for signals with very large oscillation frequencies. On the other hand, the local contribution is technically difficult to compute. This is because the local contribution is controlled by short-distance regions of the bulk time integrals, rather than by the long-distance propagation of massive particles alone. A reliable calculation requires the full unfactorized time integrals and a careful treatment of the associated local terms. Since there is no known reason indicating that including the local contribution would significantly reduce the total signal through large cancellations with nonlocal component, our computed nonlocal contribution could be viewed as a conservative estimate for the observable clock amplitude. A quantitative treatment of the local contribution is technically more challenging and is worth to be tackled for the future work.

The rest of this paper is organized as follows. In Section 2, we introduce the inflationary setup with right-handed neutrinos, derive the effective chemical potential induced by the derivative coupling of inflaton and right-handed neutrinos, and present the fermion propagators and the associated seed integrals in the inflationary background. In Section 3,

we compute the three-point inflaton correlator generated by the right-handed-neutrino loops and extract the non-analytic cosmological collider signals. In Section 4, we analyze the dependence of the cosmological collider signals on the heavy fermion mass, chemical potential, and coupling parameters. With these, we present estimates for the three-point non-Gaussian amplitude f_{NL} . Finally, we summarize our conclusions in Section 5. In Appendices A–C, we provide the technical derivations as needed for the analyses in the main text. In Appendix D, we give a brief review to describe the main concepts and ingredients of the cosmological collider physics which allows the current presentation accessible to a wider readership.

Notation and Conventions:

We consider that the background spacetime is the inflationary patch of de Sitter spacetime, which provides the standard approximation to the slow-roll inflation. We use the coordinates $(\tau, \mathbf{x})$, where $\tau \in (-\infty, 0)$ is the conformal time and $\mathbf{x}$ denotes the comoving spatial coordinates. The metric tensor is given by the distance-square,

$$ds^2 = a^2(\tau)(-d\tau^2 + d\mathbf{x}^2) = \frac{-d\tau^2 + d\mathbf{x}^2}{(H\tau)^2}, \quad (1.5)$$

where $a(\tau) = -1/(H\tau)$ is the scale factor in de Sitter spacetime, and the Hubble parameter H (also denoted as H_{inf}) during inflation is taken to be constant. For any functions $f(\tau)$ and $\phi(t)$, we denote the time-derivatives $f'(\tau) = df(\tau)/d\tau$ and $\dot{\phi}(t) = d\phi(t)/dt$.

Three-dimensional vectors will be denoted in boldface, for example, a spatial momentum is written as $\mathbf{k}$ and its magnitude is defined as $k = |\mathbf{k}|$. For clarity, some definitions of the momentum variables and momentum ratios (used in the following presentation) are given as follows:

$$k_s \equiv |\mathbf{k}_1 + \mathbf{k}_2|, \quad k_t \equiv |\mathbf{k}_1 + \mathbf{k}_4|, \quad k_{ij} \equiv k_i + k_j, \quad r_1 \equiv k_s/k_{12}, \quad r_2 \equiv k_s/k_{34}, \quad (1.6)$$

where the subscripts $i, j = 1, 2, 3, \dots$.

The generalized hypergeometric function ${}_pF_q$ is defined as follows:

$${}_pF_q \left[\begin{matrix} a_1, \dots, a_p \\ b_1, \dots, b_q \end{matrix} \middle| z \right] = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(a_1)_n \cdots (a_p)_n}{(b_1)_n \cdots (b_q)_n} \frac{z^n}{n!}, \quad (1.7)$$

where $(a)_n = \Gamma(a+n)/\Gamma(a)$ is the Pochhammer symbol. The corresponding regularized hypergeometric function ${}_p\tilde{F}_q$ is defined in the following formula:

$${}_p\tilde{F}_q \left[\begin{matrix} a_1, \dots, a_p \\ b_1, \dots, b_q \end{matrix} \middle| z \right] = \frac{1}{\Gamma[b_1, \dots, b_q]} {}_pF_q \left[\begin{matrix} a_1, \dots, a_p \\ b_1, \dots, b_q \end{matrix} \middle| z \right]. \quad (1.8)$$

2 Setup of Inflation with Neutrino Seesaw

In the canonical neutrino seesaw mechanism, for a natural Yukawa coupling $y_\nu = O(1)$, the seesaw scale is typically around 10^{14} GeV, which is a brand-new scale beyond the SM and

can be naturally embedded in the grand unification. Interestingly, this natural high-scale seesaw is also compatible with the upper range of the inflation scale [64–66], characterized by the Hubble parameter during inflation, H . This observation motivates us to consider the appealing possibility that the inflaton field ϕ couples directly to the right-handed neutrino N . Such a coupling could provide an intriguing opportunity to probe the natural seesaw mechanism through inflationary observables in the early universe.

In this section, we explore a natural interaction between the inflaton and right-handed neutrinos in a general slow-roll inflationary setup. We show that, in the presence of the inflaton background, this interaction alters the neutrino dynamics by generating an effective chemical potential. We also provide the fermion propagators in the Schwinger–Keldysh (SK) formalism, together with the associated seed integrals that will be employed in the computation of inflationary correlators in the following sections.

2.1 Inflaton Interaction with Right-Handed Neutrino

In many inflation models, the inflaton potential $V(\phi)$ must be sufficiently flat to satisfy the slow-roll conditions [3, 4] and agree with observations [64–67]. An approximate shift symmetry is often introduced to protect this flatness. As a result, the direct coupling between the inflaton and the right-handed neutrino, $y_\phi \phi (NN + \text{H.c.})$, is expected to be suppressed¹. If instead one considers a derivative coupling between the inflaton and the right-handed neutrino, the leading interaction naturally arises as a dimension-5 operator. The relevant Lagrangian in the Friedmann-Lemaître-Robertson-Walker (FLRW) spacetime (or the de Sitter spacetime)² is given by

$$\mathcal{L} = \sqrt{-g} \left[-\frac{1}{2} \partial_\mu \phi \partial^\mu \phi - V(\phi) + \frac{i}{a(\tau)} N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu D_\mu N + \frac{i}{a(\tau)} \nu_L^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu D_\mu \nu_L - \frac{1}{a(\tau)\Lambda} \partial_\mu \phi N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu N + \left(-\frac{1}{2} M N N - \frac{y_\nu h}{\sqrt{2}} \nu_L N + \text{H.c.} \right) \right]. \quad (2.1)$$

In the above equation, $V(\phi)$ denotes the inflaton potential, which is assumed to be sufficiently flat such that the inflaton can be treated as effectively massless during inflation. The fields ν_L and N correspond to the left-handed and right-handed neutrinos, respectively, both of which are described using two-component Weyl spinors. The operator D_μ represents the covariant derivative acting on spinors in de Sitter spacetime. Finally, h denotes the remaining physical component of the Higgs field in the unitary gauge. The dimension-5 coupling can be expressed as follows:

$$\Delta \mathcal{L} = \sqrt{-g} \frac{-1}{a(\tau)\Lambda} \partial_\mu \phi N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu N = a^3(\tau) \frac{-1}{\Lambda} \partial_\mu \phi N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu N, \quad (2.2)$$

where we have used $\sqrt{-g} = a^4(\tau)$ for de Sitter space in conformal coordinates. Here, $\partial_\mu \phi$ denote derivatives with respect to conformal coordinates.

¹The contraction of two Weyl spinors (NN) is defined by ($NN \equiv N^\alpha N_\alpha$), in accordance with the convention adopted in Ref. [68].

²We give a brief discussion about the Lagrangian of the Weyl spinors in curved spacetime in the Appendix A.

In the previous work [62, 63], we studied the prediction of local-type non-Gaussianity $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{local}}$ generated through Higgs-modulated reheating in the neutrino seesaw framework. In the present work, we instead investigate the impact of the dimension-5 coupling on the quantum fluctuations of the inflaton. This effect is encoded in the cosmological collider signals induced by the derivative coupling between the inflaton and the right-handed neutrino during inflation. Before proceeding to the calculation, we first introduce the theoretical framework for fermions in an inflationary background.

2.2 Fermions in the Slow-Roll Inflationary Background

In Eq.(2.1), we introduce a minimal model of the canonical seesaw combined with inflaton. Within this scenario, the right-handed neutrino, with a Majorana mass term M , is coupled to the inflaton through a dimension-5 operator. In this section, we study the dynamics of the neutrino field during the inflation. We will illustrate that the right-handed neutrino would experience an effective chemical potential sourced from the inflaton background due to the dimension-5 coupling.

During inflation, the inflaton field $\phi(t, \mathbf{x})$ is decomposed into a homogeneous background part $\phi_0(t)$ and a quantum fluctuation $\delta\phi(t, \mathbf{x})$,

$$\phi(t, \mathbf{x}) = \phi_0(t) + \delta\phi(t, \mathbf{x}). \quad (2.3)$$

Depending on the type of inflation models, the background inflaton field could be much larger or smaller than the Planck scale. In a slow-roll background, the rolling rate of $\phi_0(t)$, $\dot{\phi}_0 \equiv \partial_t \phi_0$ with respect to the physical time t , satisfies the slow-roll condition and is also constrained by observations through the dimensionless power spectrum P_ζ of the comoving curvature perturbation ζ as follows:

$$P_\zeta = \frac{H^4}{4\pi^2 \dot{\phi}_0^2} = \frac{H^2}{8\pi^2 \epsilon M_{\text{Pl}}^2} \simeq 2 \times 10^{-9}, \quad (2.4)$$

where the slow-roll parameter ϵ is given by

$$\epsilon \equiv -\frac{\dot{H}}{H^2} = \frac{\dot{\phi}_0^2}{2H^2 M_{\text{Pl}}^2}. \quad (2.5)$$

Using the observed amplitude of the scalar power spectrum, one finds that the rolling rate of the inflaton background is approximately given by

$$\dot{\phi}_0 \simeq (60H)^2. \quad (2.6)$$

In this case, the dimension-5 coupling to the inflaton induces a nontrivial modification of the quadratic part of the neutrino Lagrangian. In particular,

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta\mathcal{L} &= \sqrt{-g} \frac{-1}{a(\tau)\Lambda} \partial_\mu \phi N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu N \\ &\supset \sqrt{-g} \frac{-1}{a(\tau)\Lambda} \partial_0 \phi_0 N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^0 N \end{aligned}$$

$$= -a^4(\tau) \frac{\dot{\phi}_0}{\Lambda} N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^0 N, \quad (2.7)$$

where $\partial_0 \phi_0 = \partial_\tau \phi_0(\tau)$ denotes the derivative of the inflaton background $\phi_0(\tau)$ with respect to conformal time τ , while $\dot{\phi}_0$ denotes the derivative with respect to physical time t (referred to as the rolling rate in the above discussion). These are related by $\partial_0 \phi_0 = a \dot{\phi}_0$. We may then write the quadratic terms for the right-handed neutrino in Eq.(2.1) as

$$\Delta \mathcal{L} = a^3 N^\dagger i \not{D} N - a^4 \lambda N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^0 N - \frac{1}{2} a^4 M_R (N N + \text{H.c.}), \quad (2.8)$$

where M_R is the heavy neutrino mass, and $\lambda \equiv \dot{\phi}_0/\Lambda$ arises from the dimension-5 coupling between the inflaton and the right-handed neutrino and plays the role of an effective chemical potential for the right-handed neutrino. It is convenient to redefine the field as $N(x) = a^{-3/2} \tilde{N}(x)$, so that the covariant derivative acting on N is reduced to an ordinary partial derivative acting on $\tilde{N}$. In terms of $\tilde{N}$, the above Lagrangian takes the following form:

$$\Delta \mathcal{L} = \tilde{N}^\dagger i \not{\partial} \tilde{N} - a \lambda \tilde{N}^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^0 \tilde{N} - \frac{1}{2} a M_R (\tilde{N} \tilde{N} + \text{H.c.}). \quad (2.9)$$

The equation of motion is obtained by varying the Lagrangian with respect to $\tilde{N}^\dagger$, yielding

$$i \bar{\sigma}^\mu \partial_\mu \tilde{N} = a \lambda \bar{\sigma}^0 \tilde{N} + a M_R \tilde{N}^\dagger. \quad (2.10)$$

Then we decompose the spinor $\tilde{N}$ into eigenmodes of the three-momentum,

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{N}_\alpha(\tau, \mathbf{x}) &= \int \frac{d^3 \mathbf{k}}{(2\pi)^3} \sum_{s=\pm} \left[\xi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k}) b_s(\mathbf{k}) e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} + \chi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k}) b_s^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) e^{-i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \right], \\ \tilde{N}_\alpha^\dagger(\tau, \mathbf{x}) &= \int \frac{d^3 \mathbf{k}}{(2\pi)^3} \sum_{s=\pm} \left[\xi_{s,\alpha}^\dagger(\tau, \mathbf{k}) b_s^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) e^{-i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} + \chi_{s,\alpha}^\dagger(\tau, \mathbf{k}) b_s(\mathbf{k}) e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \right], \end{aligned} \quad (2.11)$$

where $s = \pm 1$ denotes the sign of the spinor helicity, and b_s and $b_s^\dagger$ are the annihilation and creation operators obeying the anticommutation relation,

$$\{b_s(\mathbf{k}), b_{s'}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}')\} = (2\pi)^3 \delta_{ss'} \delta^3(\mathbf{k} - \mathbf{k}'). \quad (2.12)$$

The mode functions $\xi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k})$ and $\chi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k})$ are associated with definite helicity. We decompose them in terms of the unit helicity eigenspinors h_s as

$$\xi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k}) = u_s(\tau, k) h_{s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}), \quad \chi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\tau, \mathbf{k}) = v_s(\tau, k) s h_{-s}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}). \quad (2.13)$$

The helicity basis eigenspinors h_s satisfy

$$\vec{\sigma} \cdot \hat{\mathbf{k}} h_s(\mathbf{k}) = s h_s(\mathbf{k}), \quad h_s^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_{s'}(\mathbf{k}) = \delta_{ss'}, \quad \sum_{s=\pm 1} h_s(\mathbf{k}) h_s^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) = 1. \quad (2.14)$$

For the spatial momentum along the direction

$$\hat{\mathbf{k}} = (\sin \theta \cos \varphi, \sin \theta \sin \varphi, \cos \theta), \quad (2.15)$$

the helicity eigenspinors can be chosen as follows:

$$h_+(\theta, \varphi) = \begin{pmatrix} e^{-i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \cos\frac{\theta}{2} \\ e^{i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \sin\frac{\theta}{2} \end{pmatrix}, \quad h_-(\theta, \varphi) = \begin{pmatrix} -e^{-i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \sin\frac{\theta}{2} \\ e^{i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \cos\frac{\theta}{2} \end{pmatrix}. \quad (2.16)$$

More details about these helicity eigenspinors and the derivation of their relations are given in the Appendix A.

Then, from the equations of motion we derive the equations for the τ -dependent spinor coefficients u_s and v_s (with $s = \pm$):

$$iu'_\pm \pm ku_\pm = a\lambda u_\pm + aM_R v_\pm, \quad (2.17a)$$

$$iv'_\pm \mp kv_\pm = -a\lambda v_\pm + aM_R u_\pm, \quad (2.17b)$$

where $u' = du/d\tau$ and $v' = dv/d\tau$. To solve the above mixed differential equations, we recast them in the following second-order differential equations on $u_\pm$ and $v_\pm$ respectively,

$$u''_\pm - aHu'_\pm + \left[(\pm k - a\lambda)^2 + a^2 M_R^2 \pm iaHk \right] u_\pm = 0, \quad (2.18a)$$

$$v''_\pm - aHv'_\pm + \left[(\mp k + a\lambda)^2 + a^2 M_R^2 \mp iaHk \right] v_\pm = 0. \quad (2.18b)$$

Imposing the Bunch-Davies initial condition (for $\tau \rightarrow -\infty$) together with the canonical normalization, the spinor coefficients u_s and v_s are solved as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} u_+(\tau, k) &= \frac{e^{+\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}}{\sqrt{-2k\tau}} \tilde{M}_R W_{-\frac{1}{2}-i\tilde{\lambda}, i\tilde{\nu}}(i2k\tau), \\ u_-(\tau, k) &= \frac{e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}}{\sqrt{-2k\tau}} W_{\frac{1}{2}+i\tilde{\lambda}, i\tilde{\nu}}(i2k\tau), \\ v_+(\tau, k) &= \frac{e^{+\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}}{\sqrt{-2k\tau}} W_{\frac{1}{2}-i\tilde{\lambda}, i\tilde{\nu}}(i2k\tau), \\ v_-(\tau, k) &= \frac{e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}}{\sqrt{-2k\tau}} \tilde{M}_R W_{-\frac{1}{2}+i\tilde{\lambda}, i\tilde{\nu}}(i2k\tau), \end{aligned} \quad (2.19)$$

where $W_{\kappa, \mu}(z)$ denotes the Whittaker function, and

$$\tilde{M}_R = \frac{M_R}{H}, \quad \tilde{\lambda} = \frac{\lambda}{H}, \quad \lambda = \frac{\dot{\phi}_0}{\Lambda}, \quad \tilde{\nu} = \sqrt{\tilde{M}_R^2 + \tilde{\lambda}^2}. \quad (2.20)$$

On the other hand, the Whittaker function $W_{\kappa, \mu}(z)$ can be expressed in terms of the Kummer's confluent hypergeometric function ${}_1F_1(a; b; z)$ as follows:

$$W_{\kappa, \mu}(z) = \frac{\Gamma(-2\mu)e^{-z/2}z^{\mu+\frac{1}{2}}}{\Gamma(\frac{1}{2}-\mu-\kappa)} {}_1F_1\left(\frac{1}{2}+\mu-\kappa; 1+2\mu; z\right) + (\mu \rightarrow -\mu), \quad (2.21)$$

where the function ${}_1F_1(a; b; z)$ is defined as

$${}_1F_1(a; b; z) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(a)_n z^n}{(b)_n n!}, \quad (2.22)$$

with $(a)_n$ being the rising Pochhammer symbol,

$$(a)_n \equiv \frac{\Gamma(a+n)}{\Gamma(a)}. \quad (2.23)$$

Accordingly, the spinor coefficients u_s and v_s can be rewritten as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} u_+(\tau, k) &= \frac{e^{-i\pi/4+\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}\tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}/2}\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})}(-2k\tau)^{i\tilde{\nu}} e^{-ik\tau} {}_1F_1(1+i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu}; 1+i2\tilde{\nu}; i2k\tau) + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \\ u_-(\tau, k) &= \frac{e^{-i\pi/4-\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}/2}\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})}(-2k\tau)^{i\tilde{\nu}} e^{-ik\tau} {}_1F_1(-i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu}; 1+i2\tilde{\nu}; i2k\tau) + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \\ v_+(\tau, k) &= \frac{e^{-i\pi/4+\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}/2}\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})}(-2k\tau)^{i\tilde{\nu}} e^{-ik\tau} {}_1F_1(i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu}; 1+i2\tilde{\nu}; i2k\tau) + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \\ v_-(\tau, k) &= \frac{e^{-i\pi/4-\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}\tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}/2}\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})}(-2k\tau)^{i\tilde{\nu}} e^{-ik\tau} {}_1F_1(1-i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu}; 1+i2\tilde{\nu}; i2k\tau) + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}). \end{aligned} \quad (2.24)$$

Note that the Whittaker function has a branch cut in the z -plane. As a result, performing a Wick rotation in the calculation of the correlation function is not entirely straightforward. In contrast, the function ${}_1F_1(a; b; z)$ is regular in the z -plane, which makes the Wick rotation simpler and facilitates the evaluation of the desired correlation function.

To extract the oscillatory CC signals, it is useful to determine the late-time behavior of these spinor coefficients. In the soft limit or late time limit $|k\tau| \rightarrow 0$, their asymptotic forms are given by

$$\begin{aligned} u_{L+}(\tau, k) &\simeq e^{-i\pi/4+\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2} \frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}/2}\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} (-2k\tau)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \\ u_{L-}(\tau, k) &\simeq e^{-i\pi/4-\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2} \frac{e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}/2}\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} (-2k\tau)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \\ v_{L+}(\tau, k) &\simeq e^{-i\pi/4+\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2} \frac{e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}/2}\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} (-2k\tau)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \\ v_{L-}(\tau, k) &\simeq e^{-i\pi/4-\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2} \tilde{M}_R \frac{e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}/2}\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} (-2k\tau)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \end{aligned} \quad (2.25)$$

with the $u_{L\pm}(\tau, k) \equiv \lim_{|k\tau| \rightarrow 0} u_{\pm}(\tau, k)$ and $v_{L\pm}(\tau, k) \equiv \lim_{|k\tau| \rightarrow 0} v_{\pm}(\tau, k)$.

In the next section, we will introduce the propagators of Weyl spinor, $D(\tau_1, \tau_2)$, which are constructed from products of two spinor coefficients. The late time limit of a “propagator” contributes to the CC signal. For instance, for the propagator $D(\tau_1, \tau_2) \simeq u_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau, k)$, it has the late time limit,

$$\begin{aligned} u_{L+}(\tau_1, k)u_{L+}^\dagger(\tau_2, k) &= \frac{-e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}[\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} (4k^2\tau_1\tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \\ &\quad + \frac{-e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}+\pi\tilde{\nu}}\tilde{M}_R^2\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu})} \left(\frac{\tau_1}{\tau_2}\right)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \\ &= \left[u_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc})} + \left[u_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{Loc})}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.26)$$

Similar to the case of the scalar field, the late time limit of a fermion propagator could also be divided into the nonlocal part proportional to $(\tau_1\tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}}$ (accompanied by a

non-analytic dependence on k) and the local part proportional to $\left(\frac{\tau_1}{\tau_2}\right)^{i\tilde{\nu}}$. In this work, we are interested in the nonlocal part of the cosmological collider signal generated by the right-handed neutrino, so we extract the nonlocal contribution by retaining only the terms proportional to $(\tau_1\tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}}$ and $(\tau_1\tau_2)^{-i\tilde{\nu}}$. For instance, for the product $u_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)$, the nonlocal part (denoted by the abbreviation “NLoc”) is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \left[u_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc})} &= \frac{-e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}[\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})}(4k^2\tau_1\tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \\ &= \sum_{d=\pm} \left[u_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}, \end{aligned} \quad (2.27)$$

where $\left[u_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}$ denotes the component proportional to $(\tau_1\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}$, with $d = \pm$. In the following, we summarize the nonlocal parts for all relevant products. As shown above, we obtain the nonlocal contribution, denoted by “(NLoc)”, by summing over the two components “(NLoc), d ” with $d = \pm$,

$$\left[u_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = \frac{-e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}[\Gamma(-i2d\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})}(4k^2\tau_1\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (2.28a)$$

$$\left[u_+(\tau_1, k)v_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = \frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}[\Gamma(-i2d\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})}(4k^2\tau_1\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (2.28b)$$

$$\left[v_+(\tau_1, k)u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = \frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}[\Gamma(-i2d\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})}(4k^2\tau_1\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (2.28c)$$

$$\left[u_-(\tau_1, k)u_-^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = \frac{e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}}[\Gamma(-i2d\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})}(4k^2\tau_1\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (2.28d)$$

$$\left[u_-(\tau_1, k)v_-^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = \frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}}[\Gamma(-i2d\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})}(4k^2\tau_1\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (2.28e)$$

$$\left[v_-(\tau_1, k)u_-^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = \frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}}[\Gamma(-i2d\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})}(4k^2\tau_1\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}. \quad (2.28f)$$

Using the properties of the nonlocal part, we can express the remaining cases in terms of the above results (for $s = \pm$),

$$\left[v_s(\tau_1, k)v_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = -\left[u_s(\tau_1, k)u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}, \quad (2.29a)$$

$$\left[v_s^\dagger(\tau_1, k)u_s(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = \left[u_s(\tau_1, k)v_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}, \quad (2.29b)$$

$$\left[u_s^\dagger(\tau_1, k)v_s(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d} = \left[v_s(\tau_1, k)u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}. \quad (2.29c)$$

2.3 Fermion Propagators during Inflation in the SK Formalism

The Schwinger–Keldysh (SK) path integral formalism is used to compute expectation values of operators at a finite time in a time-dependent background, as required for deriving cosmological correlators. It evolves the quantum state along a closed time contour, going forward and then backward in time, which ensures a consistent treatment of real-time dynamics. In this framework, fields are doubled into forward ($\oplus$) and backward ($\ominus$) branches,

and correlators are obtained from a generating functional defined on this contour. This method naturally incorporates interactions and initial conditions, and is commonly used to compute inflationary correlation functions and primordial non-Gaussianities [45, 46, 69]. To compute the inflationary correlators of $\delta\phi(t, \mathbf{x})$ generated by the right-handed-neutrino loop, we first present the propagators for Weyl spinors in the SK formalism.

As in flat spacetime, there are two types of propagators for Majorana fermion in term of Weyl spinors. We begin with the propagators of the $\langle \tilde{N} \tilde{N}^\dagger \rangle$ type, denoted by $D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}$, where the SK indices (a, b) take the values $\oplus, \ominus$ and have four combinations $(\oplus\oplus, \oplus\ominus, \ominus\oplus, \ominus\ominus)$ corresponding to the four possible SK contour assignments and related by time ordering. They are expressed as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} D_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \sum_s \xi_{s,\alpha}(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) \xi_{s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) = \sum_s u_s(\tau_1, k) u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k) h_{s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}) h_{s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}), \\ D_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \sum_s -\chi_{s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) \chi_{s,\alpha}(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) = \sum_s -v_s(\tau_2, k) v_s^\dagger(\tau_1, k) h_{-s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_{-s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}), \\ D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= D_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + D_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \\ D_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= D_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + D_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \end{aligned} \quad (2.30)$$

where $\theta(\tau)$ is the step function,

$$\theta(\tau) = \begin{cases} 0, & (\tau < 0), \\ 1, & (\tau \geq 0), \end{cases} \quad (2.31)$$

and $\sum_s$ denotes the sum over the two helicity states ($s = \pm$).

We call these four propagators the “type-1” propagators and give their diagrammatic representation as follows:

$$\begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{k} \\ \textcircled{\otimes} \text{---} \textcircled{\otimes} \end{array} \equiv D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2). \quad (2.32)$$

In addition, there are four propagators of the $\langle \tilde{N} \tilde{N} \rangle$ type, denoted by $\hat{D}_{ab\alpha\beta}$, which are expressed as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{D}_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \sum_s \xi_{s,\alpha}(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) \chi_{s,\beta}(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) = \sum_s s u_s(\tau_1, k) v_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k) h_{s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}) h_{-s,\beta}(\mathbf{k}), \\ \hat{D}_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \sum_s -\xi_{s,\beta}(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) \chi_{s,\alpha}(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) = \sum_s -s u_s(\tau_2, k) v_s^\dagger(\tau_1, k) h_{s,\beta}(\mathbf{k}) h_{-s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}), \\ \hat{D}_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \hat{D}_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + \hat{D}_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \\ \hat{D}_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \hat{D}_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + \hat{D}_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1). \end{aligned} \quad (2.33)$$

We refer to these four propagators as the “type-2” propagators. Their diagrammatic representation is

$$\begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{k} \\ \textcircled{\otimes} \text{---} \textcircled{\otimes} \end{array} \equiv \hat{D}_{ab\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2). \quad (2.34)$$

The two oppositely oriented arrows indicate that this propagator connects two identical Weyl fields, and thus represents a Majorana contraction rather than an N -number-conserving propagator.

The indices can be raised by contracting with the antisymmetric tensor $\epsilon^{\alpha\beta}$:

$$\hat{D}_{ab\alpha}{}^{\beta}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \equiv \epsilon^{\beta\gamma} \hat{D}_{ab\alpha\gamma}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) = -\hat{D}_{ab\alpha\gamma}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \epsilon^{\gamma\beta}. \quad (2.35)$$

Moreover, the Hermitian conjugates of the above propagators, namely those of the $\langle \tilde{N}^\dagger \tilde{N}^\dagger \rangle$ type, are denoted by $\check{D}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}$. For clarity, we refer to them as the “type-3” propagators and express them as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \check{D}_{\oplus\oplus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \sum_s \chi_{s,\dot{\alpha}}^\dagger(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) \xi_{s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) = \sum_s s v_s(\tau_1, k) u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k) h_{-s,\dot{\alpha}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_{s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}), \\ \check{D}_{\oplus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \sum_s -\chi_{s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) \xi_{s,\dot{\alpha}}^\dagger(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) = \sum_s -s v_s(\tau_2, k) u_s^\dagger(\tau_1, k) h_{-s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_{s,\dot{\alpha}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}), \\ \check{D}_{\oplus\oplus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \check{D}_{\oplus\oplus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + \check{D}_{\oplus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \\ \check{D}_{\ominus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \check{D}_{\oplus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + \check{D}_{\ominus\oplus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1). \end{aligned} \quad (2.36)$$

The dotted spinor indices can be raised likewise by contracting with the antisymmetric tensor $\epsilon^{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}$:

$$\check{D}_{ab}{}^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \equiv \epsilon^{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\gamma}} \check{D}_{ab\dot{\gamma}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) = -\epsilon^{\dot{\gamma}\dot{\alpha}} \check{D}_{ab\dot{\gamma}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2). \quad (2.37)$$

Their diagrammatic representation is given by

$$\begin{array}{c} \tau_1 \quad \xrightarrow{k} \quad \tau_2 \\ \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \end{array} \equiv \check{D}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2). \quad (2.38)$$

As discussed in Section D, the imprint of the cosmological collider signals can be read off directly from the late-time limit of the massive propagators. For instance, we can extract the nonlocal parts of the spinor propagators in the late-time limit:

$$\begin{aligned} & \left[D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} \\ &= \left[u_+(\tau_1, k) u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} h_{+,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}) h_{+,\beta}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) + \left[u_-(\tau_1, k) u_-^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} h_{-,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}) h_{-,\beta}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) \\ &= \left\{ \left[\frac{-e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} h_+(\mathbf{k}) h_+^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) + \frac{e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} h_-(\mathbf{k}) h_-^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) \right] \right. \\ & \quad \left. \times (4k^2 \tau_1 \tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}} \right\}_{\alpha\beta} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \end{aligned} \quad (2.39a)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & \left[\hat{D}_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} \\ &= \left[u_+(\tau_1, k) v_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} h_{+,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}) h_{-,\beta}(\mathbf{k}) - \left[u_-(\tau_1, k) v_-^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} h_{-,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}) h_{+,\beta}(\mathbf{k}) \\ &= \left\{ \left[\frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} h_+(\mathbf{k}) h_-(\mathbf{k}) - \frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} h_-(\mathbf{k}) h_+(\mathbf{k}) \right] \right. \\ & \quad \left. \times (4k^2 \tau_1 \tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}} \right\}_{\alpha\beta} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \end{aligned} \quad (2.39b)$$

$$\begin{aligned}
& \left[\check{D}_{\ominus \oplus \dot{\alpha} \dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} \\
&= \left[v_+(\tau_1, k) u_+^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} h_{-, \dot{\alpha}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_{+, \dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) - \left[v_-(\tau_1, k) u_-^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} h_{+, \dot{\alpha}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_{-, \dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) \\
&= \left\{ \left[\frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{\pi \tilde{\lambda}} [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} h_-^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_+^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) - \frac{\tilde{M}_R e^{-\pi \tilde{\lambda}} [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} h_+^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_-^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) \right] \right. \\
&\quad \left. \times (4k^2 \tau_1 \tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}} \right\}_{\dot{\alpha} \dot{\beta}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}), \tag{2.39c}
\end{aligned}$$

In the above expressions, the first term in the nonlocal part arises from the positive-helicity spinor coefficients, namely $u_+ u_+^\dagger$, $u_+ v_+^\dagger$, and $v_+ u_+^\dagger$, whereas the second term arises from the negative-helicity spinor coefficients, namely $u_- u_-^\dagger$, $u_- v_-^\dagger$, and $v_- u_-^\dagger$.

Without losing generality, we choose a positive chemical potential $\lambda > 0$. Then, we readily find³ that the positive-helicity contribution, namely $u_+ u_+^\dagger$, $u_+ v_+^\dagger$, and $v_+ u_+^\dagger$, is proportional to the modified Boltzmann factor $e^{+\pi \tilde{\lambda} - \pi \tilde{\nu}} \sim e^{-\pi \tilde{M}_R^2 / 2 \tilde{\lambda}}$ when the chemical potential λ is sufficiently large. In contrast, in the absence of a chemical potential ($\lambda=0$), the usual Boltzmann suppression for a heavy fermion is $e^{-\pi \tilde{M}_R}$. This shows that a positive chemical potential enhances the production of fermions with positive helicity and delays the Boltzmann suppression associated with a large mass [45, 50, 51, 70, 71].

In contrast, the negative-helicity contribution, namely $u_- u_-^\dagger$, $u_- v_-^\dagger$, and $v_- u_-^\dagger$, is proportional to $e^{-\pi \tilde{\lambda} - \pi \tilde{\nu}}$, indicating that a positive chemical potential suppresses the production of fermions with negative helicity. Similarly, a negative chemical potential would instead enhance the production of fermions with negative helicity. In either case, one helicity component of the Weyl spinor is enhanced in the presence of a sufficiently large chemical potential. Thus, it suffices for us to consider the case of a positive chemical potential $\lambda > 0$.

2.4 Seed Integrals for Fermion Propagators

In Section 3, we will evaluate the inflaton two-point correlator $\mathcal{J}_{ab}(\mathbf{k})$ containing a single fermion propagator,

$$\mathcal{J}_{ab}(\mathbf{k}) \sim \int_{-\infty}^{0-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 G_a(k, \tau_1) D_{ab}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) G_b(k, \tau_2), \tag{2.40}$$

where $G_{a,b}$ is the bulk-to-boundary propagator of the inflaton $\delta\phi$. Such two-point correlator $\mathcal{J}_{ab}(\mathbf{k})$ will serve as an ingredient in the evaluation of the three-point inflaton correlator induced by the fermion loop, which can be expressed by a set of seed integrals. In the following, we introduce these seed integrals and organize them in a convenient form for the subsequent calculations.

The bulk-to-boundary propagators of the inflaton $\delta\phi$, defined in Eq.(D.14), can always be written as the product of a function of τ and an oscillatory exponential,

$$G_a(k, \tau) = P(\tau) e^{iak\tau}, \quad P(\tau) = \sum_{n=0}^2 c(n) \tau^n, \tag{2.41}$$

³For the Gamma functions appearing in the above expressions, one may use the asymptotic formula, $\Gamma(x+iy) \sim \sqrt{2\pi} |y|^{x-1/2} e^{-\pi|y|/2}$, in the regime $\lambda \gg m \gg H$.

where $P(\tau)$ is a finite polynomial of the conformal time τ . Thus, substituting $G_a(\mathbf{k}, \tau)$ into the two-point correlator $\mathcal{J}_{ab}$ in Eq.(2.40), we derive the following seed time integral:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{I}_{ab}^{p_1 p_2} &= k^{1+p_1} k^{1+p_2} \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 e^{iak\tau_1} e^{ibk\tau_2} (-\tau_1)^{p_1} (-\tau_2)^{p_2} D_{ab}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \\ &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{-iaz_1} e^{-ibz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} D_{ab}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2),\end{aligned}\tag{2.42}$$

where we have introduced the dimensionless variables

$$z_i = -k\tau_i, \quad (i = 1, 2).\tag{2.43}$$

The fermion propagators $D_{ab}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)$ are constructed from the two types of spinor coefficients, $u_s(k, \tau)$ and $v_s(k, \tau)$, together with their conjugates. As a result, the relevant time integrals reduce to two basic forms. Taking $u_s(z_1)v_s^\dagger(z_2)$ as an example, the first form is the factorized time integral,

$$\int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iaz_1} e^{-iaz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_s(z_1) v_s^\dagger(z_2),\tag{2.44}$$

and the second form is the nested time integral,

$$\int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iaz_1} e^{iaz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_s(z_1) v_s^\dagger(z_2) \times \begin{cases} \theta(z_1 - z_2), \\ \theta(z_2 - z_1), \end{cases}\tag{2.45}$$

where $a = \oplus, \ominus$, and p_1 and p_2 are the relevant powers associated with z_1 and z_2 , respectively. Hence, there are two basic classes of seed integrals: the factorized integrals in Eq.(2.44) (corresponding to $a = -b = \oplus, \ominus$), and the nested integrals in Eq.(2.45) (corresponding to $a = b = \oplus, \ominus$). In what follows, we define the seed integrals for both classes.

All seed integrals introduced below can be evaluated by means of a Wick rotation [7, 11, 20, 69],

$$e^{\pm iz_1}, e^{\pm iz_2} \longrightarrow e^{-z_1}, e^{-z_2},\tag{2.46}$$

where the rotation directions are chosen such that the integrals remain convergent. The validity of this procedure is ensured by the usual $i\epsilon$ prescription of the interacting quantum field theory for de Sitter spacetime.

In the following Subsections 2.4.1-2.4.3, we first present the seed integrals in the special frame where the spatial momentum is aligned with z -axis,

$$\mathbf{k} = k\hat{z} = (0, 0, k).\tag{2.47}$$

Then, in Section 2.4.4, we will explain how to transform these seed integrals to the general case that has the momentum $\mathbf{k}$ in an arbitrary direction.

2.4.1 Seed Integrals for $D_{ab\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2)$

As discussed above, the seed integrals are classified according to the type of the fermion propagator. We define the seed integrals $\mathcal{I}_{ab\alpha\beta}^{p_1 p_2}$ associated with the propagator

$D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2)$ as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{I}_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} &= k_1^{1+p_1} k_2^{1+p_2} \int_{-\infty}^0 d\tau_1 d\tau_2 e^{iak\tau_1} e^{ibk\tau_2} (-\tau_1)^{p_1} (-\tau_2)^{p_2} D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \\ &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{-iaz_1} e^{-ibz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2).\end{aligned}\quad (2.48)$$

Since $D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2)$ is a rank-2 spinor-tensor which is constructed by direct product of two spinors, the seed integral $\mathcal{I}_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2}$ could be expressed by a 2×2 matrix as follows:

$$\mathcal{I}_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} = \begin{pmatrix} A_1^{p_1 p_2} - B_2^{p_1 p_2} & 0 \\ 0 & A_2^{p_1 p_2} - B_1^{p_1 p_2} \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}, \quad (2.49a)$$

$$\mathcal{I}_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} = \left(\mathcal{I}_{\oplus\oplus\beta\dot{\alpha}}^{p_2^* p_1^*} \right)^\dagger = \begin{pmatrix} (A_1^{p_2^* p_1^*} - B_2^{p_2^* p_1^*})^* & 0 \\ 0 & (A_2^{p_2^* p_1^*} - B_1^{p_2^* p_1^*})^* \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}, \quad (2.49b)$$

$$\mathcal{I}_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} = \begin{pmatrix} U_1^{p_1 p_2} & 0 \\ 0 & U_2^{p_1 p_2} \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}, \quad \mathcal{I}_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} = \begin{pmatrix} -V_2^{p_1 p_2} & 0 \\ 0 & -V_1^{p_1 p_2} \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}. \quad (2.49c)$$

In Eq.(2.49b), the seed integral $\mathcal{I}_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2}$ is connected to $\mathcal{I}_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2}$ by the identity $\mathcal{I}_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} = \left(\mathcal{I}_{\oplus\oplus\beta\dot{\alpha}}^{p_2^* p_1^*} \right)^\dagger$. This can be proved in the following way:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{I}_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} D_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2) \\ &= \left[\int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1^*} z_2^{p_2^*} \left(D_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2) \right)^\dagger \right]^\dagger \\ &= \left[\int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1^*} z_2^{p_2^*} D_{\oplus\oplus\beta\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}, z_2, z_1) \right]^\dagger = \left(\mathcal{I}_{\oplus\oplus\beta\dot{\alpha}}^{p_2^* p_1^*} \right)^\dagger.\end{aligned}\quad (2.50)$$

As discussed above, we choose $\mathbf{k}$ to be aligned with the z -axis, i.e., $\mathbf{k} = k\hat{z}$ in the seed integral. In Eq.(2.49), the matrix elements $(A_i^{p_1 p_2}, B_i^{p_1 p_2})$ ($i = 1, 2$) are defined as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}A_1^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_+(z_1) u_+^\dagger(z_2) \theta(z_2 - z_1) \\ &= \tilde{M}_R^2 e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} I^{p_1 p_2} (1 + i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, 1 + i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}),\end{aligned}\quad (2.51a)$$

$$\begin{aligned}A_2^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_-(z_1) u_-^\dagger(z_2) \theta(z_2 - z_1) \\ &= e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} I^{p_1 p_2} (-i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, -i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, 1 - i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}),\end{aligned}\quad (2.51b)$$

$$\begin{aligned}B_1^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} v_+(z_2) v_+^\dagger(z_1) \theta(z_1 - z_2) \\ &= e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} I^{p_2 p_1} (i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, 1 + i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}),\end{aligned}\quad (2.51c)$$

$$\begin{aligned}B_2^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} v_-(z_2) v_-^\dagger(z_1) \theta(z_1 - z_2) \\ &= \tilde{M}_R^2 e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} I^{p_2 p_1} (1 - i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, 1 - i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, -i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}).\end{aligned}\quad (2.51d)$$

In the above, $I^{p_1 p_2}(x, y, z)$ is given by

$$\begin{aligned}
I^{p_1 p_2}(x, y, z) &= i 2^{-2-p_1-p_2} e^{-\frac{i\pi}{2}(p_1+p_2)} \pi \operatorname{csch}(2\pi\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(2+p_1+p_2) \\
&\times \left[\frac{e^{-\pi\tilde{\nu}}}{\Gamma(x)} \Gamma(1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(2+p_1+p_2-i2\tilde{\nu}) \right. \\
&\times \left. {}_4\tilde{F}_3 \left(\begin{matrix} 2+p_1+p_2, 1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}, y, 2+p_1+p_2-i2\tilde{\nu} \\ 2+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}, 3+p_1+p_2-z, 1-i2\tilde{\nu} \end{matrix} \middle| -1 \right) - (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \right],
\end{aligned} \tag{2.52}$$

where ${}_4\tilde{F}_3$ is the hypergeometric function as defined in Section 1. The other matrix elements $(U_i^{p_1 p_2}, V_i^{p_1 p_2})$ ($i=1, 2$) are defined by

$$\begin{aligned}
U_1^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_+(z_1) u_+^\dagger(z_2) \\
&= \tilde{M}_R^2 e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} K^{p_1 p_2} (2+i\tilde{\lambda}, 2-i\tilde{\lambda}),
\end{aligned} \tag{2.53a}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
U_2^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_-(z_1) u_-^\dagger(z_2) \\
&= e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} K^{p_1 p_2} (1-i\tilde{\lambda}, 1+i\tilde{\lambda}),
\end{aligned} \tag{2.53b}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
V_1^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} v_+(z_2) v_+^\dagger(z_1) \\
&= e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} e^{-i\pi(p_1-p_2)} K^{p_1 p_2} (1-i\tilde{\lambda}, 1+i\tilde{\lambda}),
\end{aligned} \tag{2.53c}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
V_2^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} v_-(z_2) v_-^\dagger(z_1) \\
&= \tilde{M}_R^2 e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} e^{-i\pi(p_1-p_2)} K^{p_1 p_2} (2+i\tilde{\lambda}, 2-i\tilde{\lambda}),
\end{aligned} \tag{2.53d}$$

where the function $K^{p_1 p_2}(x, y)$ takes the following form,

$$K^{p_1 p_2}(x, y) = e^{\frac{i\pi}{2}(p_1-p_2)} \frac{\Gamma(1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(1+p_1+i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(1+p_2-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(1+p_2+i\tilde{\nu})}{2^{2+p_1+p_2}\Gamma(p_1+x)\Gamma(p_2+y)}. \tag{2.54}$$

The derivations of the above seed-integral matrices are provided in Appendix C.2.

2.4.2 Seed Integrals for $\hat{D}_{ab\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2)$

Then, we consider the propagator $\hat{D}_{ab\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2)$ and define its associated seed integrals $\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{ab\alpha\beta}^{p_1 p_2}$ as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}
\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{ab\alpha\beta}^{p_1 p_2} &= k_1^{1+p_1} k_2^{1+p_2} \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 e^{iak\tau_1} e^{ibk\tau_2} (-\tau_1)^{p_1} (-\tau_2)^{p_2} \hat{D}_{ab\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \\
&= \int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{-iaz_1} e^{-ibz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} \hat{D}_{ab\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2).
\end{aligned} \tag{2.55}$$

The seed integral $\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{ab\alpha\beta}^{p_1 p_2}$ can be expressed as the following 2×2 matrix:

$$\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\beta}^{p_1 p_2} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & S_1^{p_1 p_2} + S_2^{p_2 p_1} \\ -(S_1^{p_2 p_1} + S_2^{p_1 p_2}) & 0 \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\beta}, \tag{2.56a}$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\ominus}^{p_1 p_2}{}_{\alpha\beta} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & S_3^{p_1 p_2} + S_4^{p_2 p_1} \\ -(S_3^{p_2 p_1} + S_4^{p_1 p_2}) & 0 \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\beta}, \quad (2.56b)$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\oplus\oplus}^{p_1 p_2}{}_{\alpha\beta} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & W_1^{p_1 p_2} \\ -W_2^{p_1 p_2} & 0 \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\beta}, \quad \hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\oplus}^{p_1 p_2}{}_{\alpha\beta} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & W_2^{p_2 p_1} \\ -W_1^{p_2 p_1} & 0 \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\beta}. \quad (2.56c)$$

In the above seed integrals, we define $S_i^{p_1 p_2}$ ($i = 1, 2, 3, 4$) as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} S_1^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_+(z_1) v_+^\dagger(z_2) \theta(z_2 - z_1) \\ &= \tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} I^{p_1 p_2} (1 + i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, 1 + i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, 1 + i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}), \end{aligned} \quad (2.57a)$$

$$\begin{aligned} S_2^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_-(z_1) v_-^\dagger(z_2) \theta(z_2 - z_1) \\ &= \tilde{M}_R e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} I^{p_1 p_2} (-i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, -i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, -i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}), \end{aligned} \quad (2.57b)$$

$$\begin{aligned} S_3^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_+(z_1) v_+^\dagger(z_2) \theta(z_1 - z_2) \\ &= \tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} J^{p_2 p_1} (-i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, -i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, -i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}), \end{aligned} \quad (2.57c)$$

$$\begin{aligned} S_4^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_-(z_1) v_-^\dagger(z_2) \theta(z_1 - z_2) \\ &= \tilde{M}_R e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} J^{p_2 p_1} (1 + i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, 1 + i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, 1 + i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}), \end{aligned} \quad (2.57d)$$

where the function $I^{p_1 p_2}(x, y, z)$ is defined in Eq.(2.52), and the function $J^{p_1 p_2}(x, y, z)$ takes the following form:

$$\begin{aligned} J^{p_1 p_2}(x, y, z) &= i 2^{-2-p_1-p_2} e^{\frac{i\pi}{2}(p_1+p_2)} \pi \operatorname{csch}(2\pi\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(2+p_1+p_2) \\ &\times \left[\frac{e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}}}{\Gamma(x)} \Gamma(1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(2+p_1+p_2-i2\tilde{\nu}) \right. \\ &\times {}_4\tilde{F}_3 \left(\begin{matrix} 2+p_1+p_2, 1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}, y, 2+p_1+p_2-i2\tilde{\nu} \\ 2+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}, 3+p_1+p_2-z, 1-i2\tilde{\nu} \end{matrix} \middle| -1 \right) - (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \Big]. \end{aligned} \quad (2.58)$$

In Eq.(2.56), the matrix elements $W_i^{p_1 p_2}$ ($i = 1, 2$) are defined as follows:

$$W_1^{p_1 p_2} = \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_+(z_1) v_+^\dagger(z_2) = \tilde{M}_R e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} K^{p_1 p_2} (2 + i\tilde{\lambda}, 1 - i\tilde{\lambda}), \quad (2.59a)$$

$$W_2^{p_1 p_2} = \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_-(z_1) v_-^\dagger(z_2) = \tilde{M}_R e^{-\pi\tilde{\lambda}} K^{p_1 p_2} (1 - i\tilde{\lambda}, 2 + i\tilde{\lambda}), \quad (2.59b)$$

where the function $K^{p_1 p_2}(x, y)$ is defined in Eq.(2.54).

2.4.3 Seed Integrals for $\check{D}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2)$

Similarly, we consider the propagator $\check{D}_{ab\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)$ and define its associated seed integrals $\check{\mathcal{I}}_{ab}^{p_1 p_2}{}_{\alpha\beta}$ as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \check{\mathcal{I}}_{ab}^{p_1 p_2}{}_{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}} &= k_1^{1+p_1} k_2^{1+p_2} \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 e^{iak\tau_1} e^{ibk\tau_2} (-\tau_1)^{p_1} (-\tau_2)^{p_2} \check{D}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \\ &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{-iaz_1} e^{-ibz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} \check{D}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2). \end{aligned} \quad (2.60)$$

The seed integrals $\check{\mathcal{I}}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2}$ are related to the hatted counterparts $\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2}$ through the relation,

$$\check{\mathcal{I}}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} = - \left(\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{-a-b\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1^* p_2^*} \right)^*. \quad (2.61)$$

To verify this identity explicitly, we consider the choice $\text{od } (a, b) = (\ominus, \oplus)$, which means $\check{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\oplus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2} = - \left(\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\oplus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1^* p_2^*} \right)^*$. Starting from the right side, we use the definition of $\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2}$ in Eq.(2.55) and deduce the following:

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\oplus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1^* p_2^*} \right)^* &= \left[\int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{iz_2} z_1^{p_1^*} z_2^{p_2^*} \hat{D}_{\oplus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2) \right]^* \\ &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} \left[\hat{D}_{\oplus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2) \right]^* \\ &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} \left[-\check{D}_{\ominus\oplus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, z_1, z_2) \right] = -\check{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\oplus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{p_1 p_2}. \end{aligned} \quad (2.62)$$

We can also verify the identity (2.61) for other choices of (a, b) similarly.

2.4.4 Rotation of Spinor Seed Integrals

In the above subsections, we have computed all these seed integrals by choosing the spatial momentum to be along the direction of z -axis ($\mathbf{k} = k\hat{z}$). Since the seed integrals are spinor-tensors, we can derive them for a general momentum direction by a proper $SU(2)$ rotation.

Consider the spatial momentum in a general direction,

$$\hat{\mathbf{k}} = (\sin \theta \cos \varphi, \sin \theta \sin \varphi, \cos \theta). \quad (2.63)$$

The helicity spinor $h_\alpha(\hat{\mathbf{k}})$ is in the $(\frac{1}{2}, 0)$ representation of the Lorentz group. The corresponding rotation matrix for helicity spinor $h_\alpha(\mathbf{k})$ from the $h_\alpha(\hat{z})$ is given by

$$U(\theta, \varphi) = e^{-\frac{i}{2}\varphi\sigma^3} e^{-\frac{i}{2}\theta\sigma^2} = \begin{pmatrix} e^{-\frac{i}{2}\varphi} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} & -e^{-\frac{i}{2}\varphi} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} \\ e^{\frac{i}{2}\varphi} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} & e^{\frac{i}{2}\varphi} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \end{pmatrix}, \quad (2.64)$$

which is a unitary matrix obeying $U^\dagger(\theta, \varphi) = U^{-1}(\theta, \varphi)$. Similarly, we can derive the rotation matrix for spinor $h_\alpha^\dagger(\hat{\mathbf{k}})$, which belongs to the $(0, \frac{1}{2})$ representation of the Lorentz group. For a spinor tensor as direct product of two spinors (such as $M_{\alpha\beta}$), we apply the rotation $U(\theta, \varphi)$ to each of the spinor-tensor index. We summarize in Table 1 the rotation rules for six types of the spinor-tensors considered in the present analysis.

Consider a special case $\varphi=0$, where $\mathbf{k}$ lies in the x - z plane and has an angle θ relative to the z -axis, namely, $\hat{\mathbf{k}} = (\sin \theta, 0, \cos \theta)$. Thus, the rotation matrix reduces to

$$U(\theta, 0) = e^{-\frac{i}{2}\theta\sigma^2} = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} & -\sin \frac{\theta}{2} \\ \sin \frac{\theta}{2} & \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \end{pmatrix}. \quad (2.65)$$

Since $U(\theta, 0)$ is real, we have $U^*(\theta, 0) = U(\theta, 0)$ and $U^\dagger(\theta, 0) = U^T(\theta, 0) = U^{-1}(\theta, 0)$. Thus, the rotation for all types of spinor-tensors in Table 1 can be written in a single matrix form,

$$M(\mathbf{k}) = U(\theta, 0) M^{(z)} U(\theta, 0)^T. \quad (2.66)$$

Tensor Type	General Rotation Rule	Matrix Form
$M_{\alpha\beta}$	$M_{\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}) = U_\alpha^\gamma U_\beta^\delta M_{\gamma\delta}^{(z)}(k)$	$M(\mathbf{k}) = U M^{(z)} U^T$
$M_{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}$	$M_{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}) = U_{\dot{\alpha}}^{*\dot{\gamma}} U_{\dot{\beta}}^{*\dot{\delta}} M_{\dot{\gamma}\dot{\delta}}^{(z)}(k)$	$M(\mathbf{k}) = U^* M^{(z)} U^\dagger$
$M_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}$	$M_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}) = U_\alpha^\gamma U_{\dot{\beta}}^{*\dot{\delta}} M_{\gamma\dot{\delta}}^{(z)}(k)$	$M(\mathbf{k}) = U M^{(z)} U^\dagger$
$M_\alpha{}^\beta$	$M_\alpha{}^\beta(\mathbf{k}) = U_\alpha^\gamma M_\gamma^{(z)\delta}(k) (U^{-1})_\delta{}^\beta$	$M(\mathbf{k}) = U M^{(z)} U^{-1} = U M^{(z)} U^\dagger$
$M^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}$	$M^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}) = ((U^\dagger)^{-1})^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}} M^{(z)\dot{\gamma}}{}_{\dot{\delta}}(k) U_{\dot{\beta}}^{*\dot{\delta}}$	$M(\mathbf{k}) = (U^\dagger)^{-1} M^{(z)} U^\dagger = U M^{(z)} U^\dagger$
$M^{\dot{\alpha}\beta}$	$M^{\dot{\alpha}\beta}(\mathbf{k}) = ((U^\dagger)^{-1})^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}} M^{(z)\dot{\gamma}\delta}(k) (U^{-1})_\delta{}^\beta$	$M(\mathbf{k}) = (U^\dagger)^{-1} M^{(z)} U^{-1} = U M^{(z)} U^\dagger$

Table 1: Rotation rules for six types of the spinor tensors. The symbol $M^{(z)}$ denotes the relevant result evaluated for the spatial momentum in the direction of z -axis.

3 Cosmological Signatures of Right-Handed Neutrino during Inflation

After presenting the spinor coefficients, the Majorana fermion propagators, and the seed integrals within the Schwinger-Keldysh formalism in Section 2, we then turn to the loop-induced primordial signatures generated by the right-handed neutrino. The derivative interaction in Eq.(2.2) not only induces an effective chemical potential through the slow-roll inflaton background, but also couples the inflaton fluctuation $\delta\phi$ directly to the right-handed neutrinos. In consequence, the heavy-neutrino loop leaves imprints on the inflaton bispectrum $\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'$ and can generate the non-analytic cosmological collider signals, as shown in Fig. 1.

The rest of this section is organized as follows. In Section 3.1, we present the inflaton three-point correlator generated by the right-handed-neutrino triangle loop and classify the eight distinct contractions. In Section 3.2, we factorize the loop diagram into three sub-diagrams containing the left part, the right part, and the middle part (bubble) in the nonlocal sector, which will be computed separately. In Section 3.3, we derive the final bispectrum, identify the dominant contributions, and analyze their angular dependence.

3.1 Three-Point Inflaton Correlator from Right-Handed Neutrino Loop

We discussed in Section 2.2 how the inflaton background ϕ_0 modifies the dynamics of the right-handed neutrino through the dimension-5 operator in Eq.(2.2). In addition, the inflaton fluctuation $\delta\phi$ also couples to the right-handed neutrino through the same dimension-5 operator,

$$\Delta\mathcal{L} = \sqrt{-g} \frac{-1}{a(\tau)\Lambda} \partial_\mu \delta\phi N^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu N = \frac{-1}{\Lambda} \partial_\mu \delta\phi \tilde{N}^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu \tilde{N}, \quad (3.1)$$

where $\tilde{N} = a^{3/2} N$. Through this interaction, the quantum fluctuation $\delta\phi$ receives a backreaction from the right-handed neutrino N . This effect is ultimately encoded in the primordial

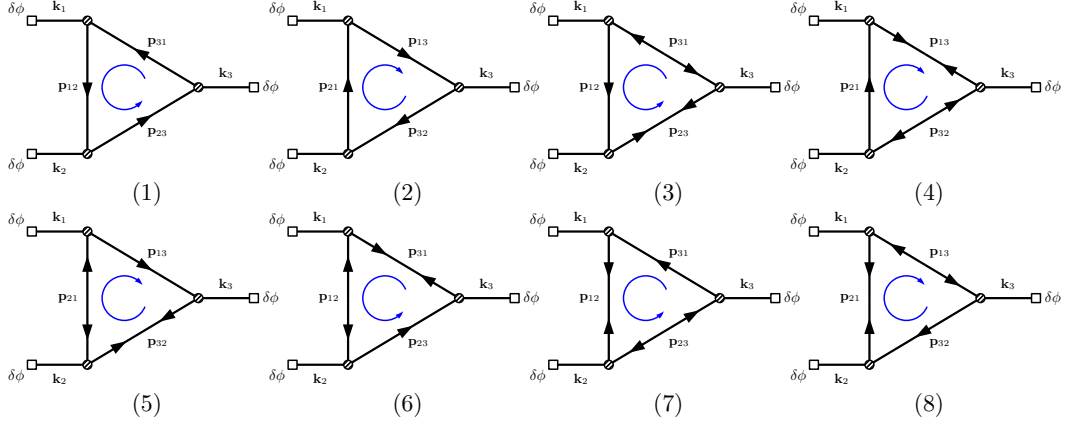


Figure 2: Relevant diagrams arising from the right-handed neutrino loop. In this figure, each propagator of the right-handed neutrino, such as $\langle \tilde{N} \tilde{N}^\dagger \rangle$ and $\langle \tilde{N} \tilde{N} \rangle$, is represented by a solid line with a single arrow or two reverse arrows. The line connecting a dot and a square without an arrow denotes a bulk-to-boundary propagator of the inflaton $\langle \delta\phi^2 \rangle$. The square at one end marks the boundary point ($\tau_f \rightarrow 0^-$). The shaded dot at the vertex indicates the two cases of time ordering in this vertex, including the time-ordered case “ $\oplus$ ” and reverse-time-ordered case “ $\ominus$ ”.

non-Gaussianity through the three-point correlator of $\delta\phi$ generated by the right-handed-neutrino triangle loop. The right-handed neutrino has a nonzero Majorana mass $m \gtrsim H$ and a large chemical potential $\lambda \sim 60H$. This loop contribution can generate a cosmological collider signal in the three-point correlator of $\delta\phi$,

$$\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle' \sim A \left(\frac{k_1}{k_3} \right)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + \text{H.c.}, \quad (3.2)$$

where we have defined $\tilde{M}_R = M_R/H$, $\tilde{\lambda} = \lambda/H$, and $\tilde{\nu} = \sqrt{\tilde{M}_R^2 + \tilde{\lambda}^2}$.

In the SK formalism, the three-point correlator generated by the right-handed-neutrino loop can be represented diagrammatically. Using the identity of the sigma matrices, $\bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} = \epsilon^{\alpha\beta} \epsilon^{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}} \sigma^\mu_{\beta\dot{\beta}}$, the inflaton-right-handed-neutrino interaction term can be expressed as follows:

$$-\frac{1}{\Lambda} \partial_\mu \delta\phi \tilde{N}^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu \tilde{N} = \frac{1}{\Lambda} \partial_\mu \delta\phi \tilde{N} \sigma^\mu \tilde{N}^\dagger. \quad (3.3)$$

As a result, there are eight distinct contractions of the neutrino fields in the triangle loop. This means that for a fixed momentum configuration $(\mathbf{k}_1, \mathbf{k}_2, \mathbf{k}_3)$, the three-point correlator receives contributions from eight diagrams, as shown in Fig. 2.

In the above diagrams, the external lines terminating at squares represent the inflaton propagator $\langle \delta\phi^2 \rangle$, whereas the internal arrow-lines represent the neutrino propagators. The square at one end denotes the boundary point ($\tau_f \rightarrow 0^-$). The shaded dot at each vertex indicates the two possible time-ordering prescriptions at that vertex: the time-ordered case “ $\oplus$ ” and the reverse-time-ordered case “ $\ominus$ ”. Using the SK path-integral formalism, the three-point correlator of the inflaton, $\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'$, obtained by summing over

the eight diagrams, can be derived as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle' &= \sum_{j=1}^8 \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(j)} \\ &= \sum_{a,b,c=\pm} abc \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^3 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 d\tau_3 \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \sum_{j=1}^8 \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(j), \end{aligned} \quad (3.4)$$

where $\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(j)}$ denotes the contribution from the diagram (j) in the Fig. 2, $a, b, c = \pm$ are the SK labels, and the factor $(-i/\Lambda)^3$ arises from the three interaction vertices. The vector function $\mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}, \tau)$ comes from the external leg of the inflaton field $\delta\phi(\mathbf{k})$ and is given by

$$\mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}, \tau) = \left(\partial_\tau G_a(k; \tau) \right) = \frac{H^2}{2k^3} \begin{pmatrix} k^2 \tau \\ i\mathbf{k} G_a(k; \tau) \end{pmatrix} e^{+iak\tau}, \quad (3.5)$$

where $G_a(k; \tau)$ denotes the boundary-to-bulk propagator of the inflaton field treated as an approximately massless scalar field, shown in the Eq.(D.14) in the Appendix D

$$G_a(k; \tau) = \frac{H^2}{2k^3} (1 - iak\tau) e^{iak\tau}. \quad (3.6)$$

In Eq.(3.4), the functions $\mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(j)$ (with $j = 1, 2, \dots, 8$) represent the neutrino triangle loop associated with the i -th diagram in Fig. 2 and take the following forms,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(1) &= -\bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \bar{\sigma}^{\nu\dot{\beta}\beta} D_{bc\beta\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} D_{ca\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1), \\ \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(2) &= -\bar{\sigma}^{\nu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} D_{ba\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{21}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\beta}\beta} D_{ac\beta\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{p}_{13}, \tau_1, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} D_{cb\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}_{32}, \tau_3, \tau_2), \\ \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(3) &= \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \bar{\sigma}^{\nu\dot{\beta}\beta} \hat{D}_{bc\beta}^{\gamma}(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3) \sigma^{\lambda}_{\gamma\dot{\gamma}} \check{D}_{ca}^{\dot{\gamma}}_{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1), \\ \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(4) &= \bar{\sigma}^{\nu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} D_{ba\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{21}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\beta}\beta} \hat{D}_{ac\beta}^{\gamma}(\mathbf{p}_{13}, \tau_1, \tau_3) \sigma^{\lambda}_{\gamma\dot{\gamma}} \check{D}_{cb}^{\dot{\gamma}}_{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}_{32}, \tau_3, \tau_2), \\ \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(5) &= \sigma^{\nu}_{\alpha\dot{\alpha}} \check{D}_{ba}^{\dot{\alpha}}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{21}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\beta}\beta} D_{ac\beta\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{p}_{13}, \tau_1, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} \hat{D}_{cb\gamma}^{\alpha}(\mathbf{p}_{32}, \tau_3, \tau_2), \\ \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(6) &= \sigma^{\mu}_{\alpha\dot{\alpha}} \check{D}_{ab}^{\dot{\alpha}}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \bar{\sigma}^{\nu\dot{\beta}\beta} D_{bc\beta\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} \hat{D}_{ca\gamma}^{\alpha}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1), \\ \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7) &= \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \hat{D}_{ab\alpha}^{\beta}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \sigma^{\nu}_{\beta\dot{\beta}} \check{D}_{bc}^{\dot{\beta}}_{\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} D_{ca\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1), \\ \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(8) &= \bar{\sigma}^{\nu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \hat{D}_{ba\alpha}^{\beta}(\mathbf{p}_{21}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \sigma^{\mu}_{\beta\dot{\beta}} \check{D}_{ac}^{\dot{\beta}}_{\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{p}_{13}, \tau_1, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} D_{cb\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}_{32}, \tau_3, \tau_2), \end{aligned} \quad (3.7)$$

where $\mathbf{p}_{12} = -\mathbf{p}_{21} = \mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_1$, $\mathbf{p}_{23} = -\mathbf{p}_{32} = \mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s$, $\mathbf{p}_{31} = -\mathbf{p}_{13} = \mathbf{q}$, and $\mathbf{q}$ is the loop momentum. The propagators with upper indices including $\hat{D}_{ab\alpha}^{\beta}$ and $\check{D}_{ab}^{\dot{\beta}}_{\dot{\alpha}}$ are defined as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{D}_{ab\alpha}^{\beta}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) &\equiv \epsilon^{\beta\gamma} \hat{D}_{ab\alpha\gamma}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) = -\hat{D}_{ab\alpha\gamma}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \epsilon^{\gamma\beta}, \\ \check{D}_{ab}^{\dot{\beta}}_{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) &\equiv \epsilon^{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\gamma}} \check{D}_{ab\dot{\gamma}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) = -\epsilon^{\dot{\gamma}\dot{\alpha}} \check{D}_{ab\dot{\gamma}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2). \end{aligned} \quad (3.8)$$

We note that in the literature [45, 46, 49] only the first two of the eight diagrams in Fig. 2 were considered. In these works [45, 46, 49], the hard internal line $|\mathbf{p}_{12}|$ was estimated using the saddle-point approximation, and the loop momentum was effectively fixed around a characteristic value. The saddle-point approximation may capture the leading exponential dependence, but could miss important fluctuation prefactors around the saddle [as will be shown in Fig. 4a]. In this work, we include all eight diagrams shown in Fig. 2 and perform a complete analysis of these diagrams.

3.2 Calculation of Three-Point Inflaton Correlator

In this subsection, we calculate the three-point correlator associated with the triangle loop shown in Fig. 2. We will extract the cosmological collider signal from the three-point correlator in the squeezed limit $k_3 \ll k_1, k_2$.

We consider a specific momentum configuration in which $\mathbf{k}_1$, $\mathbf{k}_2$, and $\mathbf{k}_3$ are nearly collinear along the z -axis:

$$\mathbf{k}_1 \simeq -\mathbf{k}_2, \quad \mathbf{k}_1 = (0, 0, k_1), \quad \mathbf{k}_3 = (0, 0, k_3). \quad (3.9)$$

Then, we can consider the case with the angle θ between $\mathbf{k}_1$ and $\mathbf{k}_3$ being arbitrary and the $\mathbf{k}_3$ being along the z -axis. In this case, we have

$$\mathbf{k}_1 \simeq -\mathbf{k}_2, \quad \mathbf{k}_1 = k_1(\sin \theta, 0, \cos \theta), \quad \mathbf{k}_3 = (0, 0, k_3). \quad (3.10)$$

As discussed in Section D.2, the cosmological collider signal contains both local and nonlocal contributions, where these two contributions have different physical origins and can be distinguished more clearly in the four-point correlator. Although their physical origins are different, both the local and nonlocal signals exhibit the same scaling behavior $\left(\frac{k_1}{k_3}\right)^{i\bar{\nu}}$ in the three-point correlator. For the present analysis, we will focus on the nonlocal contribution and extract the nonlocal part of the fermion propagator.

In this subsection, we take the diagram-(7) in Fig. 2 as a sample for illustration and present a complete calculation for it. The same procedure can be applied to the other seven diagrams in Fig. 2. For simplicity, we set the Hubble parameter during inflation, H , to unity ($H=1$) in this subsection.

3.2.1 Factorization of Fermion Loop Diagrams

To extract nonlocal cosmological collider signals from the fermion loop, it is useful to isolate the kinematic region in which two internal lines simultaneously become soft. In analogy with cosmological collider signals from scalar loop, one expects that the non-analytic part of the diagram should arise precisely from this soft region and admit a factorized description in terms of left, right, and bubble subdiagrams.

For scalar loops, this factorization can be implemented directly. It has been shown that the non-analytic behavior of a loop diagram originates from the kinematic region in which two specific internal momenta simultaneously become soft [42]. In this limit, the corresponding internal lines can be effectively cut, and the diagram factorizes into three parts: a left tree-level subdiagram $\mathcal{T}^{(L)}$, a right tree-level subdiagram $\mathcal{T}^{(R)}$, and a bubble loop subdiagram $\mathcal{B}$ in the middle. Accordingly, the nonlocal cosmological collider signal generated by a scalar loop takes the following schematic form [42]:

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi^n(\mathbf{k}_i) \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})} \sim \mathcal{T}^{(L)}(\{\mathbf{k}^{(L)}\}) \times \mathcal{B}(k_s) \times \mathcal{T}^{(R)}(\{\mathbf{k}^{(R)}\}). \quad (3.11)$$

Following the same logic, for the fermionic triangle diagrams in Fig. 2, the internal momenta $\mathbf{p}_{31}$ and $\mathbf{p}_{23}$ can be taken to the soft limit, $\mathbf{p}_{31}, \mathbf{p}_{23} \rightarrow O(k_s)$, which corresponds to the late-time limit described in Eq.(2.25). For the nonlocal contribution, we expect the three-point correlator in the squeezed-limit to have the following factorized form:⁴

⁴The factorization can be derived by taking the folded limit as shown in Appendix C.3.

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})} \simeq \sum_{d=\pm} \mathcal{T}_{(d)}^{(\text{L})}(\mathbf{k}_1, \mathbf{k}_2) \mathcal{B}_{(d)}(\mathbf{k}_s) \mathcal{T}_{(d)}^{(\text{R})}(\mathbf{k}_3), \quad (3.12)$$

where $\mathbf{k}_s = \mathbf{k}_1 + \mathbf{k}_2 = -\mathbf{k}_3$ for the three-point correlator.

On the other hand, for a fermion loop, the factorization is more subtle than in the scalar case. The reason is that the nonlocal parts of the propagators $D_{\ominus\oplus}$ and $D_{\oplus\ominus}$ are no longer identical, owing to the helicity-dependent spinor structure carried by the fermion propagators. As a result, the theta-function dependence in the time-ordered propagators $D_{\oplus\oplus}$ and $D_{\ominus\ominus}$ cannot be eliminated in the same way as for scalar loops, hence a direct application of the scalar cutting rule is not available.

To isolate a factorized nonlocal sector, we decompose the non-time-ordered propagators into their symmetric (S) and antisymmetric (A) parts:

$$\begin{aligned} D^{(\text{S})}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \frac{D_{\ominus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) + D_{\oplus\ominus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)}{2}, \\ D^{(\text{A})}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \frac{D_{\ominus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) - D_{\oplus\ominus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)}{2}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.13)$$

Then, the time-ordered propagators can be rewritten as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= D^{(\text{S})}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) + D^{(\text{A})}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) (\theta_{12} - \theta_{21}), \\ D_{\ominus\ominus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= D^{(\text{S})}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) + D^{(\text{A})}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) (\theta_{21} - \theta_{12}), \end{aligned} \quad (3.14)$$

where $\theta_{ij} = \theta(\tau_i - \tau_j)$.

The symmetric part does not contain theta functions and thus can be factorized directly, whereas the antisymmetric part still depends on theta functions and cannot be easily factorized. In this analysis, we extract the loop contribution in which the soft internal propagator is taken to be its symmetric (non-time-ordered) part. A systematic treatment of the antisymmetric part is technically challenging, so we will use the symmetric part for estimate and tackle the problem of the antisymmetric part in future work. This differs from the scalar case as discussed in Appendix D.1. For the scalar propagators, the nonlocal parts of $D_{\oplus\oplus}$ and $D_{\ominus\ominus}$ are equal,

$$\begin{aligned} [D_{\oplus\ominus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{NLoc})} &= [D_{\ominus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{NLoc})} = [\sigma_{\mathbf{k}}(\tau_1) \sigma_{\mathbf{k}}^*(\tau_2)]_{(\text{NLoc})} \\ &= \frac{H^2(\tau_1 \tau_2)^{3/2}}{4\pi} \left[[\Gamma(-i\tilde{\nu})]^2 \left(\frac{k^2 \tau_1 \tau_2}{4} \right)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + [\Gamma(i\tilde{\nu})]^2 \left(\frac{k^2 \tau_1 \tau_2}{4} \right)^{-i\tilde{\nu}} \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (3.15)$$

Hence the nonlocal part of the antisymmetric combination vanishes automatically for scalar propagators. But for the fermion case, the presence of two sets of spinor coefficients together with the spinor-helicity structure makes $[D^{(\text{A})}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{NLoc})}$ nonzero. This directly obstructs the factorization.

In Section 2.3, we introduced three types of propagators for the two-component fermion field. Their symmetric nonlocal parts in the late-time limit take the following form:

$$\left[D^{(\text{S})}_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} = \frac{\sum_s \left[u_s(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}}{2} \sigma_{0, \alpha\dot{\beta}}$$

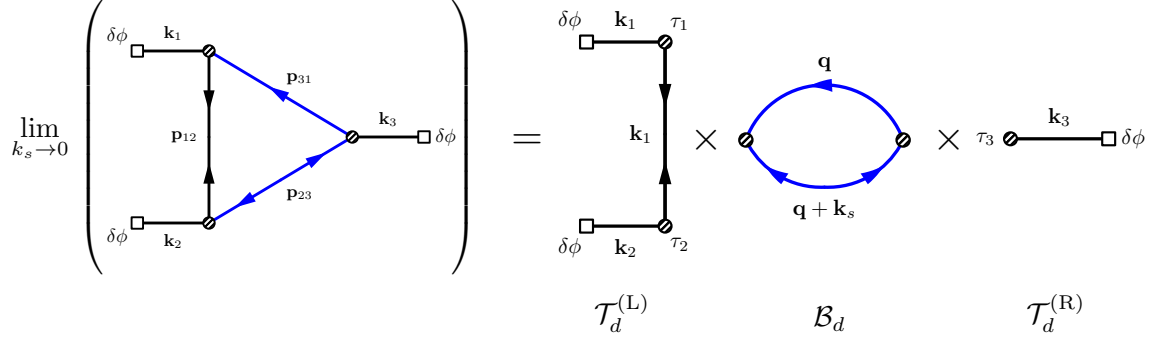


Figure 3: After applying the factorization method, the diagram-(7) in Fig. 2 can be decomposed into a left subdiagram, a bubble loop, and a right subdiagram.

$$= \left[\frac{\tilde{M}_R^2 \sinh(\pi \tilde{\lambda}) [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} (4k^2 \tau_1 \tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \right] \sigma_{0,\alpha\dot{\beta}}, \quad (3.16a)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\hat{D}^{(S)}_{\alpha}{}^{\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} &= \frac{\sum_s \left[u_s(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) v_s^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}}{2} \delta_{\alpha}{}^{\beta} \\ &= \left[\frac{\tilde{M}_R \cosh(\pi \tilde{\lambda}) [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} (4k^2 \tau_1 \tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \right] \delta_{\alpha}{}^{\beta}, \end{aligned} \quad (3.16b)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\check{D}^{(S)\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} &= \frac{\sum_s \left[v_s(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}}{2} \delta^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}} \\ &= \left[\frac{\tilde{M}_R \cosh(\pi \tilde{\lambda}) [\Gamma(-i2\tilde{\nu})]^2}{\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} (4k^2 \tau_1 \tau_2)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \right] \delta^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.16c)$$

In the above, one spinor index in the second and third propagators on the left side of each equality sign has been raised using Eq.(3.8), and the explicit expressions for $\left[u_s(\tau_1, \mathbf{k}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{k}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}$ are given in Eq.(2.28). An important simplification is that the symmetric nonlocal parts of all three types of propagators are proportional to the identity matrix in spinor space, namely, $\sigma_{0,\alpha\dot{\beta}}$, $\delta_{\alpha}{}^{\beta}$, or $\delta^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}$, and thus they do not depend on the direction of the helicity spinor.

For the symmetric part, the nested time-integrals over τ_1 and τ_2 become factorized, $\iint d\tau_1 d\tau_2 \rightarrow \int d\tau_1 \int d\tau_2$, because the soft propagators are reduced to products of functions of τ_1 and τ_2 without theta-function dependence. In this sense, the two soft internal lines can be effectively cut even for the fermion loop. The cutting rule and its applicability in the present context are explained in Appendix C.3. We note that for the non-time-ordered soft internal propagator $D_{\ominus\oplus}$ or $D_{\oplus\ominus}$, it can be factorized directly and thus we keep their original form without decomposition into the symmetric and antisymmetric parts.

With the above prescription, the factorization of the fermion loop can be implemented diagram by diagram. As an example, we illustrate in Fig. 3 the decomposition of diagram-(7) in Fig. 2. In this decomposition, all time integrals are assigned to the left and right parts. The left subdiagram $\mathcal{T}_d^{(L)}$ is a two-point object containing the time integral $\iint d\tau_1 d\tau_2$

together with the time-dependent factors $(-\tau_1)^{id\tilde{\nu}}$ and $(-\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}$ inherited from the two soft lines. The right subdiagram $\mathcal{T}_{(d)}^{(R)}$ contains only the time integral $\int d\tau_3$ and the corresponding factor $(-\tau_3)^{i2d\tilde{\nu}}$. In contrast, the bubble factor $\mathcal{B}_{(d)}$ contains only the loop integral over $d\mathbf{q}$, together with the residual Gamma-function coefficients in the two soft propagators. All non-analytic dependence arises from evaluating this bubble factor in the soft limit $\mathbf{p}_{31}, \mathbf{p}_{23} \rightarrow O(k_s)$.

We specify the SK ordering of the three vertices explicitly and denote the three parts by $\mathcal{T}_{(d),ab}^{(L)}$, $\mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}$, and $\mathcal{T}_{(d),c}^{(R)}$, respectively. Thus, we express the nonlocal contribution to the squeezed-limit three-point correlator as follows:

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})} \simeq \sum_{\substack{a,b,c=\pm \\ d=\pm}} abc \mathcal{T}_{(d),ab}^{(L)}(\mathbf{k}_1, \mathbf{k}_2) \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}(\mathbf{k}_s) \mathcal{T}_{(d),c}^{(R)}(\mathbf{k}_3). \quad (3.17)$$

For the diagram-(7), the left subdiagram is a two-point correlator containing two external inflaton legs, $\mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1)$ and $\mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2)$, together with one hard internal fermion propagator $\hat{D}_{ab}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2)$, which takes the following form:

$$\mathcal{T}_{(d),ab}^{(L)} = \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^2 \int d\tau_1 d\tau_2 \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^\mu \hat{D}_{ab}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \sigma^\nu \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) (-\tau_1)^{id\tilde{\nu}} (-\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (3.18)$$

where the factors $(-\tau_1)^{id\tilde{\nu}} (-\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}$ arise from the late-time behavior of the two soft lines in Eq.(2.39b), and the momenta satisfy $\mathbf{k}_1 = -\mathbf{k}_2 = \mathbf{p}_{12}$. The right subdiagram contains no internal fermion propagator and it can be expressed as follows:

$$\mathcal{T}_{(d),c}^{(R)} = \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right) \int d\tau_3 \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^\lambda (-\tau_3)^{i2d\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (3.19)$$

where the factor $(-\tau_3)^{i2d\tilde{\nu}}$ also comes from the two soft lines.

We note that the bubble factor depends only on the loop momentum and the residual Gamma-function coefficients from the two soft propagators. Thus, we can express it in the following form:

$$\mathcal{B}_{(d),abc} = \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} (2q)^{i2d\tilde{\nu}} \left| 2(\mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s) \right|^{i2d\tilde{\nu}} \{\Gamma\}_{(d),abc}, \quad (3.20)$$

where $\{\Gamma\}_{(d),abc}$ denotes the remaining Gamma-function factors associated with the two soft lines.

In the following subsections, we explicitly compute the diagram-(7) as a representative example. The analysis of the remaining diagrams of Fig. 2 can be carried in the same fashion.

3.2.2 Left Part of the Diagram

We begin with the left subdiagram of diagram-(7) as shown in Fig. 3. This two-point subdiagram contributes to $\mathcal{T}_{(d),ab}^{(L)}$ and consists of two massless external inflaton lines, $\mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1)$ and $\mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2)$, together with one massive internal fermion propagator $\hat{D}_{ab}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2)$. It carries two spinor indices and takes the following form:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{T}_{(d),ab}^{(L,7)} \dot{\alpha} \dot{\beta}(\mathbf{k}_1) &= \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^2 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 (-\tau_1)^{id\tilde{\nu}} (-\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}} \\ &\quad \times \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \hat{D}_{ab\alpha}{}^{\beta}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^\nu \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2), \end{aligned} \quad (3.21)$$

where the factor $(-\tau_1)^{id\tilde{\nu}}(-\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}}$ with $d = \pm$ comes from the time dependence of the soft lines in the bubble subdiagram $\mathcal{B}_{(d)}$, and the momentum satisfies $\mathbf{k}_1 = -\mathbf{k}_2 = \mathbf{p}_{12}$. For simplicity, we choose $\mathbf{k}_1$ to be along the direction of z -axis, $\mathbf{k}_1 = (0, 0, k_1)$. The result for a general orientation of $\mathbf{k}_1$ can be obtained by the rotation rule derived in Section 2.4.4.

In Refs. [45, 46], the hard internal propagator $\hat{D}_{ab}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2)$ was evaluated using a saddle-point approximation around, $|2k_1\tau_1| = |2k_1\tau_2| \simeq \tilde{M}_R$, in the regime $\tilde{\lambda} \gg \tilde{M}_R$. In contrast, we introduced in Section 2.4 a set of seed integrals that allows one to evaluate the left subdiagram directly. To express Eq.(3.21) in terms of the seed integrals $\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{ab}^{p_1 p_2}_{\alpha\beta}$, we substitute the external lines defined in Eq.(3.5) into Eq.(3.21), and contract the Lorentz indices between $\mathcal{F}_\mu$ and $\bar{\sigma}^\mu$ (or σ^ν). For instance, we can derive:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{F}_{\mu\oplus}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^\mu &= \mathcal{F}_{0\oplus}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^0 + \mathcal{F}_{3\oplus}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^3 \\ &= \frac{\tau_1 e^{ik_1\tau_1}}{2k_1} \bar{\sigma}^0 + \frac{ie^{ik_1\tau_1}(1 - ik_1\tau_1)}{2k_1^2} \bar{\sigma}^3. \end{aligned} \quad (3.22)$$

In this way, $\mathcal{F}_{\mu\oplus}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^\mu$ is rewritten as a sum of terms with definite power-law dependence on τ_1 . Matching the resulting expression to the definition of the seed integrals in Eq.(2.55), we decompose the left subdiagram into a linear combination of seed integrals with different powers of τ_1 and τ_2 .

As an illustration, we consider the case $a = b = \oplus$ and derive the following:

$$\begin{aligned} &\mathcal{T}_{(d),\oplus\oplus}^{(L,7)\ \dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_1) \\ &= \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 (-\tau_1)^{id\tilde{\nu}} (-\tau_2)^{id\tilde{\nu}} \mathcal{F}_{\mu\oplus}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \hat{D}_{\oplus\oplus\alpha}{}^\beta(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^\nu \mathcal{F}_{\nu\oplus}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \\ &= \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \frac{1}{4(k_1 k_2)^{3+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}}} \left[(\bar{\sigma}^0 + \bar{\sigma}^3)^{\dot{\alpha}\alpha} (\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\oplus\oplus}^{1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, 1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}})_\alpha{}^\beta (\sigma^0 - \sigma^3)_{\beta\dot{\beta}} - i \bar{\sigma}^{3\dot{\alpha}\alpha} (\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\oplus\oplus}^{i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, 1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}})_\alpha{}^\beta (\sigma^0 - \sigma^3)_{\beta\dot{\beta}} \right. \\ &\quad \left. + i(\bar{\sigma}^0 + \bar{\sigma}^3)^{\dot{\alpha}\alpha} (\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\oplus\oplus}^{1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}})_\alpha{}^\beta \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^3 + \bar{\sigma}^{3\dot{\alpha}\alpha} (\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\oplus\oplus}^{i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}})_\alpha{}^\beta \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^3 \right] \\ &= \sum_{\ell=1}^2 \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \frac{1}{4(k_1 k_2)^{3+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}}} \left[-S_\ell^{i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^1 \right. \\ &\quad \left. + \left(-S_\ell^{i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}} - i2S_\ell^{i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, 1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}} - i2S_\ell^{1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}} + 4S_\ell^{1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, 1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}} \right) \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^2 \right], \end{aligned} \quad (3.23)$$

where $\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{ab}^{p_1, p_2}_{\alpha}{}^\beta = -\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{ab}^{p_1, p_2}_{\alpha\gamma} \epsilon^{\gamma\beta}$. We also use the following matrix notation,

$$\delta_{\dot{\beta}}^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}_{\dot{\beta}}^{\dot{\alpha}}, \quad \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}_{\dot{\beta}}^{\dot{\alpha}}. \quad (3.24)$$

Substituting the seed integrals $S_1^{p_1, p_2}$ and $S_2^{p_1, p_2}$ (with $p_1, p_2 = i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}, 1+i\tilde{d}\tilde{\nu}$) into Eq.(3.23), we obtain the explicit result for the left subdiagram $\mathcal{T}_{(d),\oplus\oplus}^{(L,7)\ \dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_1)$.

The case $a = b = \ominus$ can be treated in the same manner. The corresponding subdiagram, $\mathcal{T}_{(d),\ominus\ominus}^{(L,7)\ \dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_1)$, can be expressed in terms of the seed integrals $S_3^{p_1, p_2}$ and $S_4^{p_1, p_2}$ as follows:

$$\mathcal{T}_{(d),\ominus\ominus}^{(L,7)\ \dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_1)$$

$$\begin{aligned}
&= \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 (-\tau_1)^{i d\bar{\nu}} (-\tau_2)^{i d\bar{\nu}} \mathcal{F}_{\mu\ominus}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \hat{D}_{\ominus\ominus\alpha}{}^\beta(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^\nu \mathcal{F}_{\nu\ominus}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \\
&= \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \frac{1}{4(k_1 k_2)^{3+i d\bar{\nu}}} \left[(\bar{\sigma}^0 - \bar{\sigma}^3)^{\dot{\alpha}\alpha} (\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\ominus}^{1-i d\bar{\nu}, 1-i d\bar{\nu}})_\alpha{}^\beta (\sigma^0 + \sigma^3)_{\beta\dot{\beta}} - i \bar{\sigma}^{3\dot{\alpha}\alpha} (\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\ominus}^{-i d\bar{\nu}, 1-i d\bar{\nu}})_\alpha{}^\beta (\sigma^0 + \sigma^3)_{\beta\dot{\beta}} \right. \\
&\quad \left. + i (\bar{\sigma}^0 - \bar{\sigma}^3) (\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\ominus}^{1-i d\bar{\nu}, -i d\bar{\nu}})_\alpha{}^\beta \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^3 + \bar{\sigma}^{3\dot{\alpha}\alpha} (\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\ominus}^{-i d\bar{\nu}, -i d\bar{\nu}})_\alpha{}^\beta \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^3 \right] \\
&= \sum_{\ell=3}^4 \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \frac{1}{4(k_1 k_2)^{3+i d\bar{\nu}}} \left[-S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} \delta_1^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^1 \right. \\
&\quad \left. + \left(-S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} - i 2 S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, 1+i d\bar{\nu}} - i 2 S_\ell^{1+i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} + 4 S_\ell^{1+i d\bar{\nu}, 1+i d\bar{\nu}} \right) \delta_2^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^2 \right]. \tag{3.25}
\end{aligned}$$

We next consider diagram-(8) in Fig. 2, which is related to diagram-(7) by reversing the fermion flow. Thus the same factorization can be applied. Its left subdiagram is given by

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{T}_{(d), ab\dot{\beta}}^{(L,8)\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_1) &= \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 (-\tau_1)^{i d\bar{\nu}} (-\tau_2)^{i d\bar{\nu}} \\
&\quad \times \mathcal{F}_{\mu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \hat{D}_{ba\alpha}{}^\beta(\mathbf{p}_{21}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^\nu \mathcal{F}_{\nu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1), \tag{3.26}
\end{aligned}$$

where $\mathbf{p}_{21} = -\mathbf{p}_{12} = -\mathbf{k}_1$. Because the fermion flow of diagram-(8) is reversed relative to diagram-(7), its internal momentum is given by $\mathbf{p}_{21} = -\mathbf{k}_1 = (0, 0, -k_1)$, and its time-integral variables are interchanged ($\tau_1 \leftrightarrow \tau_2$). In Eq.(3.26), the propagator $\hat{D}_{ba\alpha}{}^\beta(-\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_2, \tau_1)$ can be obtained from the corresponding propagator $\hat{D}_{ba\gamma}{}^\delta(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_2, \tau_1)$ through a rotation with $\theta = \varphi = \pi$ as follows:

$$\hat{D}_{ba\alpha}{}^\beta(-\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_2, \tau_1) = U(\pi, \pi)_\alpha{}^\gamma \hat{D}_{ba\gamma}{}^\delta(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_2, \tau_1) U(\pi, \pi)^\dagger{}_\delta{}^\beta. \tag{3.27}$$

Accordingly, the nested-integral cases $\mathcal{T}_{(d), \oplus\oplus}^{(L,8)}$ and $\mathcal{T}_{(d), \ominus\ominus}^{(L,8)}$ are obtained from the results of diagram-(7) by exchanging τ_1 and τ_2 and performing a rotation $U(\pi, \pi)$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{T}_{(d), \oplus\oplus}^{(L,8)\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_1) &= U(\pi, \pi)^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}} \mathcal{T}_{(d), \oplus\oplus}^{(L,7)\dot{\gamma}} \Big|_{\tau_1 \leftrightarrow \tau_2} (\mathbf{k}_1) U(\pi, \pi)^\dagger{}_{\dot{\delta}}{}^{\dot{\beta}} \\
&= \sum_{\ell=1}^2 \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \frac{1}{4(k_1 k_2)^{3+i d\bar{\nu}}} \left[-S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} \delta_2^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^2 \right. \\
&\quad \left. + \left(-S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} - i 2 S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, 1+i d\bar{\nu}} - i 2 S_\ell^{1+i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} + 4 S_\ell^{1+i d\bar{\nu}, 1+i d\bar{\nu}} \right) \delta_1^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^1 \right], \tag{3.28a}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{T}_{(d), \ominus\ominus}^{(L,8)\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_1) &= U(\pi, \pi)^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}} \mathcal{T}_{(d), \ominus\ominus}^{(L,7)\dot{\gamma}} \Big|_{\tau_1 \leftrightarrow \tau_2} (\mathbf{k}_1) U(\pi, \pi)^\dagger{}_{\dot{\delta}}{}^{\dot{\beta}} \\
&= \sum_{\ell=3}^4 \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right)^2 \frac{1}{4(k_1 k_2)^{3+i d\bar{\nu}}} \left[-S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} \delta_1^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^1 \right. \\
&\quad \left. + \left(-S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} + i 2 S_\ell^{i d\bar{\nu}, 1+i d\bar{\nu}} + i 2 S_\ell^{1+i d\bar{\nu}, i d\bar{\nu}} + 4 S_\ell^{1+i d\bar{\nu}, 1+i d\bar{\nu}} \right) \delta_2^{\dot{\alpha}} \delta_{\dot{\beta}}^2 \right]. \tag{3.28b}
\end{aligned}$$

Here the notation $\left[\mathcal{T}_{(d), \oplus\oplus}^{(L,7)} \right]_{\tau_1 \leftrightarrow \tau_2}$ means that the roles of τ_1 and τ_2 are exchanged in the corresponding time integrals.

An important observation is that the dominant contribution to $\mathcal{T}_{(d),ab}^{(L)}$ corresponds to the cases with $ad, bd > 0$. This can be understood by inspecting the following integral (which is contained in the time integral of the left subdiagram):

$$\int_0^\infty dz e^{-iaz} z^{id\tilde{\nu}} = -ia \int_0^\infty dz e^{-z} (-iaz)^{id\tilde{\nu}} = -ia e^{\frac{\pi(ad)\tilde{\nu}}{2}} \Gamma(1+id\tilde{\nu}). \quad (3.29)$$

From the above, we see that when $ad, bd < 0$, the integral is exponentially suppressed. In consequence, the left subdiagram is dominated by contributions with $ad, bd > 0$.

Finally, when the momentum of the propagator in the left subdiagram is not aligned with the z -axis, we define θ as the polar angle between $\mathbf{p}_{12} = \mathbf{k}_1$ and the z -axis, namely $\mathbf{k}_1 = k_1(\sin\theta, 0, \cos\theta)$ and $\mathbf{k}_1 \simeq -\mathbf{k}_2$. Thus, the corresponding left subdiagram for nonzero θ can be obtained from the $\theta=0$ case by the rotation rule given in Section 2.4.4.

3.2.3 Right Part of the Diagram

The right subdiagram is considerably simpler than the left one. It can be viewed as a degenerate “one-point” function, which is a 2×2 spinor matrix with no internal fermion propagator. As an explicit example, we consider the right subdiagram of diagram-(7) and it is given by the following:

$$\mathcal{T}_{(d),c}^{(R,7)\dot{\gamma}\gamma} = \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda}\right) \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_3 \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma}(-\tau_3)^{i2d\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (3.30)$$

where the factor $(-\tau_3)^{i2d\tilde{\nu}}$ with $d = \pm$ comes from the time dependence of the two soft lines. The corresponding expressions for the other diagrams can be derived in the same way.

Since the right subdiagram contains only one massless external line $\mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3)$, the time integral can be directly evaluated by using the integral formula,

$$\int_0^\infty dt t^z e^{-i\omega t} = (i\omega)^{-1-z} \Gamma(1+z). \quad (3.31)$$

Thus, we derive the contribution to the right subdiagram as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{T}_{(d),\oplus}^{(R,7)\dot{\gamma}\gamma} &= \left(\frac{-i}{2\Lambda}\right) k_3^{-3-i2d\tilde{\nu}} e^{d\pi\tilde{\nu}} \Gamma(1+i2d\tilde{\nu}) \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3+i4d\tilde{\nu} \end{pmatrix}^{\dot{\gamma}\gamma}, \\ \mathcal{T}_{(d),\ominus}^{(R,7)\dot{\gamma}\gamma} &= \left(\frac{-i}{2\Lambda}\right) k_3^{-3-i2d\tilde{\nu}} e^{-d\pi\tilde{\nu}} \Gamma(1+i2d\tilde{\nu}) \begin{pmatrix} 3+i4d\tilde{\nu} & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}^{\dot{\gamma}\gamma}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.32)$$

Eq.(3.32) shows that the right subdiagram could avoid the additional exponential suppression factor $e^{-2\pi\tilde{\nu}}$ only when $d=c=\pm$. Accordingly, in the following sections we will only consider the cases with $d=c$.

Among the eight diagrams in Fig. 2, there are six diagrams (with numbers 1,2,5,6,7,8) in which their right subdiagram takes the same form. The only exceptions are diagrams (3) and (4) which take a different form and are given by

$$\mathcal{T}_{(d),c}^{(R,3)} = \mathcal{T}_{(d),c}^{(R,4)} = \frac{-i}{\Lambda} \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_3 \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \sigma_{\dot{\gamma}\gamma}^\lambda(-\tau_3)^{i2d\tilde{\nu}}. \quad (3.33)$$

These can be obtained from the counterparts of the diagram-(7) by exchanging the diagonal elements of the 2×2 spinor matrix. Thus, using the formula for diagram-(7) we derive the following:

$$\mathcal{T}_{(d),\oplus\gamma\dot{\gamma}}^{(R,3)} = \mathcal{T}_{(d),\oplus\gamma\dot{\gamma}}^{(R,4)} = \left(\frac{-i}{2\Lambda}\right) k_3^{-3-i2d\tilde{\nu}} e^{d\pi\tilde{\nu}} \Gamma(1+i2d\tilde{\nu}) \begin{pmatrix} 3+i4d\tilde{\nu} & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}_{\gamma\dot{\gamma}}, \quad (3.34a)$$

$$\mathcal{T}_{(d),\ominus\gamma\dot{\gamma}}^{(R,3)} = \mathcal{T}_{(d),\ominus\gamma\dot{\gamma}}^{(R,4)} = \left(\frac{-i}{2\Lambda}\right) k_3^{-3-i2d\tilde{\nu}} e^{-d\pi\tilde{\nu}} \Gamma(1+i2d\tilde{\nu}) \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3+i4d\tilde{\nu} \end{pmatrix}_{\gamma\dot{\gamma}}. \quad (3.34b)$$

3.2.4 Central Part: Fermion Bubble Contribution

In this subsection, we analyze the bubble contribution $\mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}$, which contains the loop-momentum integral $\int d^3\mathbf{q}$, the dependence on the soft external momentum $\mathbf{k}_s$, and the remaining Gamma-function factors from the nonlocal parts of the two soft internal lines.

The treatment of the two internal lines in the bubble depends on the SK structure. In the time-ordered sector, for example when $a=b=c$, we use the symmetric component for the two internal lines, rather than the nonlocal propagators themselves. In a non-time-ordered sector, on the other hand, such as $a=b=\ominus$ and $c=\oplus$, the bubble diagram is constructed from the corresponding non-time-ordered propagator, $D_{\ominus\oplus}$ or $D_{\oplus\ominus}$, and we retain its nonlocal part. Moreover, as shown in the previous two subsections, the left subdiagram is dominated by the sector $d=a=b$, while the right subdiagram is dominated by $d=c$. It then follows that the leading contribution to the full diagram comes from the sector $d=a=b=c$, whereas the remaining choices of a , b , and c are suppressed.

In the following, we use the two representative cases

$$\begin{cases} d = -, & a = b = c = \ominus, \\ d = +, & a = b = c = \oplus, \end{cases} \quad (3.35)$$

to illustrate the evaluation of the bubble contribution.

In the diagram-(7), the central part of the bubble loop integral contains the product of two propagators with the spinor structure: $\check{D}_{ac}^{\dot{\beta}} D_{cb\gamma\dot{\alpha}} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(\tau)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}\gamma\dot{\alpha}}$. Since $a=b=c$, the two soft internal propagators entering the bubble loop integration should be taken to be the nonlocal parts of the symmetric propagators, as discussed in Section 3.2.1. Thus, we have the following:

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\check{D}_{bc}^{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{P}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3)\right]_{(\text{NLoc})} &\Rightarrow \left[\check{D}^{(S)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{P}_{23}; \tau_2, \tau_3)\right]_{(\text{NLoc})} = \frac{\sum_s [v_s(\tau_2, \mathbf{P}_{23}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_3, \mathbf{P}_{23})]_{(\text{NLoc})}}{2} \delta^{\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}}, \\ \left[D_{ca\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{P}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1)\right]_{(\text{NLoc})} &\Rightarrow \left[D^{(S)}_{\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{P}_{31}; \tau_3, \tau_1)\right]_{(\text{NLoc})} = \frac{\sum_s [u_s(\tau_3, \mathbf{P}_{31}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_1, \mathbf{P}_{31})]_{(\text{NLoc})}}{2} \sigma_{0\gamma\dot{\alpha}}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.36)$$

For fixed d , the bubble loop contribution $\mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(\tau)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}\gamma\dot{\alpha}}$ (with $d=a=b=c$) can be expressed as follows:

$$\mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(\tau)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}\gamma\dot{\alpha}} = \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \frac{\left[\check{D}^{(S)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{P}_{23}; \tau_2, \tau_3)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}}{(\tau_2\tau_3)^{id\tilde{\nu}}} \frac{\left[D^{(S)}_{\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{P}_{31}; \tau_3, \tau_1)\right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}}{(\tau_3\tau_1)^{id\tilde{\nu}}}$$

$$= \delta_{\dot{\gamma}}^{\dot{\beta}} \sigma_{0\gamma\dot{\alpha}} \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \frac{\sum_s \left[v_s(\tau_2, \mathbf{p}_{23}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_3, \mathbf{p}_{23}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}}{2(\tau_2\tau_3)^{i d \tilde{\nu}}} \frac{\sum_s \left[u_s(\tau_3, \mathbf{p}_{31}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_1, \mathbf{p}_{31}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}}{2(\tau_3\tau_1)^{i d \tilde{\nu}}}, \quad (3.37)$$

where $\mathbf{p}_{23} = \mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s$, $\mathbf{p}_{31} = \mathbf{q}$. The nonlocal mode-function combinations $\left[v_s(\tau_2, \mathbf{p}_{23}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_3, \mathbf{p}_{23}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}$ and $\left[u_s(\tau_3, \mathbf{p}_{31}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_1, \mathbf{p}_{31}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}$ (with $s = \pm$) are defined in Eq. (2.28).

In Eq.(3.37), the time-dependent factors $(\tau_2\tau_3)^{i d \tilde{\nu}}$ and $(\tau_3\tau_1)^{i d \tilde{\nu}}$ associated with the two soft internal lines have already been included in the time integrals of the left and right subdiagrams. Hence, they do not appear in the bubble loop contribution. Because the Gamma-function factors contained in the nonlocal parts are independent of the internal momenta $\mathbf{p}_{23}$ and $\mathbf{p}_{31}$, we factorize the loop integral as follows:

$$\mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(7)} \dot{\beta}_{\dot{\gamma}\gamma\dot{\alpha}} = \frac{\delta_{\dot{\gamma}}^{\dot{\beta}} \sigma_{0\gamma\dot{\alpha}}}{4} \{\Gamma\}_{(d),abc} \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} (2\mathbf{q})^{i 2 d \tilde{\nu}} |2(\mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s)|^{i 2 d \tilde{\nu}}, \quad (3.38)$$

where $\{\Gamma\}_{(d),abc}$ denotes the Gamma-function from the two nonlocal soft propagators. This is precisely the form quoted in Eq.(3.20) in Section 3.2.1.

As shown in Appendix C.4, the loop integral can be evaluated directly and we derive the following:

$$\mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(7)} \dot{\beta}_{\dot{\gamma}\gamma\dot{\alpha}} = \frac{\delta_{\dot{\gamma}}^{\dot{\beta}} \sigma_{0\gamma\dot{\alpha}}}{4} \{\Gamma\}_{(d),abc} \frac{2^{i 4 d \tilde{\nu}} k_s^{3+i 4 d \tilde{\nu}}}{(4\pi)^{3/2}} \frac{\Gamma(-\frac{3}{2} - i 2 d \tilde{\nu}) [\Gamma(\frac{3}{2} + i d \tilde{\nu})]^2}{[\Gamma(-i d \tilde{\nu})]^2 \Gamma(3 + i 2 d \tilde{\nu})}. \quad (3.39)$$

We note that the above result contains a factor

$$\mathcal{C}(\tilde{\nu}) \equiv \frac{\Gamma(-\frac{3}{2} - i 2 d \tilde{\nu}) [\Gamma(\frac{3}{2} + i d \tilde{\nu})]^2}{[\Gamma(-i d \tilde{\nu})]^2 \Gamma(3 + i 2 d \tilde{\nu})}, \quad (3.40)$$

which arises from the loop-momentum integral. After removing the phase, its large- $\tilde{\nu}$ behavior scales as $|\mathcal{C}(\tilde{\nu})| \simeq 2^{-9/2} \tilde{\nu}^{-3/2}$. For the sample input $\tilde{\nu} = 60$ [or $\tilde{\nu} = 30$], this corresponds to a suppression factor $|\mathcal{C}(\tilde{\nu})| \simeq 10^{-4}$ [or $|\mathcal{C}(\tilde{\nu})| \simeq 3 \times 10^{-4}$]. Hence, despite that this factor is not apparent from simple estimates in the previous works, it does generate a large numerical factor to substantially affect on the size of the loop contribution.

For the cases with $d = a = b = c$, the remaining Gamma function is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \{\Gamma\}_{(d),abc} &= \frac{\sum_s \left[v_s(\tau_2, \mathbf{p}_{23}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_3, \mathbf{p}_{23}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}}{(4p_{23}^2 \tau_2 \tau_3)^{i d \tilde{\nu}}} \frac{\sum_s \left[u_s(\tau_3, \mathbf{p}_{31}) u_s^\dagger(\tau_1, \mathbf{p}_{31}) \right]_{(\text{NLoc}),d}}{(4p_{31}^2 \tau_3 \tau_1)^{i d \tilde{\nu}}} \\ &= \frac{e^{-2\pi\tilde{\lambda}} (1 + e^{2\pi\tilde{\lambda}}) \tilde{M}_R \left(e^{2\pi\tilde{\lambda}} \tilde{M}_R^2 + \tilde{\lambda}^2 - \tilde{\nu}^2 \right) [\Gamma(-i 2 d \tilde{\nu})]^4}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda} - i d \tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1 + i\tilde{\lambda} - i d \tilde{\nu}) [\Gamma(1 - i\tilde{\lambda} - i d \tilde{\nu})]^2} \\ &= \frac{2\tilde{M}_R^3 \sinh(2\pi\tilde{\lambda}) [\Gamma(-i 2 d \tilde{\nu})]^4}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda} - i d \tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1 + i\tilde{\lambda} - i d \tilde{\nu}) [\Gamma(1 - i\tilde{\lambda} - i d \tilde{\nu})]^2}, \end{aligned} \quad (3.41)$$

where in the last line we have used $\tilde{\nu}^2 = \tilde{\lambda}^2 + \tilde{M}_R^2$. Substituting this expression back to Eq. (3.39), we derive the bubble contribution as follows:

$$\mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(7)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}\gamma\dot{\alpha}} = \delta_{\dot{\gamma}}^{\dot{\beta}} \sigma_{0\gamma\dot{\alpha}} \frac{2^{i4d\tilde{\nu}-3}}{\pi} k_s^{3+i4d\tilde{\nu}} \times \frac{\tilde{M}_R^3(1+i2d\tilde{\nu})^3 \Gamma(-2-i2d\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(-3-i4d\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(-i2d\tilde{\nu}) \sinh(2\pi\tilde{\lambda}) \tanh(d\pi\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu}) [\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})]^2}. \quad (3.42)$$

The bubble contribution depends only on the types of the two soft propagators in the loop. Thus we can readily verify that the bubble term of diagram-(8) in Fig. 2 is identical to that of diagram-(7). More generally, we derive the following relations for the bubble contributions from the different diagrams:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(1)} &= \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(2)}, & \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(3)} &= \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(4)}, \\ \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(5)} &= \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(6)}, & \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(7)} &= \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(8)}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.43)$$

3.3 Full Result of the Three-Point Correlator

In this subsection, we are ready to derive the full result of the nonlocal contribution to the three-point correlator from summing up all diagrams of Fig. 2. For each given diagram-(j) of Fig. 2, the nonlocal contribution takes the following form:

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})}{}^{(j)} \simeq \sum_{\substack{a,b,c=\pm \\ d=\pm}} abc \mathcal{T}_{(d),ab}^{(\text{L},j)}(\mathbf{k}_1, \mathbf{k}_2) \mathcal{B}_{(d),abc}^{(j)}(\mathbf{k}_s) \mathcal{T}_{(d),c}^{(\text{R},j)}(\mathbf{k}_3). \quad (3.44)$$

As discussed above, the dominant contribution comes from the cases with $d = a = b = c$. Thus, the above formula reduces to

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})}{}^{(j)} \simeq \sum_{a=d=\pm} a \mathcal{T}_{(d),aa}^{(\text{L},j)}(\mathbf{k}_1, \mathbf{k}_2) \mathcal{B}_{(d),aaa}^{(j)}(\mathbf{k}_s) \mathcal{T}_{(d),a}^{(\text{R},j)}(\mathbf{k}_3). \quad (3.45)$$

Then, we present the results for diagrams (7) and (8). Since these two diagrams share the same bubble contribution and the same right subdiagram, the corresponding three-point correlator can be expressed as follows:

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \left[\langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})}{}^{(7)} + \langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})}{}^{(8)} \right] \simeq \sum_{a=d=\pm} d \left[\mathcal{T}_{(d),aa}^{(\text{L},7)}(\mathbf{k}_1) + \mathcal{T}_{(d),aa}^{(\text{L},8)}(\mathbf{k}_1) \right] \mathcal{B}_{(d),aaa}^{(7)}(\mathbf{k}_s) \mathcal{T}_{(d),a}^{(\text{R},7)}(\mathbf{k}_3). \quad (3.46)$$

For a three-point correlator $k_s = k_3$, we can compute the following product of the bubble term and the right subdiagram $\mathcal{BR}_{(d),a}^{(7)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_3)$:

$$\mathcal{BR}_{(d),a}^{(7)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_3) \equiv \mathcal{B}_{(d),aaa}^{(7)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\gamma}\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_s) \mathcal{T}_{(d),a}^{(\text{R},7)\dot{\gamma}\gamma}(\mathbf{k}_3). \quad (3.47)$$

Substituting Eqs.(3.32) and (3.42) (with $d = a = b = c$) into the above formula, we derive the product as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{BR}_{(d),a}^{(7)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_3) &= \frac{-i}{\Lambda} \frac{2^{i4d\tilde{\nu}-4} e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}} (1+i2d\tilde{\nu})^3 \Gamma(-2-i2d\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(-3-i4d\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu}) [\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}-id\tilde{\nu})]^2} \\ &\quad \times \sinh(2\pi\tilde{\lambda}) \text{csch}(2d\pi\tilde{\nu}) \tanh(d\pi\tilde{\nu}) k_3^{i2d\tilde{\nu}} \tilde{M}_R^3 \mathcal{A}_{(d)}^{\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}}, \end{aligned} \quad (3.48)$$

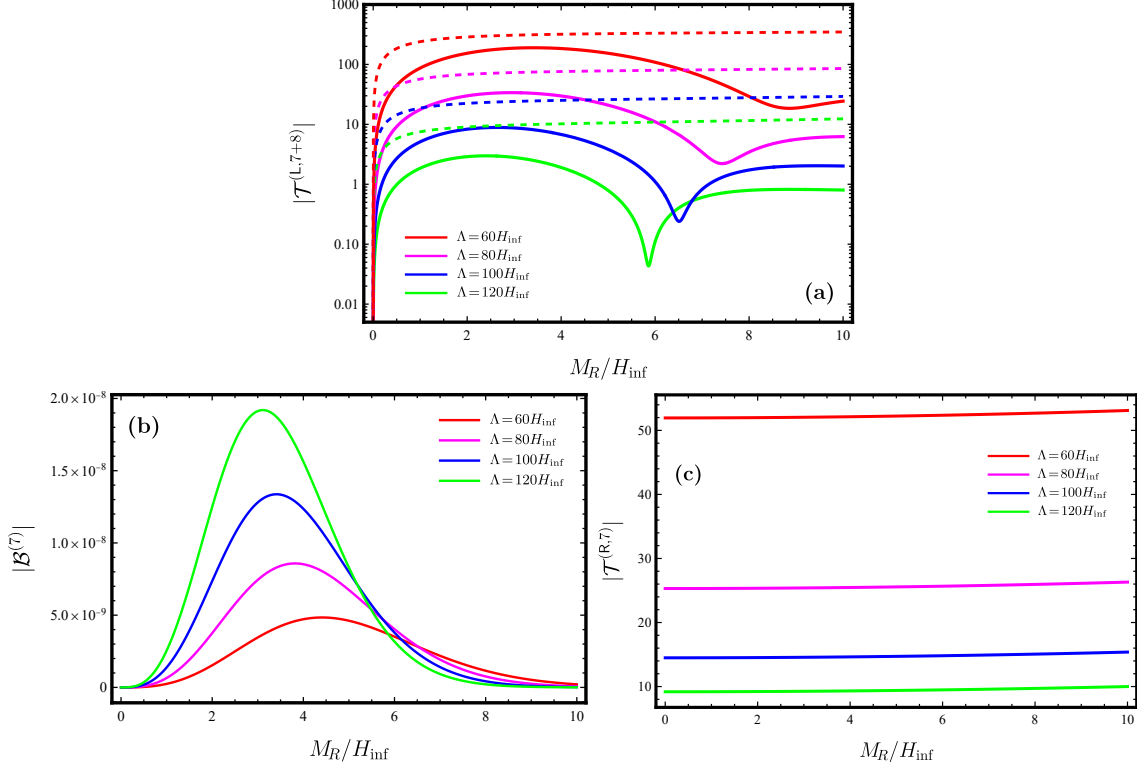


Figure 4: Contributions of diagrams (7)-(8) of Fig. 2 to the three-point correlator as a function of right-handed neutrino mass M_R for a set of sample Λ values. The plot (a) shows the contribution of the sum of the left subdiagrams, the plot (b) depicts the contribution of the central bubble subdiagram, and the plot (c) display the leading contribution of the right subdiagram. For comparison, the dashed curves of plot (a) also show the results as derived by using the saddle point approximation [45, 46, 49].

where $\mathcal{A}_{(d)}^{\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}}$ is a 2×2 matrix and depends on the choice of d ,

$$\mathcal{A}_{(+)}^{\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}} = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3+i4d\tilde{\nu} \end{pmatrix}_{\dot{\alpha}}^{\dot{\beta}}, \quad \mathcal{A}_{(-)}^{\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}} = \begin{pmatrix} 3+i4d\tilde{\nu} & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}_{\dot{\alpha}}^{\dot{\beta}}. \quad (3.49)$$

Then, the nonlocal CC signal of the three-point correlator from diagram-(7) and diagram-(8) takes the following form:

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \left[\langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})}^{(7)} + \langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})}^{(8)} \right] \simeq \sum_{a=d=\pm} d \left[\mathcal{T}_{(d),aa}^{(L,7)\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}_1) + \mathcal{T}_{(d),aa}^{(L,8)\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}_1) \right] \mathcal{B}\mathcal{R}_{(d),a}^{(7)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}_3), \quad (3.50)$$

where the term $\mathcal{T}_{(d),aa}^{(L,7)\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}_1)$ is given by Eqs.(3.23) and (3.2.2), the term $\mathcal{T}_{(d),aa}^{(L,8)\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}_1)$ is given by Eqs.(3.28a) and (3.28b), and the term $\mathcal{B}\mathcal{R}_{(d),a}^{(7)\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}}$ is given by Eq.(3.48).

Finally, the nonlocal CC signal of the full three-point correlator is given by the following sum of the eight diagrams of Fig. 2:

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})} = \lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \sum_{j=1}^8 \langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})}^{(j)}. \quad (3.51)$$

The calculations for the remaining six diagrams are similar and we do not list their explicit expressions here. Moreover, as proved in Appendix C.1, we have the following conjugate relations between two diagrams:

$$\begin{aligned}\langle\delta\phi^3\rangle_{(\text{NLoc})}'^{(1)} &= \left[\langle\delta\phi^3\rangle_{(\text{NLoc})}'^{(2)}\right]^*, & \langle\delta\phi^3\rangle_{(\text{NLoc})}'^{(3)} &= \left[\langle\delta\phi^3\rangle_{(\text{NLoc})}'^{(4)}\right]^*, \\ \langle\delta\phi^3\rangle_{(\text{NLoc})}'^{(5)} &= \left[\langle\delta\phi^3\rangle_{(\text{NLoc})}'^{(7)}\right]^*, & \langle\delta\phi^3\rangle_{(\text{NLoc})}'^{(6)} &= \left[\langle\delta\phi^3\rangle_{(\text{NLoc})}'^{(8)}\right]^*.\end{aligned}\tag{3.52}$$

In the above analysis, we have chosen the small momentum $\mathbf{k}_3$ to be on the z -axis and the large momentum $\mathbf{k}_1$ to be approximately aligned with the z -axis. For a more general configuration with $\mathbf{k}_1$ having an angle θ relative to the z -axis, we find that the total nonlocal cosmological collider signal of the three-point correlator is independent of θ . Hence the above analysis applies to the general case.

In Fig. 4, we present the contributions of diagrams (7)-(8) of Fig. 2 to the three-point correlator as a function of right-handed neutrino mass parameter M_R for a set of sample values of the UV cutoff, $\Lambda = (60, 80, 100, 120)H_{\text{inf}}$ [corresponding to $\lambda \simeq (60, 45, 36, 30)H_{\text{inf}}$] which are shown respectively by the (red, pink, blue, green) curves.

The left subdiagram shows the strongest dependence on both the mass parameter M_R and the chemical potential λ . Its magnitude is significantly enhanced for larger chemical potential, and for each benchmark choice it reaches its largest value around the intermediate-mass region. By contrast, the left subdiagram is relatively insensitive to M_R and mainly provides an overall $\tilde{\lambda}$ -dependent normalization. The bubble contribution also peaks around the region of $M_R \sim (3-5)H_{\text{inf}}$, but unlike the left and right subdiagrams, it becomes larger for smaller chemical potential.

For the left subdiagram, we also show in Fig. 4(a) the results obtained from using the saddle-point approximation of Refs. [45, 46, 49]. In the small-mass region, the saddle-point approximation overestimates the left subdiagram by roughly a factor of $O(10)$, whereas in the large-mass region the discrepancy can increase to $O(10-100)$. Since the total contribution to the CC signal is determined by the product of the three parts, the enhancement of the left and right subdiagrams dominates the final result as the chemical potential increases. Consequently, the full oscillatory signal becomes stronger for larger chemical potential and is most significant around the intermediate-mass-parameter region.

4 Amplitude and Shape of Cosmological Collider Signatures

In the previous section, we derived the nonlocal oscillatory contribution to the inflaton three-point correlator generated by the right-handed neutrino loop. In this section, we study its phenomenological application. First, we analyze the cosmological collider signal (including its magnitude) generated by the full three-point inflaton correlator as contributed by all the eight diagrams in Fig. 2. Second, we compare our result with that of the previous work [45] and discuss the difference between our study and the previous one.

4.1 Complete Cosmological Collider Signatures

Our goal in this subsection is twofold. We first express the squeezed-limit bispectrum in the conventional non-Gaussianity normalization and extract the corresponding oscillatory amplitude parameter $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$. Then, we analyze the dependence of the signal on the heavy right-handed neutrino mass and the cutoff scale, and display the characteristic oscillatory shape of the cosmological collider signal. We will focus on the nonlocal contribution as computed in Section 3, which captures the clock signal associated with the right-handed-neutrino propagation.

According to the convention of Planck collaboration [65], the bispectrum of the Bardeen potential Φ is defined as follows:

$$\langle \Phi_{\mathbf{k}_1} \Phi_{\mathbf{k}_2} \Phi_{\mathbf{k}_3} \rangle' = \frac{6A^2 f_{\text{NL}}}{(k_1 k_2 k_3)^2} \mathcal{C}(k_1, k_2, k_3), \quad (4.1)$$

where f_{NL} characterizes the magnitude of the primordial non-Gaussianity, and $\mathcal{C}(k_1, k_2, k_3)$ denotes the corresponding shape template. The normalization constant A is defined through the power spectrum of Φ , $P_\Phi = \langle \Phi_{\mathbf{k}_1} \Phi_{\mathbf{k}_2} \rangle' = A/k^3$, where $k = |\mathbf{k}_1|$. On the superhorizon scales, the Bardeen potential is connected to the comoving curvature perturbation (ζ) by the relation $\Phi = \frac{3}{5}\zeta$, and thus $A = 2\pi^2 (\frac{3}{5})^2 P_\zeta$, where $P_\zeta = \frac{k^3}{2\pi^2} \langle \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_1} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_2} \rangle' \simeq 2 \times 10^{-9}$ is the observed dimensionless scalar power spectrum.

For the oscillatory cosmological collider signal, the bispectrum of ζ may be written as

$$\langle \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_1} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_2} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_3} \rangle' = f_{\text{NL}} \frac{72\pi^4 P_\zeta^2}{5k_1^2 k_2^2 k_3^2} \mathcal{C}(k_1, k_2, k_3). \quad (4.2)$$

In the above the function $\mathcal{C}(k_1, k_2, k_3)$ is the oscillatory template and takes the following form in the squeezed limit,

$$\mathcal{C}(k_1, k_2, k_3) = e^{i\varphi_0} \left(\frac{k_1}{k_3} \right)^{i2\tilde{\nu}-2} + \text{c.c.} = 2 \left(\frac{k_1}{k_3} \right)^{-2} \cos \left(2\tilde{\nu} \ln \frac{k_1}{k_3} + \varphi_0 \right), \quad (4.3)$$

where φ_0 is an overall phase. Then, we derive the corresponding oscillatory non-Gaussian amplitude $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} &= \frac{5}{72\pi^4 P_\zeta^2} \frac{k_1^2 k_2^2 k_3^2}{\mathcal{C}(k_1, k_2, k_3)} \langle \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_1} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_2} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_3} \rangle'_{\text{squeezed}} \\ &= \frac{5}{72\pi^4 P_\zeta^2} \left(\frac{H_{\text{inf}}}{\dot{\phi}_0} \right)^3 \frac{k_1^2 k_2^2 k_3^2}{\mathcal{C}(k_1, k_2, k_3)} \langle \delta\phi_{\mathbf{k}_1} \delta\phi_{\mathbf{k}_2} \delta\phi_{\mathbf{k}_3} \rangle'_{\text{squeezed}} \\ &\simeq \left| \frac{10\pi^3 e^{2\pi\tilde{\lambda}-5\pi\tilde{\nu}} (i+2\tilde{\nu})^2 (i3+4\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(i2\tilde{\nu}) S_3^{1-i\tilde{\nu}, 1-i\tilde{\nu}} \tilde{\lambda}^3 \tilde{M}_R^3 P_\zeta}{9\Gamma(1-i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu})^2 \Gamma(5-i4\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu})} \right|, \end{aligned} \quad (4.4)$$

where in the above second line we have used $\zeta = -\frac{H}{\dot{\phi}_0} \delta\phi$. The quantity $S_3^{1-i\tilde{\nu}, 1-i\tilde{\nu}}$ is one of the entries in the seed integral matrix $\hat{\mathcal{I}}_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\beta}^{p_1 p_2}$ (with $p_1 = p_2 = 1-i\tilde{\nu}$) as defined in Eqs.(2.56b) and (2.57c),

$$\begin{aligned} S_3^{1-i\tilde{\nu}, 1-i\tilde{\nu}} &= 2^{-3+i2\tilde{\nu}} e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}-2\pi\tilde{\nu}} \pi \tilde{M}_R \Gamma(2-i2\tilde{\nu}) \\ &\times \left\{ -\frac{1}{(-i+\tilde{\lambda}-\tilde{\nu})(i2-\tilde{\lambda}+\tilde{\nu})^2 \Gamma(2+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(-1+i2\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu})} \right\} \end{aligned}$$

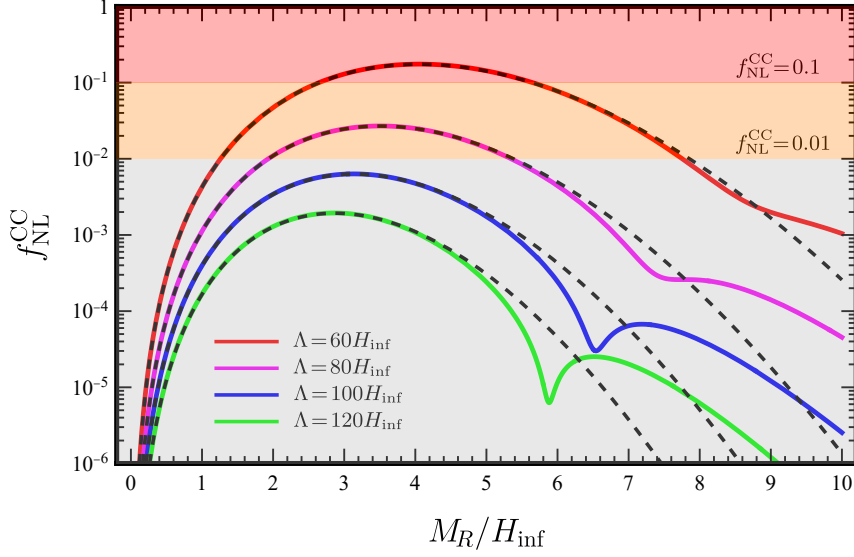


Figure 5: Amplitude of the oscillatory non-Gaussianity $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ as a function of the right-handed neutrino mass M_R (in the unit of H_{inf}). The (red, pink, blue, green) curves correspond to $\Lambda = (60, 80, 100, 120) H_{\text{inf}}$ respectively. The regions shaded by the light gray, light orange, and light red colors represent $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} < 0.01$, $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} > 0.01$, and $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} > 0.1$ respectively. Each black dashed curve shows the corresponding analytic result under the large-chemical-potential limit ($\tilde{\lambda} \gg 1$) as in Eq.(4.6).

$$\begin{aligned}
& + \frac{1}{(-i + \tilde{\lambda} - \tilde{\nu})(-i2 + \tilde{\lambda} - \tilde{\nu})\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu})} \left[{}_3\tilde{F}_2 \left(\begin{matrix} 2, -2 - i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, 2 - i2\tilde{\nu} \\ 3 + i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, -1 + i2\tilde{\nu} \end{matrix} \middle| -1 \right) \right. \\
& + 4(-i2 + \tilde{\lambda} - \tilde{\nu})(1 - i\tilde{\nu}) {}_3\tilde{F}_2 \left(\begin{matrix} 3, -1 - i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu}, 3 - i2\tilde{\nu} \\ 4 + i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, i2\tilde{\nu} \end{matrix} \middle| -1 \right) \Big] \\
& - i e^{2\pi\tilde{\nu}} \frac{\Gamma(4 - i2\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(4 - i4\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(-i\tilde{\lambda} + i\tilde{\nu})} {}_4\tilde{F}_3 \left(\begin{matrix} -i\tilde{\lambda} - i\tilde{\nu}, 2 - i2\tilde{\nu}, 4 - i2\tilde{\nu}, 4 - i4\tilde{\nu} \\ 1 - i2\tilde{\nu}, 3 - i2\tilde{\nu}, 5 + i\tilde{\lambda} - i3\tilde{\nu} \end{matrix} \middle| -1 \right) \Big\}. \quad (4.5)
\end{aligned}$$

We further simplify the above result for the non-Gaussian amplitude $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ by taking the large-chemical-potential limit $\tilde{\lambda} \gg 1$, which gives the following expression:

$$f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} \simeq \frac{5\pi^{\frac{5}{2}}}{2^8 9\sqrt{2}} P_\zeta \tilde{M}_R^4 \tilde{\lambda}^{\frac{9}{2}} e^{-\frac{9\pi}{2}(\tilde{\nu} - \tilde{\lambda})}. \quad (4.6)$$

This clearly shows that the usual the exponential suppression factor $e^{-\pi m/H_{\text{inf}}}$ is softened by the chemical potential $e^{-\frac{9\pi}{2}(\tilde{\nu} - \tilde{\lambda})} \sim e^{-\frac{9\pi}{4}(\tilde{M}_R^2/\tilde{\lambda})}$.

In Fig. 5, we show the amplitude of the oscillatory non-Gaussianity $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ as a function of the right-handed neutrino mass M_R for a set of benchmark values of the cutoff scale Λ . The (red, pink, blue, green) curves correspond to $\Lambda = (60, 80, 100, 120) H_{\text{inf}}$ respectively, which in turn give $\lambda \simeq (60, 45, 36, 30) H_{\text{inf}}$. The regions shaded by the light gray, light orange, and light red colors indicate $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} < 0.01$, $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} > 0.01$, and $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} > 0.1$, respectively. In the same plot, we show analytic results under the large-chemical-potential limit ($\tilde{\lambda} \gg 1$) as given by Eq.(4.6), which are depicted by the black dashed curves for each case.

As shown in Fig. 5, the oscillatory non-Gaussianity depends sensitively on both the cut-off scale and the right-handed neutrino mass. When the cutoff scale is reduced towards the

unitarity bound, $(\dot{\phi}_0)^{1/2} \simeq 60 H_{\text{inf}}$, the cosmological collider signal can reach $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} = O(0.1)$ for $M_R = (3-6) H_{\text{inf}}$. Such signals may be probed by the future searches through the measurements of the CMB, the large-scale-structure, and especially the 21cm tomography. Even for a moderately larger cutoff, such as $\Lambda = 80 H_{\text{inf}}$, part of the parameter space with $M_R = (2-6) H_{\text{inf}}$ can still give $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} \gtrsim O(0.01)$, which may be probed by the future 21cm tomography surveys. Fig. 5 also shows that the cosmological collider signal becomes weaker as Λ increases, or equivalently, as the chemical potential $\lambda = \dot{\phi}_0/\Lambda$ decreases. This trend can be understood from the factorized structure discussed in Section 3.2. As shown in Fig. 4, the left and right subdiagrams are both enhanced by a larger chemical potential, and this enhancement dominates over the bubble contribution (which becomes smaller as the chemical potential increases). Consequently, the full oscillatory signal becomes stronger when the chemical potential increases. This feature highlights the central role of the chemical potential. In the absence of a chemical potential, the cosmological collider signal from heavy fermions is strongly suppressed by the usual Boltzmann factor, and an additional suppression arises from the loop level. In contrast, a nonzero chemical potential softens the Boltzmann suppression and significantly enhances the dominant helicity mode. This opens up a window for observing the cosmological collider signals generated by heavy fermions such as the right-handed neutrinos.

Figure 5 also shows that the non-Gaussianity $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ is suppressed in both the large-mass and small-mass regions. In the large-mass region, the suppression is controlled by the Boltzmann factor. In the small-mass region, the suppression is determined by two complementary factors. First, certain left subdiagrams in Fig. 3, especially the diagrams (3)–(7), are effectively controlled by mass-insertion-type couplings. As the Majorana mass decreases, the corresponding mass-insertions become less important, and the oscillatory signals become reduced. Second, the suppression is also encoded in the soft-fermion propagators: the nonlocal part of the type-1 propagator in Eq.(2.30) scales as M_R^2 in the small-mass limit, whereas the corresponding nonlocal parts of the type-2 and type-3 propagators in Eqs.(2.33) and (2.36) scale linearly with M_R at the leading order. Combining these factors, we deduce the following:

$$\lim_{M_R \rightarrow 0} f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}} \sim \tilde{M}_R^4, \quad (4.7)$$

which shows that the neutrino-loop signal is quickly reduced via $\tilde{M}_R^4$ as the heavy fermion mass decreases.

To further characterize the structure of the cosmological collider signal, one can introduce a dimensionless shape function $S(k_1, k_2, k_3)$ through the following relation:

$$\langle \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_1} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_2} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_3} \rangle' = \frac{(2\pi)^4 P_\zeta^2}{(k_1 k_2 k_3)^2} S(k_1, k_2, k_3). \quad (4.8)$$

Unlike the template function $\mathcal{C}(k_1, k_2, k_3)$ defined above, the shape function $S(k_1, k_2, k_3)$ also contains the overall amplitude information. Using the squeezed-limit form of the bispectrum, it can be derived as follows:

$$S(k_1, k_2, k_3) = \langle \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_1} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_2} \zeta_{\mathbf{k}_3} \rangle' \frac{k_1^2 k_2^2 k_3^2}{(2\pi)^4 P_\zeta^2} = \frac{2f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}}{(2\pi)^4 P_\zeta^2} \left(\frac{H_{\text{inf}}}{\dot{\phi}_0} \right)^3 \left(\frac{k_3}{k_1} \right)^2 \cos\left(2\tilde{\nu} \ln \frac{k_1}{k_3} + \varphi_0\right). \quad (4.9)$$

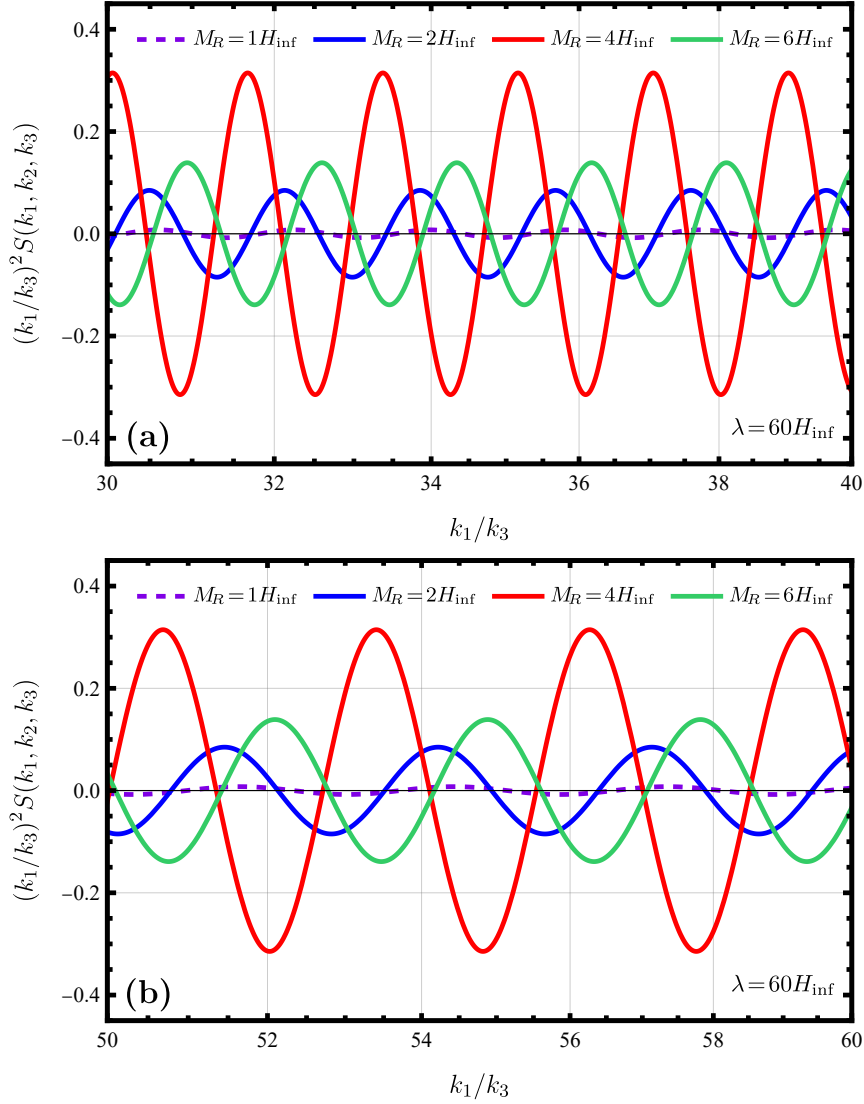


Figure 6: Dimensionless shape function $(k_1/k_3)^2 S(k_1, k_2, k_3)$ plotted as a function of the ratio k_1/k_3 on a logarithmic horizontal axis. The (purple-dashed, purple, blue, red, green) curves correspond to $M_R = (1, 2, 4, 6) H_{\text{inf}}$ respectively, with the chemical potential $\lambda = 60 H_{\text{inf}}$. The upper and lower plots correspond to different ranges of k_1/k_3 , illustrating the characteristic logarithmic scaling behavior along the horizontal axis.

In Fig. 6, we plot the dimensionless quantity $(k_1/k_3)^2 S(k_1, k_2, k_3)$ as a function of the ratio k_1/k_3 on a logarithmic horizontal axis. The (purple-dashed, purple, blue, red, green) curves correspond to the benchmark masses $M_R = (1, 2, 4, 6) H_{\text{inf}}$ respectively, and the chemical potential takes a sample value $\lambda = \dot{\phi}_0/\Lambda = 60 H_{\text{inf}}$. This figure demonstrates the characteristic oscillatory behavior of the cosmological collider signals in the squeezed limit. Moreover, because the horizontal axis is logarithmic, the oscillation frequency can be read off directly from the period of each curve and is determined by

$$\omega = 2\tilde{\nu} = 2\sqrt{\tilde{M}_R^2 + \tilde{\lambda}^2} . \quad (4.10)$$

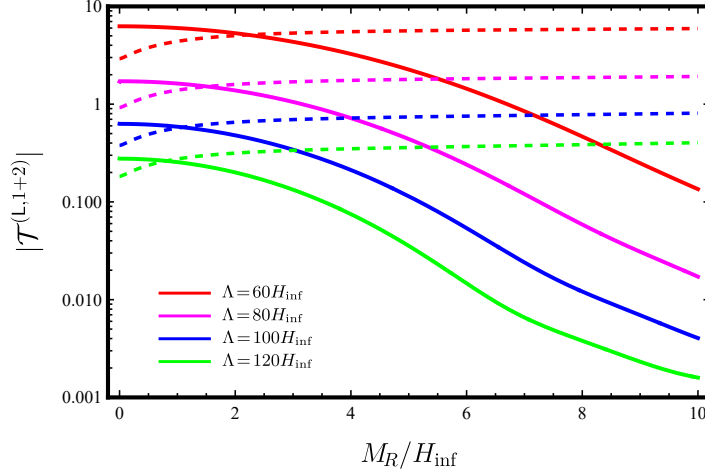


Figure 7: Comparison for magnitude of the left subdiagrams of the diagrams (1)+(2) in Fig. 2. The solid curves present the precise result of the left subdiagrams from the diagrams-(1)+(2), and the dashed curves present the result of the same left subdiagrams using the saddle point approximation adopted by Refs. [45, 46, 49].

Hence, the shape of the cosmological collider signal directly encodes the right-handed-neutrino mass scale and the chemical potential.

Finally, we note that once the chemical potential is switched off, namely in the limit $\tilde{\lambda} \rightarrow 0$, the nonlocal part of the symmetric propagator $[D^{(S)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{\text{NLoc}}$ vanishes. This indicates that the cosmological collider signal generated by a fermion loop is suppressed in the absence of the chemical potential. Hence, for the case where the heavy fermions couple to the inflaton only through an interaction that does not induce an effective chemical potential, such as a Yukawa-type coupling, the resultant cosmological collider signal is expected to be much weaker.

4.2 Comparison with the Previous Work

In this subsection, we briefly compare our result for the inflaton bispectrum with the estimate presented in Ref. [45], which gave qualitative estimate on the characteristic oscillatory signal generated by heavy fermions during inflation. In contrast, our work uses a new method to quantitatively compute the cosmological collider signals generated by the heavy right-handed neutrino loop. In the following, we will explain why the overall amplitude derived in the present work is numerically smaller than Ref. [45], and clarify how this difference arises in our calculation.

We note that the previous analysis [45] adopted two simplifying approximations: (i) the hard propagator was treated by a saddle-point approximation; and (ii) the loop momentum was replaced by a characteristic value instead of being integrated over explicitly. By contrast, our calculation is based on the factorized loop treatment developed in Section 3 and Appendix C, in which the diagram is decomposed into a left part, a right part, and a bubble loop part in which the loop-momentum integration is explicitly performed within this framework.

The numerical difference between our analysis and the previous one [45] mainly arises from the following sources. First, the propagator structure of Ref. [45] improperly included all four helicity combinations $(++, +-, -+, --)$, whereas in the present formalism only two independent helicity contributions $(++, --)$ enter the final result. This is because the anti-commutator (2.12) vanishes for the mixed helicity-combinations $(+-, -+)$. Second, Ref. [45] adopted the saddle-point approximation for the hard propagator and included the extra helicity channels $(+-, -+)$ [which should not exist due to the vanishing anti-commutator (2.12)]. These two factors enlarged the result of Ref. [45] as compared with our result, and caused a large discrepancy of order $O(10-100)$ in the intermediate-mass range. In contrast, if one keeps only the two helicity channels $(++, --)$, the saddle-point-approximation-based result for the left subdiagram remains close to the precise result for intermediate mass range, but can deviate by about two orders of magnitude in the large-mass range, as illustrated in Fig. 7. Third, and more importantly, the loop integration measure is treated very differently. Ref. [45] effectively approximates the loop integral as the following over-simplified form,

$$\frac{1}{(2\pi)^3} \int d\phi = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^2}, \quad (4.11)$$

whereas in the present analysis we compute the full bubble-loop integral explicitly, as given in Appendix C.4. Numerically, this leads to an $O(10^4)$ difference in the intermediate- and large-mass ranges, as shown in Fig. 9, and constitutes the dominant source of our new improvements. This main numerical improvement can be traced to the following factor of Gamma functions:

$$\mathcal{C}(\tilde{\nu}) \equiv \frac{\Gamma(-\frac{3}{2}-i2\tilde{\nu}) [\Gamma(\frac{3}{2}+i\tilde{\nu})]^2}{[\Gamma(-i\tilde{\nu})]^2 \Gamma(3+i2\tilde{\nu})}. \quad (4.12)$$

This factor arises from the explicit loop-momentum integration and is not captured by the estimate based on pure dimensional analysis of the bubble integral. After removing the phase, it exhibits the large- $\tilde{\nu}$ behavior, $|\mathcal{C}(\tilde{\nu})| \simeq 2^{-9/2} \tilde{\nu}^{-3/2}$. For a sample input of $\tilde{\nu} = 30$ (corresponding to $\Lambda = 120H_{\text{inf}}$), this factor is of the order 3×10^{-4} . Thus, without including this factor would cause the resultant loop-amplitude to be over-estimated by about three to four orders of magnitude.

In addition, Ref. [45] includes only the diagrams (1) and (2) of Fig. 2, whereas our calculation includes the complete set of all eight diagrams of Fig. 2. Besides, Ref. [45] uses $D_{\ominus\oplus}$ as a representative soft propagator, whereas our calculation employs the symmetric combination discussed around Eq.(C.42) of Appendix C.3. These differences do not modify the qualitative oscillatory structure of the signal, but they do affect the overall magnitude by $O(1)$ factors.

To make an explicit comparison, we show in Fig. 8 the non-Gaussian amplitude $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ obtained in our framework when only diagrams (1) and (2) of Fig. 2 are retained. Even within this special case, the resultant non-Gaussianity $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ [shown in the present Fig. 8(a)] is already substantially smaller than the previous qualitative estimate of Ref. [45] and than our full result [shown in the present Fig. 8(b)].

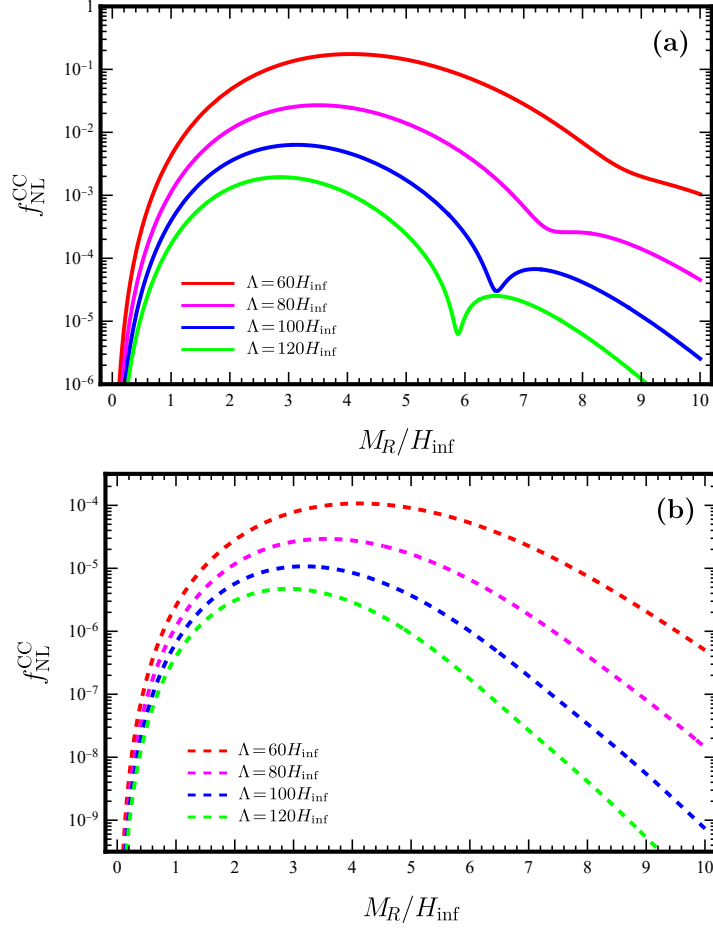


Figure 8: Comparison of the correlation amplitude of the cosmological-collider non-Gaussianity $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ as a function of the heavy-neutrino mass scale M_R , which is contributed by all diagrams of Fig. 2 as shown in the present plot (a) and contributed by the diagrams (1)+(2) only as shown in the present plot (b). The (red, pink, blue, green) curves correspond to a set of sample values of the cutoff scale $\Lambda = (60, 80, 100, 120)H_{\text{inf}}$, respectively.

We can make more direct comparison in Fig. 9 for the same cutoff choice $\Lambda = 120H_{\text{inf}}$ and for including only the diagrams (1) and (2) of Fig. 2. In Fig. 9, we plot the previous result of Ref. [45] (shown as blue curve), the result obtained after correcting the propagator treatment (i.e., the correct helicity contributions and the precise evaluation of the hard propagator in the left subdiagram) (shown as green curve), and the full result obtained in the present work (shown as red curve). As shown in Fig. 9, the previous result of Ref. [45] (the blue curve) is about one order of magnitude larger than the result obtained after correcting the propagators (the green curve). The propagator-corrected result (the green curve) is about four orders of magnitude larger than the present result (the red curve). This substantial difference between the green curve and the red curve is mainly due to the different treatments of the loop integration measure as given by our formula in Eq.(3.38) and by the previous approximation in Eq.(4.11).

Finally, we present a comparison of the correlation amplitude of the cosmological-

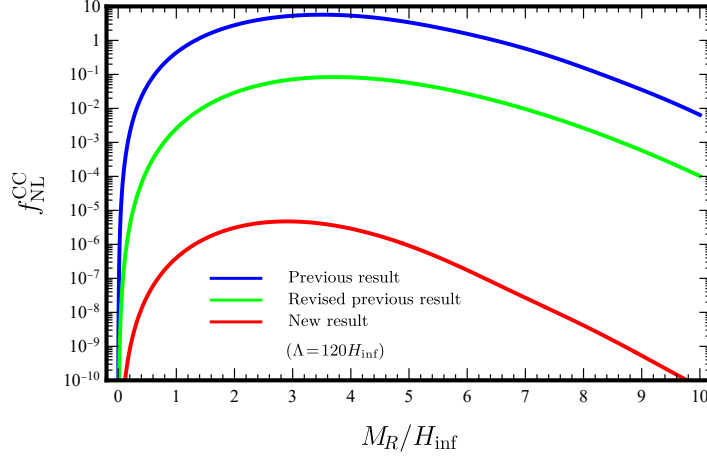


Figure 9: Comparison among the previous result of Ref. [45] (shown as blue curve), the revised previous result after correcting the propagators (shown as green curve), and the new result (shown as red curve), for a sample cutoff value $\Lambda = 120H_{\text{inf}}$, where only the diagrams (1) and (2) of Fig. 2 are included for this comparison.

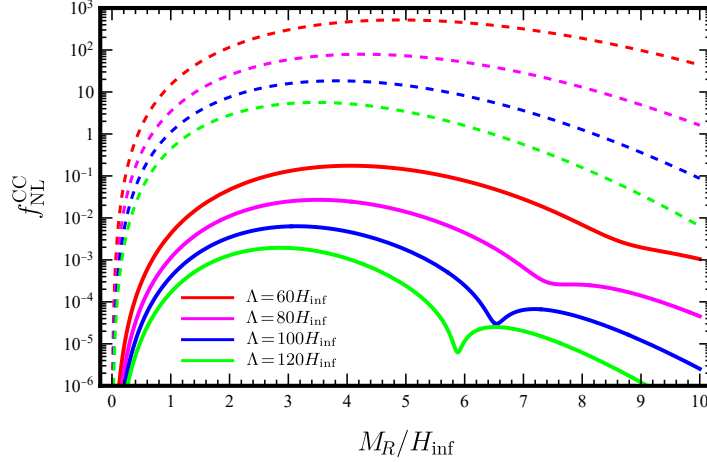


Figure 10: Comparison of the correlation amplitude of the cosmological-collider non-Gaussianity $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ between our new result and the estimate of Ref. [45]. The (red, pink, blue, green) solid curves denote our results for $\Lambda = (60, 80, 100, 120)H_{\text{inf}}$ respectively, whereas the dashed curves denote the corresponding estimates obtained using the method of Ref. [45].

collider non-Gaussianity $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ between our new result (4.4) and the estimate of Ref. [45] in Fig. 10, as a function of the heavy-neutrino mass scale M_R . For the cutoff scales $\Lambda = (60, 80, 100, 120)H_{\text{inf}}$, the previous estimate is larger than our result by roughly $O(10^3)$ in the intermediate and large mass ranges. This difference is mainly caused by the combined effects of the corrected fermion propagators, the complete helicity and Schwinger-Keldysh structure, the inclusion of the full set of relevant loop diagrams, and the explicit loop-momentum integration performed in the present calculation.

In summary, the above comparison shows that our present method is more precise and reliable, which leads to substantial improvements of our results over the previous

results [45]. The main difference lies in the overall magnitude of the CC signals, which is improperly enlarged in Ref. [45] by the oversimplified approximations described above. In our present approach, the loop integration is consistently factorized in the squeezed limit, and the full set of relevant diagrams in Fig. 2 is computed for our analyses. We have presented the comparisons in Fig. 7, Fig. 8, Fig. 9 and Fig. 10. Due to these reasons, our present method and analysis have made important progress for more reliably predicting cosmological collider signals from the heavy fermion loop contributions.

5 Conclusions

Cosmological collider physics [6–18] provides a unique means to probing heavy particles present during inflation through their contributions to the primordial non-Gaussianities. So far most of the existing studies have focused on tree-level signals or scalar-loop effects, whereas signatures of heavy fermion loops are technically more challenging and remain largely unexplored. But, heavy fermions (such as the right-handed neutrinos) are strongly motivated [62, 63] from the structure of the Standard Model of particle physics and from the light neutrino mass-generations through the canonical seesaw mechanism [58–61]. Hence, it is important to develop a systematic method for computing the contributions of heavy fermion loops to the inflaton correlators and to predict the fermion-loop signatures through the primordial non-Gaussianities.

In this work, we studied cosmological collider signals generated by heavy fermion loops in an inflationary setup including the derivative interaction between the inflaton and right-handed neutrinos. A central ingredient of our analysis is the effective chemical potential induced by the slow-roll inflaton background. This chemical potential leads to helicity-dependent fermion production and can substantially enhance one of the helicity modes, thereby weakening the usual Boltzmann suppression of heavy-particle production during inflation. In this way, heavy fermions (such as the heavy right-handed neutrinos) that would otherwise generate extremely small signals may become significantly more visible in the primordial non-Gaussianity.

In Section 2, we formulated the dynamics of the right-handed Majorana neutrinos in the slow-roll inflationary background. With the unique derivative interaction between the inflaton and right-handed neutrinos as given in Eq.(2.1), we showed how the rolling inflaton background induces an effective chemical potential (2.8) for the right-handed neutrinos. We then derived the corresponding Weyl-spinor mode functions (2.19), constructed the Schwinger-Keldysh propagators in Eqs.(2.30), (2.33), and (2.36), and extracted their late-time nonlocal components in Eqs.(2.39a)–(2.39c). These late-time components encode the characteristic oscillatory clock signals and provide the basic building blocks for the fermion-loop calculation.

In Section 3, we computed the three-point inflaton correlator generated by the right-handed-neutrino triangle loop. We classified the eight inequivalent contractions of the Majorana fermion loop [shown in Fig. 2 and Eqs.(3.4)(3.7)] and organized their contributions in terms of the factorized left subdiagram, central bubble loop, and right subdiagram [shown in Fig. 3 and Eq.(3.12)]. Since the nonlocal parts of fermion propagators contain nontrivial

helicity and spinor structures, the scalar-loop cutting rule cannot be directly applied to the full fermion loop. Hence, we isolated the factorizable nonlocal contribution associated with the symmetric part of the soft propagators. Within this sector, the loop calculation can be reduced to a controlled product of three contributions (the left subdiagram, the central bubble loop-integral, and the right subdiagram). This treatment keeps the hard propagator analytically in the left subdiagram and retains the loop-momentum integration in the central bubble part, thereby improving the control over the normalization of the nonlocal signals as compared with the previous estimates based on a saddle-point treatment of the hard internal propagator.

In Section 4, we analyzed the size and shape of the predicted cosmological collider signatures. We expressed the squeezed-limit bispectrum in terms of the oscillatory non-Gaussianity amplitude $f_{\text{NL}}^{\text{CC}}$ in Eq.(4.4) and studied its dependence on the right-handed-neutrino mass, the induced chemical potential, and the UV cutoff scale of the inflaton-right-handed-neutrino interaction. We found that the chemical potential enhances one of the helicity modes and can substantially soften the usual Boltzmann suppression of heavy-fermion production. In consequence, as shown Fig. 5, the loop-induced signals can become sizable in the intermediate-mass range, whereas it is suppressed both in the large-mass range by the heavy-particle Boltzmann factor and in the small-mass range by the mass-dependence of the fermion propagators and the mass-insertion structure. We further compared our result with previous estimates as presented in Figs. 7-9. The main difference arises from a more precise treatment of the full loop structure as shown in Fig. 9. In earlier analysis, the hard propagator was estimated by a saddle-point approximation and the magnitude of loop momentum was assumed to be a cutoff value. Moreover, not all fermion-loop contractions were included, so part of the loop-diagram contributions was effectively omitted. In contrast, we keep the hard propagator inside the left subdiagram, include the complete set of relevant fermion-loop contractions, and perform the loop-momentum integration precisely in the bubble subdiagram. This treatment precisely retains the momentum dependence, helicity dependence, and Schwinger-Keldysh structure of the fermion propagators. In consequence, we found that the resultant signal amplitude is substantially smaller than the previous estimate, showing that the saddle-point approximation, the oversimplification of loop integral, and incomplete diagrams cause large overestimate of the loop-induced cosmological collider signals.

Our analysis provides a systematic framework for fermion-loop signals of the cosmological collider physics. We have shown that heavy-fermion derivative interaction with the inflaton can generate potentially observable oscillatory non-Gaussian signatures even when their masses are significantly above the Hubble scale. This opens up a new window to sensitively probing the high-scale new physics involving heavy fermions, such as the right-handed neutrinos responsible for the light neutrino mass generation through the seesaw mechanism. In such cosmological collider signals, the oscillation frequency is mainly controlled by the effective chemical potential, which is set by the cutoff scale Λ , whereas the signal amplitude is sensitive to the mass scale of the right-handed neutrino.

We also stress the complementarity between the present study of probing the neutrino seesaw scale using cosmological collider signals and the previous study [62, 63] of probing

the neutrino seesaw mechanism using the local non-Gaussianity. In Refs. [62, 63], the local non-Gaussian signals arise from the Higgs-modulated reheating and depend on the seesaw parameters (including the right-handed-neutrino mass and the neutrino Yukawa coupling) and the Higgs self-coupling during inflation. Hence, the two types of observables can probe different combinations of the seesaw and inflationary parameters: the non-analytic cosmological-collider signals are primarily sensitive to the heavy right-handed-neutrino mass and the chemical-potential, whereas the local non-Gaussianity constrains the reheating dynamics and the seesaw parameters (connected to the light neutrino mass as well). Combining these two types of primordial non-Gaussian signatures will give complementary probes of the full seesaw parameter space.

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Appendix

A Weyl Spinors in the Inflationary Background

In this Appendix, we retain the spinor indices explicitly and set up the spinor-helicity conventions. Then, we derive a self-consistent set of equations of motion for the Weyl spinor mode-functions.

Consider the curved spacetime with a metric tensor $g_{\mu\nu}$,

$$ds^2 = g_{\mu\nu} dx^\mu dx^\nu. \quad (\text{A.1})$$

Using the vierbein $e^a_\mu = \partial\xi^a/\partial x^\mu$ with ξ^a being the coordinate of the Minkowski metric η_{ab} , the metric tensor can be expressed as $g_{\mu\nu} = e^a_\mu e^b_\nu \eta_{ab}$, where $\eta_{ab} = \text{diag}(-1, 1, 1, 1)$ is the Minkowski metric tensor.

In curved spacetime, spinors are defined with respect to a local Lorentz frame and the covariant derivative includes the spin connection [72–74]. The covariant derivative acting on a Weyl spinor ψ_α is defined as

$$D_\mu \psi_\alpha = \partial_\mu \psi_\alpha + \frac{1}{2} \omega_{\mu ab} (\Sigma^{ab})_\alpha^\beta \psi_\beta, \quad (\text{A.2})$$

where $\omega_{\mu ab}$ is the spin connection,

$$\omega_{\mu ab} = e^a_\nu D_\mu e^{b\nu} = e^a_\nu \left(\partial_\mu e^{b\nu} + \Gamma^\nu_{\mu\rho} e^{b\rho} \right), \quad (\text{A.3})$$

with $\Gamma_{\mu\rho}^\nu$ being the Christoffel symbol. In Eq.(A.2), the quantity $(\Sigma^{ab})_\alpha{}^\beta$ denotes the Lorentz generators in the Weyl representation,

$$(\Sigma^{ab})_\alpha{}^\beta = \frac{1}{4}(\sigma^a \bar{\sigma}^b - \sigma^b \bar{\sigma}^a)_\alpha{}^\beta, \quad (\text{A.4})$$

where $\sigma^a = (1, \vec{\sigma})$ and $\bar{\sigma}^a = (1, -\vec{\sigma})$ are the sigma matrices in the flat spacetime.

Then, we consider the spatially flat FLRW metric in the conformal coordinate,

$$ds^2 = a^2(\tau)(-d\tau^2 + d\vec{x}^2). \quad (\text{A.5})$$

The vierbein is given by $e_\mu^a = a(\tau) \delta_\mu^a$ and $e_a^\mu = a^{-1}(\tau) \delta_a^\mu$. The non-vanishing Christoffel symbols $\Gamma_{\mu\rho}^\nu$ are derived as follows:

$$\Gamma_{00}^0 = \mathcal{H}, \quad \Gamma_{ij}^0 = \mathcal{H} \delta_{ij}, \quad \Gamma_{0j}^i = \mathcal{H} \delta_j^i, \quad (\text{A.6})$$

where $\mathcal{H} = \frac{a'}{a}$ with $a' = da(\tau)/d\tau$. Thus, the non-vanishing spin connection components are given by

$$\omega_{ij0} = -\omega_{i0j} = \mathcal{H} \delta_{ij}, \quad (i, j = 1, 2, 3), \quad (\text{A.7})$$

and all other components vanish. Using the formula

$$(\Sigma^{0i})_\alpha{}^\beta = -(\Sigma^{i0})_\alpha{}^\beta = \frac{1}{4}(\sigma^0 \bar{\sigma}^i - \sigma^i \bar{\sigma}^0)_\alpha{}^\beta = \frac{1}{2}(\sigma^0 \bar{\sigma}^i)_\alpha{}^\beta, \quad (\text{A.8})$$

we simplify the covariant derivative (acting on the Weyl spinor) as follows:

$$D_0 \psi_\alpha = \partial_0 \psi_\alpha, \quad D_i \psi_\alpha = \partial_i \psi_\alpha - \frac{1}{2} \mathcal{H} (\sigma^0 \bar{\sigma}^i)_\alpha{}^\beta \psi_\beta, \quad (\text{A.9})$$

where σ^a and $\bar{\sigma}^a$ are the sigma matrices in the flat spacetime.

Consider the free Lagrangian of a Weyl spinor in the curved spacetime,

$$\Delta \mathcal{L} = \sqrt{-g} \, i \psi_\alpha^\dagger \bar{\varsigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} D_\mu \psi_\alpha, \quad (\text{A.10})$$

where the Pauli sigma matrices ς_μ and $\bar{\varsigma}^\mu$ are defined from the flat-space sigma matrices σ^a through the vierbein e_a^μ ,

$$\varsigma^\mu = e_b^\mu \sigma^b, \quad \bar{\varsigma}^\mu = e_b^\mu \bar{\sigma}^b. \quad (\text{A.11})$$

For the FLRW universe, the Pauli sigma matrices ς^μ and $\bar{\varsigma}^\mu$ are expressed as follows:

$$\varsigma^\mu = a(\tau)^{-1} \sigma^\mu, \quad \bar{\varsigma}^\mu = a(\tau)^{-1} \bar{\sigma}^\mu. \quad (\text{A.12})$$

Then, the kinematic term of the free Lagrangian for a Weyl spinor in FLRW spacetime takes the following form:

$$\Delta \mathcal{L} = \sqrt{-g} \, \frac{i}{a} \psi_\alpha^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} D_\mu \psi_\alpha. \quad (\text{A.13})$$

Using $\sqrt{-g} = a(\tau)^4$ and the covariant derivative formula (A.9), we derive the above Lagrangian as follows:

$$\Delta \mathcal{L} = i a^3 \psi^\dagger \left(\bar{\sigma}^0 \partial_0 + \bar{\sigma}^i \partial_i + \frac{3}{2} \mathcal{H} \bar{\sigma}^0 \right) \psi, \quad (\text{A.14})$$

where we use an identity,

$$\sum_i (\bar{\sigma}^i \sigma^0 \bar{\sigma}^i)^{\dot{\alpha}\beta} = -3\bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\beta}. \quad (\text{A.15})$$

With the field redefinition

$$\tilde{\psi} = a^{3/2} \psi, \quad (\text{A.16})$$

we can simplify the Lagrangian to the flat-space form:

$$\Delta\mathcal{L} = i\tilde{\psi}^\dagger (\bar{\sigma}^0 \partial_0 + \bar{\sigma}^i \partial_i) \tilde{\psi} = i\tilde{\psi}^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu \partial_\mu \tilde{\psi}. \quad (\text{A.17})$$

Thus, using the field redefinition for the right-handed neutrino field $\tilde{N} = a^{3/2} N$, we can simplify the free Lagrangian (2.8) of the right-handed neutrinos with a chemical potential as follows:

$$\Delta\mathcal{L} = i\tilde{N}_\alpha^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \partial_\mu \tilde{N}_\alpha - a\lambda \tilde{N}_\alpha^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \tilde{N}_\alpha - \frac{1}{2} a M_R (\tilde{N}^\alpha \tilde{N}_\alpha + \tilde{N}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}} \tilde{N}_\alpha^\dagger). \quad (\text{A.18})$$

Then, we derive the equation of motion for $\tilde{N}_\alpha^\dagger$,

$$i\bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \partial_\mu \tilde{N}_\alpha = a\lambda \bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \tilde{N}_\alpha + a M_R \tilde{N}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}. \quad (\text{A.19})$$

With this, we define the quantized right-handed-neutrino fields:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{N}_\alpha(\tau, \mathbf{x}) &= \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{k}}{(2\pi)^3} \sum_{s=\pm} [\xi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k}) b_s(\mathbf{k}) e^{i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} + \chi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k}) b_s^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}}], \\ \tilde{N}_\alpha^\dagger(\tau, \mathbf{x}) &= \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{k}}{(2\pi)^3} \sum_{s=\pm} [\xi_{s,\alpha}^\dagger(\tau, \mathbf{k}) b_s^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} + \chi_{s,\alpha}^\dagger(\tau, \mathbf{k}) b_s(\mathbf{k}) e^{i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}}], \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.20})$$

where b_s and $b_s^\dagger$ are annihilation and creation operators satisfying

$$\{b_s(\mathbf{k}), b_{s'}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}')\} = (2\pi)^3 \delta_{ss'} \delta^3(\mathbf{k} - \mathbf{k}'). \quad (\text{A.21})$$

In the above expansions (A.20), $\xi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k})$ and $\chi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k})$ are the mode functions. Substituting Eq.(A.20) into the equation of motion (A.18), we derive the equations of motion for the mode functions:

$$i(\bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\beta} \xi'_{s,\beta} + i\bar{\sigma}^{i\dot{\alpha}\beta} k_i \xi_{s,\beta}) = a\lambda \bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\beta} \xi_{s,\beta} + a M_R \chi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}, \quad (\text{A.22a})$$

$$i(\bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\beta} \chi'_{s,\beta} - i\bar{\sigma}^{i\dot{\alpha}\beta} k_i \chi_{s,\beta}) = a\lambda \bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\beta} \chi_{s,\beta} + a M_R \xi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}, \quad (\text{A.22b})$$

where we have used the notation $f'(\tau) = df(\tau)/d\tau$ with $f(\tau) = \xi_{s,\beta}(\tau)$ or $f(\tau) = \chi_{s,\beta}(\tau)$. We can reexpress the above second equation and have the following coupled equations of motion for the two mode functions $\xi_{s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k})$ and $\chi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k})$:

$$i(\bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\beta} \xi'_{s,\beta} + i\bar{\sigma}^{i\dot{\alpha}\beta} k_i \xi_{s,\beta}) = a\lambda \bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\beta} \xi_{s,\beta} + a M_R \chi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}, \quad (\text{A.23a})$$

$$-i(-\sigma_{\beta\dot{\alpha}}^0 \chi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}'} - i k_i \sigma_{\beta\dot{\alpha}}^i \chi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}) = -a\lambda \sigma_{\beta\dot{\alpha}}^0 \chi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}} + a M_R \xi_{s,\beta}. \quad (\text{A.23b})$$

We further factorize the helicity spinors and define the spinor coefficients u_s and v_s as follows:

$$\xi_{s,\alpha}(\tau, \mathbf{k}) = u_s(\tau, k) h_{s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}), \quad \chi_s^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\tau, \mathbf{k}) = v_s(\tau, k) s h_{-s}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}), \quad (\text{A.24})$$

where $s h_{-s}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}) = \pm h_{\mp}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k})$ for $s = \pm$. The unit helicity eigenspinors h_s for momentum $\mathbf{k}$ in the direction

$$\hat{\mathbf{k}} = (\sin \theta \cos \varphi, \sin \theta \sin \varphi, \cos \theta) \quad (\text{A.25})$$

are chosen to take the following forms:

$$h_{+, \alpha}(\mathbf{k}) = h_{+, \alpha}(\theta, \varphi) = \begin{pmatrix} e^{-i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \\ e^{+i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha}, \quad (\text{A.26a})$$

$$h_{-, \alpha}(\mathbf{k}) = h_{-, \alpha}(\theta, \varphi) = \begin{pmatrix} -e^{-i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} \\ e^{i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha}. \quad (\text{A.26b})$$

We also have the relation $h_{s, \alpha} = s h_{-s}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}$, which leads to the following:

$$h_{-}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}) = \begin{pmatrix} e^{-i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \\ e^{i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} \end{pmatrix}^{\dot{\alpha}}, \quad -h_{+}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}) = \begin{pmatrix} -e^{-i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} \\ e^{i\frac{\varphi}{2}} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \end{pmatrix}^{\dot{\alpha}}. \quad (\text{A.27})$$

The helicity eigenspinors $h_{s, \alpha}$ satisfy the following relations:

$$(-\vec{\sigma} \cdot \hat{\mathbf{k}})^{\dot{\alpha}\beta} h_{s, \beta}(\mathbf{k}) = h_{-s}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}), \quad \bar{\sigma}^{0\dot{\alpha}\beta} h_{s, \beta}(\mathbf{k}) = s h_{-s}^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{k}), \quad (\text{A.28a})$$

$$(\vec{\sigma} \cdot \hat{\mathbf{k}})_{\alpha\dot{\beta}} h_s^{\dagger\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}) = h_{-s, \alpha}(\mathbf{k}), \quad \sigma_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^0 h_s^{\dagger\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}) = -s h_{-s, \alpha}(\mathbf{k}), \quad (\text{A.28b})$$

which is consistent with Eq.(2.14). In the above equations, we express the spinor indices explicitly, with α denoting left-handed $(\frac{1}{2}, 0)$ indices and $\dot{\alpha}$ denoting right-handed $(0, \frac{1}{2})$ indices.

Substituting Eq.(A.24) into the equations of motion (A.23), we derive the following coupled equations for the spinor coefficients u_s and v_s :

$$i u'_{\pm} \pm k u_{\pm} = a \lambda u_{\pm} + a M_R v_{\pm}, \quad (\text{A.29a})$$

$$i v'_{\pm} \mp k v_{\pm} = -a \lambda v_{\pm} + a M_R u_{\pm}. \quad (\text{A.29b})$$

Then, we recast these two equations into the diagonal forms:

$$u''_{\pm} - a H u'_{\pm} + [(\pm k - a \lambda)^2 + a^2 M_R^2 \pm i a H k] u_{\pm} = 0, \quad (\text{A.30a})$$

$$v''_{\pm} - a H v'_{\pm} + [(\mp k + a \lambda)^2 + a^2 M_R^2 \mp i a H k] v_{\pm} = 0. \quad (\text{A.30b})$$

The above second-order differential equations just give Eqs.(2.18a) in Section 2.2, which can be solved to give the solutions in Eq.(2.19).

B Schwinger-Keldysh Propagators of Weyl Spinors

In this Appendix, we briefly summarize the propagators of two-component Weyl spinors in the Schwinger-Keldysh (SK) path-integral formalism. We present the generating functional and the fermion propagators for Weyl spinors in the presence of a nonzero chemical potential.

Since the path-integral variables for fermion fields are anticommuting Grassmann quantities, some care is required for constructing the doubled path integral in the in-in formalism. In particular, the reverse-time-ordered contour should be placed to the left-hand-side of the time-ordered contour. Let ψ_+ and ψ_- denote the path-integral variables on the time-ordered and reverse-time-ordered contours respectively, and let I_+ and I_- be the corresponding external sources. Then, the generating functional of the in-in correlators can be written as follows:

$$Z[I_-, I_-^\dagger; I_+, I_+^\dagger] = \int \mathcal{D}\psi_-^\dagger \mathcal{D}\psi_- \exp \left[-iS[\psi_-, \psi_-^\dagger] - i \int d^4x \left(I_-^\alpha \psi_{-\alpha} + I_{-\alpha}^\dagger \psi_-^{\dagger\alpha} \right) \right] \times \int \mathcal{D}\psi_+^\dagger \mathcal{D}\psi_+ \exp \left[iS[\psi_+, \psi_+^\dagger] + i \int d^4x \left(I_+^\alpha \psi_{+\alpha} + I_{+\alpha}^\dagger \psi_+^{\dagger\alpha} \right) \right]. \quad (\text{B.1})$$

In the above path integral, we treat the left-handed spinors $\psi_{\pm\alpha}$ and the right-handed spinors $\psi_{\pm}^{\dagger a}$ as independent variables. It is understood that the boundary conditions $\psi_+ = \psi_-$ and $\psi_+^\dagger = \psi_-^\dagger$ at future infinity $\tau=0$ are imposed.

From the generating functional (B.1), we derive three types of two-point correlators (propagators) of the Weyl spinors ψ and $\psi^\dagger$ by taking two functional derivatives with respect to the corresponding external sources:

$$\hat{D}_{ab\alpha\beta}(\tau_1, \mathbf{x}; \tau_2, \mathbf{y}) = \int d^3\mathbf{x} e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} \frac{\delta}{ia\delta I_a^\alpha(\tau_1, \mathbf{x})} \frac{\delta}{ib\delta I_b^\beta(\tau_2, \mathbf{y})} Z[I_-, I_-^\dagger; I_+, I_+^\dagger] \Big|_{I=0}, \quad (\text{B.2a})$$

$$\check{D}_{ab\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\tau_1, \mathbf{x}; \tau_2, \mathbf{y}) = \int d^3\mathbf{x} e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} \frac{\delta}{ia\delta I_a^{\dagger\dot{\alpha}}(\tau_1, \mathbf{x})} \frac{\delta}{ib\delta I_b^{\dagger\dot{\beta}}(\tau_2, \mathbf{y})} Z[I_-, I_-^\dagger; I_+, I_+^\dagger] \Big|_{I=0}, \quad (\text{B.2b})$$

$$D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\tau_1, \mathbf{x}; \tau_2, \mathbf{y}) = \int d^3\mathbf{x} e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} \frac{\delta}{ia\delta I_a^\alpha(\tau_1, \mathbf{x})} \frac{\delta}{ib\delta I_b^{\dagger\dot{\beta}}(\tau_2, \mathbf{y})} Z[I_-, I_-^\dagger; I_+, I_+^\dagger] \Big|_{I=0}. \quad (\text{B.2c})$$

These objects correspond to the two-point vacuum expectation values in the in-in formalism. For instance, the propagators of the $D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}$ type are given by

$$D_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) = \int d^3\mathbf{x} e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} \langle 0 | \psi_\alpha(\tau_1, \mathbf{x}) \psi_{\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{0}) | 0 \rangle, \quad (\text{B.3a})$$

$$D_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) = - \int d^3\mathbf{x} e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} \langle 0 | \psi_{\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{0}) \psi_\alpha(\tau_1, \mathbf{x}) | 0 \rangle, \quad (\text{B.3b})$$

$$D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) = \int d^3\mathbf{x} e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} \langle 0 | \mathbf{T} \left\{ \psi_\alpha(\tau_1, \mathbf{x}) \psi_{\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{0}) \right\} | 0 \rangle, \quad (\text{B.3c})$$

$$D_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) = \int d^3\mathbf{x} e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{x}} \langle 0 | \bar{\mathbf{T}} \left\{ \psi_\alpha(\tau_1, \mathbf{x}) \psi_{\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\tau_2, \mathbf{0}) \right\} | 0 \rangle, \quad (\text{B.3d})$$

where $\mathbf{T}$ denotes the time-ordered product and $\bar{\mathbf{T}}$ the reverse-time-ordered product. The extra minus sign in $D_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}$ arises from exchanging the fermionic fields when the reverse-time-ordered field is placed to the left of the time-ordered field.

Substituting the mode expansion of ψ_α and $\psi_{\dot{\beta}}^\dagger$ of Eq.(2.11) into the above definitions, we find that only the term containing $b_s(\mathbf{k})b_s^\dagger(\mathbf{k})$ survives because

$$\{b_s(\mathbf{k}), b_{s'}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}')\} = (2\pi)^3 \delta_{ss'} \delta^3(\mathbf{k}-\mathbf{k}'), \quad (\text{B.4})$$

with which the fermion propagators can be derived as in Section 2.3.

C Derivations of the Relevant Formulas

In this Appendix, we present several derivations for the evaluation of the right-handed-neutrino loop contribution to the three-point inflaton correlation function. Our purpose is to make the calculation strategy more transparent and to separate the basic derivations from the analysis of special kinematic limits.

We proceed in the following order. First, we summarize several general relations that are repeatedly used in the loop calculation, including the conjugation properties of the external lines and loop diagrams. Then, we present sample derivations of the seed integrals introduced in Section 2.4. These seed integrals form the basic building blocks of the factorized loop calculation. We further explain how to use these seed integrals to form the three-point inflaton correlators and clarify the origin of the dominant contribution in the squeezed limit. After that, we discuss the folded-limit behavior and the cutting rule, which provide a useful structural interpretation of the nonlocal part of the signal. Finally, we derive the bubble loop integral by using the Feynman diagram approach.

C.1 Conjugation Relations between Three-Point Correlators

In this subsection, we analyze the relations between the three-point loop correlators. Specifically, we can classify the eight diagrams of Fig. 2 into four pairs, where the two diagrams within each pair are related by complex conjugation. A particularly useful relation is the conjugation property of the external function (3.5),

$$\mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}, \tau)^* = \mathcal{F}_{\mu, -a}(-\mathbf{k}, \tau), \quad (\text{C.1})$$

which follows directly from the definition of the SK bulk-to-boundary propagator (3.6). In consequence, the pairs of correlators related by reversing the fermion-flow in the loop are complex conjugates of each other. This relation can also be checked numerically.

As an illustration, consider diagram-(7) of Fig. 2, whose contribution takes the following form:

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(7)} &= \sum_{a,b,c=\pm} abc \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^3 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 d\tau_3 \\ &\quad \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7), \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.2})$$

where the function $\mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7)$ is given by

$$\mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7) = \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \hat{D}_{ab\alpha}^{\beta}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^{\nu} \check{D}_{bc}^{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} D_{ca\gamma\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1), \quad (\text{C.3})$$

with $\mathbf{p}_{12} = \mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_1$, $\mathbf{p}_{23} = \mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s$, and $\mathbf{p}_{31} = \mathbf{q}$.

Taking the complex conjugate of Eq.(C.2), we derive the following:

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(7)} \right]^* &= \sum_{a,b,c=\pm} abc \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^3 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 d\tau_3 \\ &\quad \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1)^* \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2)^* \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3)^* \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \mathcal{Y}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7)^*. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.4})$$

Using $\mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}, \tau)^* = \mathcal{F}_{\mu, -a}(-\mathbf{k}, \tau)$, we deduce the following:

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(7)} \right]^* &= \sum_{a,b,c=\pm} abc \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^3 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 d\tau_3 \\ &\quad \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(-\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(-\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(-\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \int \frac{d^3 \mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \mathcal{Y}_{-a,-b,-c}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7)^*. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.5})$$

To evaluate $\mathcal{Y}_{-a,-b,-c}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7)^*$, it is convenient to suppress spinor indices and use the following trace notation:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Y}_{-a,-b,-c}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7)^* &= \left[\text{Tr} \left(\bar{\sigma}^\mu \hat{D}_{-a,-b}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \sigma^\nu \check{D}_{-b,-c}(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^\lambda D_{-c,-a}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1) \right) \right]^* \\ &= \text{Tr} \left\{ \sigma^\nu \left[\hat{D}_{-a,-b}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu \left[D_{-c,-a}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1) \right]^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\lambda \left[\check{D}_{-b,-c}(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3) \right]^\dagger \right\}. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.6})$$

The Hermitian conjugates of the propagators satisfy the relations:

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\hat{D}_{-a,-b\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]^\dagger &= \check{D}_{ba\dot{\beta}\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_2, \tau_1), & \left[\hat{D}_{-a,-b}{}^\beta{}_\alpha(\mathbf{p}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]^\dagger &= -\check{D}_{ba}{}^{\dot{\beta}}{}_{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_2, \tau_1), \\ \left[\check{D}_{-a,-b\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]^\dagger &= \hat{D}_{ba\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_2, \tau_1), & \left[\check{D}_{-a,-b}{}_{\dot{\beta}}{}^{\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]^\dagger &= -\hat{D}_{ba}{}_{\beta}{}^{\alpha}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_2, \tau_1), \\ \left[D_{-a,-b\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]^\dagger &= D_{ba\dot{\beta}\alpha}(\mathbf{p}, \tau_2, \tau_1). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.7})$$

Thus, using the above relations, we further derive Eq.(C.6) as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Y}_{-a,-b,-c}^{\mu\nu\lambda}(7)^* &= \text{Tr} \left\{ \sigma^\nu \check{D}_{ba}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^\mu D_{ac}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_1, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^\lambda \hat{D}_{cb}(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_3, \tau_2) \right\} \\ &= \sigma^\nu{}_{\alpha\dot{\alpha}} \check{D}_{ba}{}^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\beta}\beta} D_{ac\beta\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_1, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} \hat{D}_{cb\gamma}{}^\alpha(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_3, \tau_2). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.8})$$

Then, we reverse the direction of each external momentum as $\mathbf{k}_j \rightarrow -\mathbf{k}_j$, and further reverse the direction of the loop momentum $\mathbf{q} \rightarrow -\mathbf{q}$. With these and using Eq.(C.8), we further express the three-point correlator (C.5) as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} &\left[\langle \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(7)} \right]^* \\ &= \sum_{a,b,c=\pm} abc \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^3 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 d\tau_3 \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \\ &\quad \times \int \frac{d^3 \mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \sigma^\nu{}_{\alpha\dot{\alpha}} \check{D}_{ba}{}^{\dot{\alpha}}{}_{\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{21}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\beta}\beta} D_{ac\beta\dot{\gamma}}(\mathbf{p}_{13}, \tau_1, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} \hat{D}_{cb\gamma}{}^\alpha(\mathbf{p}_{32}, \tau_3, \tau_2), \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.9})$$

which just describes the contribution from the diagram-(5) of Fig. 2. Hence, we deduce the following relation:

$$\left[\langle \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(7)} \right]^* = \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(5)}. \quad (\text{C.10})$$

Note that the cosmological collider signal takes the schematic form in the squeezed limit,

$$\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})} \sim \frac{A}{k_1^3 k_3^3} \left(\frac{k_1}{k_3} \right)^{n+12\bar{\nu}} f(\hat{\mathbf{k}}_1 \cdot \hat{\mathbf{k}}_3) + \text{H.c.}, \quad (\text{C.11})$$

where n is certain real number and the function $f(\hat{\mathbf{k}}_1 \cdot \hat{\mathbf{k}}_3)$ depends only on the angle between the two external momenta. Thus, the signal should be invariant under the transformation $\mathbf{k}_j \rightarrow -\mathbf{k}_j$, with which we derive the following:

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})} \right]^* &= \left[\lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(-\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'_{(\text{NLoc})} \right]^* \\ &= \lim_{k_s \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'^{(5)}_{(\text{NLoc})}, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.12})$$

where in the last step we have used Eq.(C.10). Moreover, we can prove that for other pairs of diagrams in Fig. 2, including each pair of diagrams-(1)(2), (3)(4), and (6)(8), also obey the same type of relations as derived in (3.52).

C.2 Derivation of Seed Integrals for Fermion Propagators

In Section 2.4, we introduced the seed integrals associated with the three types of fermion propagators and listed the entries of the corresponding seed-integral matrices, such as $A_i^{p_1, p_2}$, $S_i^{p_1, p_2}$, $U_i^{p_1, p_2}$, and $W_i^{p_1, p_2}$ (with $i = 1, 2$). In this subsection, we derive these entries explicitly. As representative examples, we present the derivation of the time-ordered integral $S_1^{p_1, p_2}$ and the non-time-ordered integral $W_1^{p_1, p_2}$. The remaining entries can be obtained analogously.

◆ Time-Ordered Seed Integral:

We first consider the following time-ordered integral $S_1^{p_1, p_2}$,

$$\begin{aligned} S_1^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_+(z_1) v_+^\dagger(z_2) \theta(z_2 - z_1) \\ &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_{z_1}^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_+(z_1) v_+^\dagger(z_2) \\ &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz e^{-iz_1} e^{-i(z+z_1)} z_1^{p_1} (z+z_1)^{p_2} u_+(z_1) v_+^\dagger(z+z_1). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.13})$$

where (p_1, p_2) are the relevant powers associated with (z_1, z_2) . In the last step of the above derivation, we have changed the integral variable z_2 by $z = z_2 - z_1$, whereas the spinor coefficients u_+ and v_+ are given by

$$u_+(z) = \frac{e^{+\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}}{\sqrt{2z}} \tilde{M}_R W_{-\frac{1}{2}-i\tilde{\lambda}, i\tilde{\nu}}(-i2z), \quad (\text{C.14a})$$

$$v_+(z) = \frac{e^{+\pi\tilde{\lambda}/2}}{\sqrt{2z}} W_{\frac{1}{2}-i\tilde{\lambda}, i\tilde{\nu}}(-i2z). \quad (\text{C.14b})$$

The power factors p_1 and p_2 are complex in general and all such complex power are defined on the principal branch,

$$w^p \equiv e^{p \log w}, \quad \arg(w) \in (-\pi, \pi]. \quad (\text{C.15})$$

In particular, for $x > 0$, we have $(-ix)^p = e^{-i\pi p/2} x^p$.

For Eq.(C.13), we first make Wick rotation $z \rightarrow -iz$ for the integral contour of z . Since $z_1 - iz$ stays in the fourth quadrant for $z_1 > 0$ and $z > 0$, the contour deformation does not

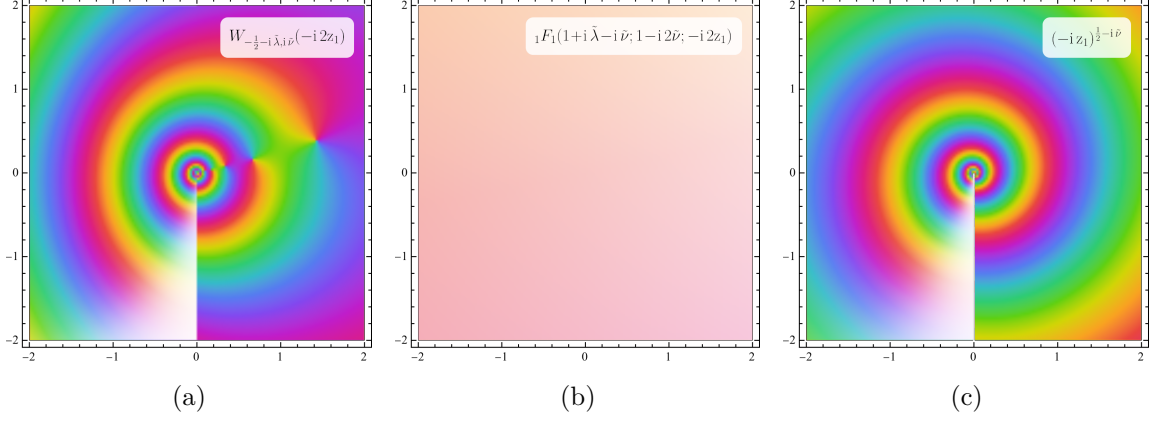


Figure 11: Domain-coloring plots illustrating the origin of the branch cut in the z_1 plane: (a). $W_{-\frac{1}{2}-i\tilde{\lambda}, i\tilde{\nu}}(-i2z_1)$, (b). ${}_1F_1(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}, 1-i2\tilde{\nu}; -i2z_1)$, and (c). $(-iz_1)^{1/2-i\tilde{\nu}}$. The horizontal and vertical axes denote $\text{Re } z_1$ and $\text{Im } z_1$, respectively. The color indicates the complex phase, whereas the brightness indicates the magnitude. Plot (b) is regular in the z_1 plane, whereas the non-analyticity in plot (a) is associated with the fractional-power behavior shown in plot (c), whose principal-branch cut lies along the negative imaginary axis of the z_1 plane.

cross the branch cut:

$$S_1^{p_1 p_2} = \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-iz_1} z_1^{p_1} u_+(z_1) \int_0^\infty dz (-i) e^{-i(-iz+z_1)} (-iz+z_1)^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz+z_1). \quad (\text{C.16})$$

The subsequent Wick rotation of the z_1 contour is more delicate, because $u_+(z_1)$ contains the Whittaker function according to the expression (C.14a), which is a function of z_1 and has a branch cut along the negative imaginary axis. Hence, the contour deformation should be understood as follows:

$$z_1 \rightarrow e^{-i(\pi/2-\epsilon)} z_1, \quad (\epsilon > 0), \quad (\text{C.17})$$

and the limit $\epsilon \rightarrow 0^+$ is taken after the deformation.

To identify the origin of the branch cut, we rewrite the Whittaker function in terms of the confluent hypergeometric function ${}_1F_1$ by using Eq.(2.21):

$$W_{-\frac{1}{2}-i\tilde{\lambda}, i\tilde{\nu}}(-i2z_1) = \frac{2^{\frac{1}{2}-i\tilde{\nu}} e^{iz_1} (-iz_1)^{\frac{1}{2}-i\tilde{\nu}} \Gamma(i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu})} {}_1F_1(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}, 1-i2\tilde{\nu}; -i2z_1) + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}). \quad (\text{C.18})$$

Since ${}_1F_1(a; b; x)$ is analytic in x and does not generate branch cuts, the non-analyticity in the z_1 plane originates from the fractional-power factor $(-iz_1)^{1/2 \pm i\tilde{\nu}}$ in Eq.(C.18), as illustrated in Fig. 11. With the principal-branch convention adopted above, this factor has a branch cut along the negative imaginary axis of the z_1 plane. Hence, the Wick rotation of the z_1 contour should be understood as approaching this axis from the fourth quadrant, namely, through the regulated deformation $z_1 \rightarrow e^{-i(\pi/2-\epsilon)} z_1$, with $\epsilon \rightarrow 0^+$. After the principal branch has been fixed by this prescription, the Wick rotation of each fractional-power factor appearing in Eq.(C.18) can be evaluated as $(-iz_1)^\alpha \rightarrow (e^{-i\pi} z_1)^\alpha = e^{-i\pi\alpha} z_1^\alpha$. With this prescription and making the Wick rotation $z_1 \rightarrow -iz_1$ for the integral contour of z_1 , we arrive at

$$S_1^{p_1 p_2} = \int_0^\infty dz_1 (-i) e^{-z_1} (-iz_1)^{p_1} u_+(-iz_1) \int_0^\infty dz (-i) e^{-(z+z_1)} (-iz-iz_1)^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz-iz_1)$$

$$= - \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-z_1} (-iz_1)^{p_1} u_+(-iz_1) \int_0^\infty dz e^{-(z+z_1)} (-iz-iz_1)^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz-iz_1), \quad (\text{C.19})$$

where the overall minus sign comes from the two Jacobian factors, $(-i)^2 = -1$.

Finally, defining $z' = z + z_1$ and $dz' = dz$, we further derive

$$\begin{aligned} S_1^{p_1 p_2} &= - \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-z_1} (-iz_1)^{p_1} u_+(-iz_1) \int_{z_1}^\infty dz' e^{-z'} (-iz')^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz') \\ &= - \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-z_1} (-iz_1)^{p_1} u_+(-iz_1) \int_{z_1}^\infty dz_2 e^{-z_2} (-iz_2)^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz_2). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.20})$$

Equivalently, using the principal-branch relation $(-ix)^p = e^{-i\pi p/2} x^p$ (for $x > 0$), we obtain the following:

$$S_1^{p_1 p_2} = -e^{-\frac{i}{2}\pi(p_1+p_2)} \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-z_1} z_1^{p_1} u_+(-iz_1) \int_{z_1}^\infty dz_2 e^{-z_2} z_2^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz_2). \quad (\text{C.21})$$

Next, we proceed to explicitly evaluate the double integral over z_1 and z_2 in Eq.(C.21). Since the z_2 integration is nested within the z_1 integration, we begin with the z_2 integral. The integral over z_2 can be evaluated analytically, yielding an indefinite integral in terms of a Meijer G function. Taking the asymptotic expansion at infinity and then setting the lower limit to $z_2 = z_1$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{I}_2(z_1) &\equiv \int_{z_1}^\infty dz_2 e^{-z_2} z_2^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz_2) \\ &= 2^{-\frac{3}{2}-p_2} e^{\frac{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}{2}} e^{i\frac{\pi}{4}} z_2^{-\frac{1}{2}} G_{2,3}^{2,1} \left[\frac{3}{2}, \frac{3}{2}+p_2-i\tilde{\lambda} \right. \\ &\quad \left. \frac{3}{2}+p_2-i\tilde{\nu}, \frac{3}{2}+p_2+i\tilde{\nu}, \frac{1}{2}; 2z_2 \right] \Big|_{z_1}^\infty \\ &= \left(2^{-1-p_2} e^{\frac{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}{2}} e^{i\frac{\pi}{4}} \frac{\Gamma(1+p_2-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(1+p_2+i\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1+p_2-i\tilde{\lambda})} \right) \\ &\quad - \left(2^{-\frac{3}{2}-p_2} e^{\frac{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}{2}} e^{i\frac{\pi}{4}} z_1^{-\frac{1}{2}} G_{2,3}^{2,1} \left[\frac{3}{2}, \frac{3}{2}+p_2-i\tilde{\lambda} \right. \right. \\ &\quad \left. \left. \frac{3}{2}+p_2-i\tilde{\nu}, \frac{3}{2}+p_2+i\tilde{\nu}, \frac{1}{2}; 2z_1 \right] \right). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.22})$$

The Meijer G function is defined as follows:

$$G_{p,q}^{m,n} \left[\begin{matrix} a_1, a_2, \dots, a_p \\ b_1, b_2, \dots, b_q \end{matrix}; z \right] \equiv \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_C ds z^s \frac{\left[\prod_{k=1}^n \Gamma(1-a_k+s) \right] / \left[\prod_{k=m+1}^q \Gamma(1-b_k+s) \right]}{\left[\prod_{k=n+1}^p \Gamma(a_k-s) \right] / \left[\prod_{k=1}^m \Gamma(b_k-s) \right]}. \quad (\text{C.23})$$

In the second step, we evaluate the integral over z_1 from 0 to ∞ . By virtue of Eq.(2.21) and after adopting the branch-cut prescription specified above, $u_+(-iz_1)$ can be written as follows:

$$u_+(-iz_1) = \tilde{M}_R e^{z_1} e^{-\frac{i\pi}{4}} e^{\frac{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}{2}} \left[\frac{2^{-i\tilde{\nu}} e^{-\pi\tilde{\nu}} z_1^{-i\tilde{\nu}} \Gamma(i2\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu})} {}_1F_1(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}, 1-i2\tilde{\nu}; -i2z_1) + (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \right]. \quad (\text{C.24})$$

Then, we can evaluate the remaining z_1 integral directly, which yields the following:

$$\begin{aligned}
S_1^{p_1 p_2} &= -e^{-\frac{i}{2}\pi(p_1+p_2)} \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-z_1} z_1^{p_1} u_+(-iz_1) \mathcal{I}_2(z_1) \\
&= \frac{i\pi 2^{-2-p_1-p_2} e^{-\frac{i\pi}{2}(p_1+p_2)} e^{\pi\tilde{\lambda}} \tilde{M}_R \operatorname{csch}(2\pi\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(2+p_1+p_2)}{\Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}+i\tilde{\nu})} \\
&\quad \times \left[e^{-\pi\tilde{\nu}} \Gamma(1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(2+p_1+p_2-i2\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}) \right. \\
&\quad \left. \times {}_4\tilde{F}_3 \left(\begin{matrix} 2+p_1+p_2, 1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}, 1+i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}, 2+p_1+p_2-i2\tilde{\nu} \\ 2+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}, 2+p_1+p_2-i\tilde{\lambda}-i\tilde{\nu}, 1-i2\tilde{\nu} \end{matrix}; -1 \right) - (\tilde{\nu} \rightarrow -\tilde{\nu}) \right].
\end{aligned} \tag{C.25}$$

◆ Non-Time-Ordered Seed Integral:

Next, we consider the following non-time-ordered integral $W_1^{p_1 p_2}$,

$$\begin{aligned}
W_1^{p_1 p_2} &= \int_0^\infty dz_1 \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{iz_1} e^{-iz_2} z_1^{p_1} z_2^{p_2} u_+(z_1) v_+^\dagger(z_2) \\
&= \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{iz_1} z_1^{p_1} u_+(z_1) \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-iz_2} z_2^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(z_2) \\
&= \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-z_1} (iz_1)^{p_1} u_+(iz_1) \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-z_2} (-iz_2)^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz_2) \\
&= e^{\frac{i\pi}{2}(p_1-p_2)} \int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-z_1} z_1^{p_1} u_+(iz_1) \int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-z_2} z_2^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz_2).
\end{aligned} \tag{C.26}$$

Unlike the time-ordered integrals, the variables z_1 and z_2 are not coupled in the non-time-ordered case, so the double integral factorizes into a product of two single integrals:

$$\int_0^\infty dz_1 e^{-z_1} z_1^{p_1} u_+(iz_1) = (1-i) 2^{-\frac{3}{2}-p_1} e^{\frac{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}{2}} \tilde{M}_R \frac{\Gamma(1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+p_1+i\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(2+p_1+i\tilde{\lambda})}, \tag{C.27a}$$

$$\int_0^\infty dz_2 e^{-z_2} (-iz_2)^{p_2} v_+^\dagger(-iz_2) = (1+i) 2^{-\frac{3}{2}-p_2} e^{\frac{\pi\tilde{\lambda}}{2}} \frac{\Gamma(1+p_2-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+p_2+i\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1+p_2-i\tilde{\lambda})}. \tag{C.27b}$$

With these, we further derive $W_1^{p_1 p_2}$ as follows:

$$W_1^{p_1 p_2} = \tilde{M}_R e^{\frac{i\pi}{2}(p_1-p_2)} 2^{-2-p_1-p_2} \frac{\Gamma(1+p_1-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+p_1+i\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(2+p_1+i\tilde{\lambda})} \frac{\Gamma(1+p_2-i\tilde{\nu}) \Gamma(1+p_2+i\tilde{\nu})}{\Gamma(1+p_2-i\tilde{\lambda})}. \tag{C.28}$$

C.3 Folded-Limit Analysis and the Cutting Rule

In this subsection, we discuss the two closely related aspects of the nonlocal signal: its behavior in the folded limit and its interpretation in terms of the cutting rule. Both provide useful insight into the physical origin of the oscillatory contribution as extracted in the squeezed limit.

◆ Folded-limit Analysis:

In general, a three-point correlator may be viewed as the folded limit of a four-point correlator,

$$\lim_{k_4 \rightarrow 0} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_4) \rangle' \implies \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle'. \tag{C.29}$$

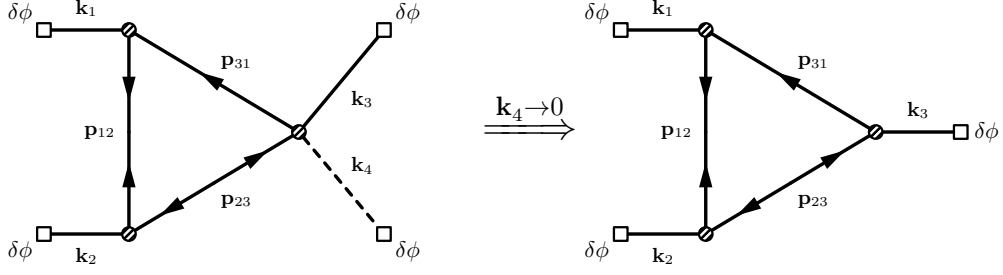


Figure 12: From the four-point correlator to the three-point correlator in the folded limit.

Once the expression for the corresponding four-point correlator is obtained, one may directly infer the structure of the three-point correlator [10, 75].

To realize this, we introduce the auxiliary coupling through

$$\Delta\mathcal{L} = \frac{-a}{\Lambda} \delta\phi' \partial_\mu \phi (\tilde{N}^\dagger \bar{\sigma}^\mu \tilde{N}), \quad (\text{C.30})$$

where $\phi' = d\phi/d\tau$. This allows us to construct a four-point correlator that reduces to the original three-point correlator in the folded limit, as shown in Fig.12. Thus, this four-point correlator can be expressed as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_4) \rangle' &= \sum_{a,b,c=\pm} abc \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^3 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 d\tau_3 \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \\ &\quad \times (-H\tau_3)^{-1} G'_c(k_4, \tau_3) \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \mathcal{T}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.31})$$

where $G'_c(k_4, \tau_3) = \frac{H^2}{2k_4} \tau_3 e^{i c k_4 \tau_3}$ and $\mathcal{T}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda}$ is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{T}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda} &= - \left[\bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} \hat{D}_{a\dot{\alpha}\alpha}^\beta(\mathbf{p}_{12}, \tau_1, \tau_2) \sigma_{\beta\dot{\beta}}^\nu \check{D}_{b\dot{\beta}\gamma}^\beta(\mathbf{p}_{23}, \tau_2, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\gamma}\gamma} D_{c\dot{\gamma}\dot{\alpha}}(\mathbf{p}_{31}, \tau_3, \tau_1) \right] \\ &\quad - \left[\bar{\sigma}^{\mu\dot{\alpha}\alpha} D_{a\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{p}_{13}, \tau_1, \tau_3) \bar{\sigma}^{\lambda\dot{\beta}\beta} \hat{D}_{c\dot{\beta}\beta}^\gamma(\mathbf{p}_{32}, \tau_3, \tau_2) \sigma_{\gamma\dot{\gamma}}^\nu \check{D}_{b\dot{\alpha}\dot{\alpha}}^\gamma(\mathbf{p}_{21}, \tau_2, \tau_1) \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.32})$$

Taking the folded limit, we simplify the new vertex (C.30) for the four-point correlator to the following factor:

$$\lim_{k_4 \rightarrow 0} (-H\tau_3)^{-1} G'_c(k_4, \tau_3) = -\frac{H}{2k_4}. \quad (\text{C.33})$$

Thus, in the folded limit $k_4 \rightarrow 0$, we derive the desired three-point correlator as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} &\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle' \\ &= \sum_{a,b,c=\pm} abc \left(\frac{-i}{\Lambda} \right)^3 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 d\tau_2 d\tau_3 \mathcal{F}_{\mu a}(\mathbf{k}_1, \tau_1) \mathcal{F}_{\nu b}(\mathbf{k}_2, \tau_2) \mathcal{F}_{\lambda c}(\mathbf{k}_3, \tau_3) \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \mathcal{T}_{abc}^{\mu\nu\lambda} \\ &= \lim_{k_4 \rightarrow 0} -\frac{2k_4}{H} \langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_4) \rangle'. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.34})$$

In the literature [42], the four-point correlator with a scalar triangle loop was factorized to isolate the nonlocal cosmological-collider signal. In the present study, the factorization of

the three-point correlator with a fermion triangle loop may be viewed as the folded-limit reduction of the corresponding four-point factorization.

◆ Cutting Rule Interpretation:

As discussed in Section 2, the nonlocal cosmological-collider signal is extracted by taking the soft limit for the internal propagators. We refer to such internal propagators as the soft propagators. To illustrate the cutting rule, we first consider a massive scalar field σ with mode function $y_k(\tau)$. Its in-in propagators are given by

$$\begin{aligned} D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) &= D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)\theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)\theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \\ D_{\oplus\ominus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) &= D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)\theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)\theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \\ D_{\ominus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) &= y_k(\tau_1)y_k^*(\tau_2), \quad D_{\ominus\ominus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2) = y_k^*(\tau_1)y_k(\tau_2). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.35})$$

The nonlocal part of a soft massive propagator satisfies the relations:

$$D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)_{(\text{NLoc})} = D_{\oplus\oplus}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)_{(\text{NLoc})} = D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)_{(\text{NLoc})}. \quad (\text{C.36})$$

In consequence, for the nonlocal signal the θ functions in the time-ordered and reverse-time-ordered propagators do not affect the time integrals. Thus, the integral $\int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_2$ factorizes into a product of the following two separate integrals:

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \delta\phi^n \rangle &\supset \sum_{a,b=\pm} \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_2 f_L^a(\tau_1) f_R^b(\tau_2) D_{ab}(\mathbf{k}_s, \tau_1, \tau_2) \\ &\rightarrow \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_1 \int_{-\infty}^{0^-} d\tau_2 \left[\sum_{a,b=\pm} f_L^a(\tau_1) f_R^b(\tau_2) \right] D_{\oplus\oplus}(\mathbf{k}_s, \tau_1, \tau_2). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.37})$$

A more systematic proof was given in Ref. [42].

For the fermion propagator $D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \sum_s u_s(\tau_1, k) u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k) h_{s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}) h_{s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}), \\ D_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \sum_s -v_s(\tau_2, k) v_s^\dagger(\tau_1, k) h_{-s,\dot{\beta}}^\dagger(\mathbf{k}) h_{-s,\alpha}(\mathbf{k}), \\ D_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)\theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)\theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \\ D_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)\theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)\theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1). \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.38})$$

As shown in the Eq.(2.28) and Eq.(2.29), we have the following relations:

$$\left[u_+ u_+^\dagger \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} = - \left[v_+ v_+^\dagger \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}, \quad \left[u_- u_-^\dagger \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} = - \left[v_- v_-^\dagger \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}. \quad (\text{C.39})$$

Since $D_{ab\alpha\dot{\beta}}$ is a 2×2 matrix carrying the helicity-spinor structure, the nonlocal parts of the time-ordered and reverse-time-ordered propagators are not equal,

$$D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)_{(\text{NLoc})} \neq D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2)_{(\text{NLoc})}. \quad (\text{C.40})$$

Hence, unlike the scalar case, the cutting rule cannot be directly applied to the full spinor propagator.

To overcome this obstacle, we decompose $D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}$ and $D_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}$ into symmetric and antisymmetric parts:

$$\begin{aligned} D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \left[D_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{(S)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right] + \left[D_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{(A)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right] (\theta_{12} - \theta_{21}), \\ D_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) &= \left[D_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{(S)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right] + \left[D_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{(A)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right] (\theta_{21} - \theta_{12}), \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.41})$$

where we have defined $\theta_{ij} = \theta(\tau_i - \tau_j)$. The symmetric part is defined as

$$\left[D_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{(S)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right] \equiv \frac{1}{2} \left[D_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) + D_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right], \quad (\text{C.42})$$

in which by using Eq.(C.39) the nonlocal part can be written as follows:

$$\left[D_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{(S)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} = \frac{\sigma_{0,\alpha\dot{\beta}}}{2} \sum_s \left[u_s(\tau_1, k) u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}. \quad (\text{C.43})$$

The antisymmetric part is defined as

$$\left[D_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{(A)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right] \equiv \frac{1}{2} \left[D_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) - D_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right], \quad (\text{C.44})$$

whose nonlocal part is given by

$$\left[D_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}^{(A)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_s s \left[u_s(\tau_1, k) u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} \begin{pmatrix} \cos\theta & e^{-i\phi} \sin\theta \\ -e^{i\phi} \sin\theta & -\cos\theta \end{pmatrix}_{\alpha\dot{\beta}}. \quad (\text{C.45})$$

In the present analysis, the symmetric parts of $D_{\oplus\oplus\alpha\dot{\beta}}$ and $D_{\ominus\ominus\alpha\dot{\beta}}$ are included, which allows a cutting-rule-like factorization of the loop diagram. We take this as a conservative estimate since the antisymmetric part could not be easily treated in this way and its precise treatment will be pursued for future works.

For the other two types of propagators introduced in Section 2.3, the procedure is the same. Their symmetric parts are given by

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\hat{D}_{\alpha\beta}^{(S)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} &= \frac{1}{2} \left[\hat{D}_{\ominus\oplus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) + \hat{D}_{\oplus\ominus\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} \\ &= \frac{\epsilon_{\alpha\beta}}{2} \sum_s \left[u_s(\tau_1, k) v_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.46a})$$

$$\begin{aligned} \left[\check{D}_{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}^{(S)}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} &= \frac{1}{2} \left[\check{D}_{\ominus\oplus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) + \check{D}_{\oplus\ominus\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_2) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})} \\ &= \frac{\epsilon_{\dot{\alpha}\dot{\beta}}}{2} \sum_s \left[u_s^\dagger(\tau_2, k) v_s(\tau_1, k) \right]_{(\text{NLoc})}. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{C.46b})$$

C.4 Loop Integration Using Feynman Parameterization

In this subsection, we evaluate the relevant loop-momentum integration by using Feynman parameterization. This derivation makes the separation between the local UV-sensitive part and the nonlocal, non-analytic part fairly transparent.

We consider the following master integral,

$$\mathcal{I}_{\text{bubble}}(k_s) = \int \frac{d^3\mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} |\mathbf{q}|^{-2a} |\mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s|^{-2b}, \quad (\text{C.47})$$

where a and b are complex parameters in general, and $\mathbf{k}_s$ denotes an external momentum.

For generic complex factors a and b , the integral is absolutely convergent only if the following conditions are obeyed,

$$\operatorname{Re}(a) < \frac{3}{2}, \quad \operatorname{Re}(b) < \frac{3}{2}, \quad \operatorname{Re}(a+b) > \frac{3}{2}. \quad (\text{C.48})$$

Outside the above convergent domain, the integral can be regulated by the analytical continuation. Within the convergent domain, it can be evaluated explicitly using the Feynman parameterization, and the resultant expression can be analytically continued to the parameter region where the fermion loop integration is performed.

Using the formula

$$\frac{1}{A^a B^b} = \frac{\Gamma(a+b)}{\Gamma(a)\Gamma(b)} \int_0^1 d\xi_1 d\xi_2 \delta(1-\xi_1-\xi_2) \frac{\xi_1^{a-1} \xi_2^{b-1}}{(\xi_1 A + \xi_2 B)^{a+b}}, \quad (\text{C.49})$$

we can reexpress Eq.(C.47) as follows:

$$\mathcal{I}_{\text{bubble}}(k_s) = \frac{\Gamma(a+b)}{\Gamma(a)\Gamma(b)} \int_0^1 d\xi_1 d\xi_2 \delta(1-\xi_1-\xi_2) \int \frac{d^3 \mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^3} \frac{\xi_1^{a-1} \xi_2^{b-1}}{[\xi_1 |\mathbf{q}|^2 + \xi_2 |\mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s|^2]^{a+b}}. \quad (\text{C.50})$$

Then, shifting the loop momentum $\mathbf{q} = \mathbf{p} - \xi_2 \mathbf{k}_s$, we derive $\xi_1 |\mathbf{q}|^2 + \xi_2 |\mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s|^2 = p^2 + \Delta$ with $\Delta = \xi_1 \xi_2 k_s^2$. Thus, the integral (C.50) becomes

$$\mathcal{I}_{\text{bubble}}(k_s) = \frac{\Gamma(a+b)}{\Gamma(a)\Gamma(b)} \int_0^1 d\xi_1 d\xi_2 \delta(1-\xi_1-\xi_2) \xi_1^{a-1} \xi_2^{b-1} \int \frac{d^3 \mathbf{p}}{(2\pi)^3} \frac{1}{(p^2 + \Delta)^{a+b}}. \quad (\text{C.51})$$

The remaining momentum integral is computed in the standard way,

$$\int \frac{d^3 \mathbf{p}}{(2\pi)^3} \frac{1}{(p^2 + \Delta)^{a+b}} = \frac{\Gamma(a+b-\frac{3}{2})}{(4\pi)^{3/2} \Gamma(a+b)} \Delta^{\frac{3}{2}-a-b}. \quad (\text{C.52})$$

Substituting $\Delta = \xi_1 \xi_2 k_s^2$ into the above integral, we derive the integral $\mathcal{I}_{\text{bubble}}$ as follows:

$$\mathcal{I}_{\text{bubble}}(k_s) = \frac{k_s^{3-2a-2b}}{(4\pi)^{3/2}} \frac{\Gamma(a+b-\frac{3}{2})}{\Gamma(a)\Gamma(b)} \int_0^1 d\xi_1 d\xi_2 \delta(1-\xi_1-\xi_2) \xi_1^{\frac{3}{2}-b-1} \xi_2^{\frac{3}{2}-a-1}. \quad (\text{C.53})$$

We compute the Feynman-parameter integral,

$$\int_0^1 d\xi_1 d\xi_2 \delta(1-\xi_1-\xi_2) \xi_1^\alpha \xi_2^\beta = \frac{\Gamma(1+\alpha)\Gamma(1+\beta)}{\Gamma(2+\alpha+\beta)}, \quad (\text{C.54})$$

which leads to

$$\mathcal{I}_{\text{bubble}}(k_s) = \frac{\Gamma(a+b-\frac{3}{2}) \Gamma(\frac{3}{2}-b) \Gamma(\frac{3}{2}-a)}{(4\pi)^{3/2} \Gamma(a)\Gamma(b)\Gamma(3-a-b)} k_s^{3-2a-2b}. \quad (\text{C.55})$$

We note that the integral (C.55) is first derived in the convergence domain (C.48), and then it can be obtained for other domains by analytic continuation.

It is useful to compare this analytic-continuation prescription with other regularization schemes. If we introduce a sharp UV cutoff, $|\mathbf{q}| < \Lambda_{\text{UV}}$, then the large- q expansion yields the following:

$$\mathcal{I}_\Lambda(k_s) = \frac{\Lambda_{\text{UV}}^{3-2a-2b}}{2\pi^2(3-2a-2b)} + \frac{b(2b-1)k_s^2 \Lambda_{\text{UV}}^{1-2a-2b}}{6\pi^2(1-2a-2b)} + \cdots + \mathcal{I}_{\text{NLoc}}(k_s), \quad (\text{C.56})$$

where the omitted terms are higher-order analytic functions of k_s^2 . These cutoff-dependent terms can be absorbed into counterterms as generated by local operators. Then the remaining non-analytic part, $\mathcal{I}_{\text{NLoc}}(k_s)$, just corresponds to Eq.(C.55) and is independent of regularization scheme, which contributes to the cosmological collider signal.

With the dimensional regularization, we continue the spatial dimension to $D = 3 - \epsilon$ and considers

$$\mathcal{I}_{\text{bubble}}^{(D)} = \mu^\epsilon \int \frac{d^D \mathbf{q}}{(2\pi)^D} (\mathbf{q}^2)^{-a} [(\mathbf{q} + \mathbf{k}_s)^2]^{-b}. \quad (\text{C.57})$$

Using the standard massless two-point integral, we have

$$\mathcal{I}_{\text{bubble}}^{(D)} = \frac{\mu^\epsilon (k_s^2)^{\frac{D}{2} - a - b}}{(4\pi)^{D/2}} \frac{\Gamma(\frac{D}{2} - a) \Gamma(\frac{D}{2} - b) \Gamma(a + b - \frac{D}{2})}{\Gamma(a) \Gamma(b) \Gamma(D - a - b)}. \quad (\text{C.58})$$

In this scheme, the power-divergent analytic terms do not appear as explicit $1/\epsilon$ poles. This is expected for the dimensional regularization: the power-divergent analytic contributions do appear, whereas the non-analytic momentum dependence is retained.

The important point is that different regularization schemes affect only the analytic UV-sensitive part of the bubble integral. In the cutoff scheme, these appear as analytic terms such as those shown in Eq.(C.56), whereas in the dimensional regularization the corresponding power-divergent analytic terms do not exist. In contrast, the non-analytic dependence on k_s is captured by the expression (C.55) which is obtained from the analytic continuation.

It is useful to clarify in what sense the non-analytic part is associated with the soft region. Strictly speaking, the full loop integral is not dominated by low loop-momentum in a naive sense. Instead, the nonlocal cosmological-collider signal is generated by the kinematic region in which the internal momentum becomes comparable to the external soft scale, or, equivalently in which the two internal propagators become soft as $k_s \rightarrow 0$ [42]. In this region, the loop integral develops the non-analytic dependence on the momentum ratio that gives rise to the oscillatory cosmological-collider signal. In contrast, the hard-momentum region admits an ordinary expansion in the soft external momentum and thus contributes only analytic functions of k_s^2 . But, this does not mean that one could simply discard the hard-momentum region and impose a soft cutoff on the integral to estimate the nonlocal contribution. Once a regulator or matching scale is introduced, the soft contribution generally contains scheme-dependent pieces, so the universal non-analytic part must be isolated by a consistent subtraction or matching procedure. In this sense, the oscillatory cosmological-collider signal is encoded in the soft-propagator region of the bubble integral, whereas the hard-momentum region, although not generating the signal itself, is still needed to organize the decomposition and remove the scheme-dependence of intermediate expressions.

D Brief Review of Cosmological Collider Physics

In this Appendix, we give a brief review of the cosmological collider physics and define the relevant observables and notations used in the main text.

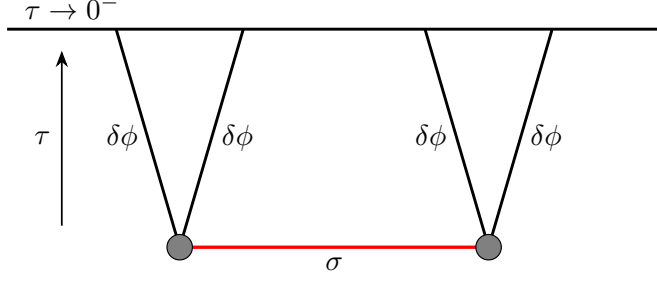


Figure 13: An illustrative diagram of a four-point correlator of the inflaton $\delta\phi$ with the exchange of a massive scalar σ , namely $\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_4) \rangle$. The horizontal line represents the future boundary of de Sitter spacetime, $\tau \rightarrow 0^-$, and the two shaded blobs denote the interaction vertices.

During inflation, the inflaton field can be decomposed into a homogeneous background $\phi_0(t)$ and quantum fluctuations $\delta\phi(t, \mathbf{x})$:

$$\phi(t, \mathbf{x}) = \phi_0(t) + \delta\phi(t, \mathbf{x}). \quad (\text{D.1})$$

The background field $\phi_0(t)$ slowly rolls during inflation. On the other hand, the fluctuation $\delta\phi$ can be treated as an approximately massless scalar field due to the flatness of the inflaton potential. As a result, in single-field inflation the quantum evolution of $\delta\phi(t, \mathbf{x})$ is nearly Gaussian.

However, the inflaton needs to interact with other fields because reheating requires the inflaton decays through the inflation couplings with the Standard Model (SM) fields. Such interactions can generate non-Gaussianity in the inflaton fluctuations, characterized by their n -point ($n \geq 3$) correlators evaluated at the future boundary of inflationary spacetime,

$$\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2) \cdots \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_n) \rangle \equiv \lim_{\tau \rightarrow 0^-} \langle \delta\phi(\tau, \mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\tau, \mathbf{k}_2) \cdots \delta\phi(\tau, \mathbf{k}_n) \rangle, \quad (\text{D.2})$$

namely in the late-time limit $\tau \rightarrow 0^-$. A schematic example is shown in Fig. 13.

In the spatially flat gauge, the primordial curvature perturbation ζ is related to the inflaton fluctuation by

$$\zeta \simeq -\frac{H}{\dot{\phi}_0} \delta\phi(\mathbf{x}). \quad (\text{D.3})$$

Consequently, primordial non-Gaussianity, as characterized by the n -point correlators of the curvature perturbation ζ , can be directly probed by large-scale-structure observations and therefore encodes information about interactions during inflation. The corresponding n -point correlators of the inflaton can be computed in the well-known in-in formalism [76, 77], or equivalently in the Schwinger-Keldysh (SK) path-integral formalism. See [19, 20, 69] for reviews.

Depending on the interactions and on the nature of the particles involved, the resulting non-Gaussianity can exhibit a variety of shapes. Among the different types of primordial non-Gaussianity, cosmological collider signals have attracted particular attention in recent years [7–18]. A cosmological collider (CC) signal, also known as a clock signal, is an oscillatory contribution to the n -point correlators $\langle \delta\phi^n \rangle$ in a special kinematic regime. For

instance, the CC signal for a three-point correlator $\langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle$ is encoded in its squeezed limit:

$$\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle_{\text{squeezed}} \sim c_1 f_{\text{BG}}(\mathbf{k}) + c_2 f_{\text{CC}}(\mathbf{k}) \mathbf{P}(\mathbf{k})^{i\omega} e^{i\varphi} + \text{H.c.} \quad (\text{D.4})$$

In the above, c_1 and c_2 are constant coefficients, ω is the oscillation frequency, and φ denotes the relevant phase angle. The first term, $f_{\text{BG}}(\mathbf{k})$, denotes the background non-Gaussian contribution, which is analytic in the momenta $\mathbf{k}$ and typically takes the form of a low-order polynomial. In contrast, the second term, $f_{\text{CC}}(\mathbf{k}) \mathbf{P}(\mathbf{k})^{i\omega}$, represents the CC signal. In Eq.(D.4), $f_{\text{CC}}(\mathbf{k})$ is also analytic in the momenta, whereas $\mathbf{P}(\mathbf{k})$ denotes a function of the momenta, typically a ratio of two characteristic scales, such as $k_{\text{long}}/k_{\text{short}}$. The CC signal originates from the non-analytic factor $\mathbf{P}(\mathbf{k})^{i\omega}$.

Further, for the above correlator with a CC signal, the squeezed limit is a special momentum configuration which describes a situation with a clear separation of scales, a long-wavelength mode k_{long} and a short-wavelength mode k_{short} satisfying $k_{\text{long}} \ll k_{\text{short}}$.

For a four-point correlator with the momenta satisfying $\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_4) \rangle$, with $\mathbf{k}_s \equiv \mathbf{k}_1 + \mathbf{k}_2$, the *squeezed limit* refers to the kinematic configuration $k_s \ll k_1 + k_2, k_3 + k_4$, as shown in the Fig.14. The long-wavelength (soft) mode k_{long} corresponds to k_s , while the short-wavelength (hard) modes k_{short} corresponds to k_1, k_2, k_3 and k_4 .

For a three-point correlator $\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3) \rangle$, the *squeezed limit* refers to the configuration $k_1 \ll k_2 \simeq k_3$, as shown in the Fig.15. The long-wavelength mode k_{long} corresponds to k_3 , while the short-wavelength modes k_{short} corresponds to k_1 and k_2 .

The squeezed limit could cleanly separate the oscillation CC signal away from analytic contributions from contact interactions and local operators, which are typically smooth power law dependence of the momentum $\mathbf{P}(\mathbf{k})^n$.

D.1 Origin of the Cosmological Collider Signatures

In general, cosmological collider signals arise from interactions between the inflaton and massive particles with masses $m \gtrsim H$. As a result, the masses and spins of such particles can be encoded in the resulting CC signals [7, 10]. In this respect, an analogy may be drawn with particle accelerators in flat spacetime, where the presence of intermediate particles is revealed through characteristic structures of scattering amplitudes. For illustration, we give a diagram showing a four-point correlator of the inflaton mediated by a massive scalar boson σ .

To study cosmological collider signals, it is essential to understand the behavior of massive fields propagating in the bulk spacetime of de Sitter, where the conformal time lies in the range of $-\infty < \tau < 0$. For a free massive field, the nontrivial de Sitter geometry generally leads to mode functions expressed in terms of special functions, such as Hankel or Whittaker functions. For concreteness, we consider the scalar field σ with mass m . Its mode function satisfies the equation of motion,

$$\ddot{\sigma}_k + 3H\dot{\sigma}_k + \frac{k^2}{a^2}\sigma_k + m^2\sigma_k = 0, \quad (\text{D.5})$$

where σ_k denotes the mode function, H is the Hubble parameter during inflation, and $a(\tau) = -1/(H\tau)$ is the scale factor. The solution of Eq.(D.5) is given by

$$\sigma_k(\tau) = \frac{\sqrt{\pi} H}{2} e^{-\pi\tilde{\nu}/2} (-\tau)^{3/2} H_{i\tilde{\nu}}^{(1)}(-k\tau), \quad (\text{D.6})$$

where $\tilde{\nu} = \sqrt{(m/H)^2 - 9/4}$, and $H_n^{(1)}(z)$ denotes the Hankel function of the first kind. In the Schwinger-Keldysh (SK) formalism, the bulk propagators of this field take the following form [69]:

$$D_{\oplus\oplus}(k; \tau_1, \tau_2) = \sigma_k(\tau_1)\sigma_k^*(\tau_2)\theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + \sigma_k^*(\tau_1)\sigma_k(\tau_2)\theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \quad (\text{D.7a})$$

$$D_{\ominus\oplus}(k; \tau_1, \tau_2) = \sigma_k^*(\tau_1)\sigma_k(\tau_2), \quad (\text{D.7b})$$

$$D_{\oplus\ominus}(k; \tau_1, \tau_2) = \sigma_k(\tau_1)\sigma_k^*(\tau_2), \quad (\text{D.7c})$$

$$D_{\ominus\ominus}(k; \tau_1, \tau_2) = \sigma_k^*(\tau_1)\sigma_k(\tau_2)\theta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + \sigma_k(\tau_1)\sigma_k^*(\tau_2)\theta(\tau_2 - \tau_1), \quad (\text{D.7d})$$

where $\sigma_k(\tau_1)\sigma_k^*(\tau_2)$ and its complex conjugate are given by

$$\sigma_k(\tau_1)\sigma_k^*(\tau_2) = \frac{\pi H^2}{4} e^{-\pi\tilde{\nu}} (\tau_1\tau_2)^{3/2} H_{i\tilde{\nu}}^{(1)}(-k\tau_1) H_{-i\tilde{\nu}^*}^{(2)}(-k\tau_2), \quad (\text{D.8a})$$

$$\sigma_k^*(\tau_1)\sigma_k(\tau_2) = \frac{\pi H^2}{4} e^{-\pi\tilde{\nu}} (\tau_1\tau_2)^{3/2} H_{-i\tilde{\nu}^*}^{(1)}(-k\tau_1) H_{i\tilde{\nu}}^{(2)}(-k\tau_2). \quad (\text{D.8b})$$

For the present study of the cosmological collider signals, it is useful to make it clear on how the relevant information is encoded in the propagator of a massive field. The key feature is the non-analytic behavior of the propagator, which contains an imaginary power-law dependence on time and can be extracted in the late-time limit $|k\tau_1|, |k\tau_2| \rightarrow 0^-$. This is also referred to the soft limit of the propagator. In this limit, the propagator can be decomposed into two contributions relevant for the cosmological collider signal, known as the nonlocal and local parts [41], for instance,

$$\lim_{|k\tau_1|, |k\tau_2| \rightarrow 0^-} D_{\oplus\ominus}(k, \tau_1, \tau_2) = [D_{\oplus\ominus}(k, \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{NLoc})} + [D_{\oplus\ominus}(k, \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{Loc})}, \quad (\text{D.9})$$

where the $[D_{\oplus\ominus}(k, \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{NLoc})}$ and $[D_{\oplus\ominus}(k, \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{Loc})}$ are given by

$$[D_{\oplus\ominus}(k, \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{NLoc})} = \frac{H^2(\tau_1\tau_2)^{3/2}}{4\pi} \left[[\Gamma(-i\tilde{\nu})]^2 \left(\frac{k^2\tau_1\tau_2}{4} \right)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + [\Gamma(i\tilde{\nu})]^2 \left(\frac{k^2\tau_1\tau_2}{4} \right)^{-i\tilde{\nu}} \right], \quad (\text{D.10a})$$

$$[D_{\oplus\ominus}(k, \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{(\text{Loc})} = \frac{H^2(\tau_1\tau_2)^{3/2}}{4\pi} \Gamma(-i\tilde{\nu})\Gamma(i\tilde{\nu}) \left[e^{\pi\tilde{\nu}} \left(\frac{\tau_1}{\tau_2} \right)^{i\tilde{\nu}} + e^{-\pi\tilde{\nu}} \left(\frac{\tau_1}{\tau_2} \right)^{-i\tilde{\nu}} \right]. \quad (\text{D.10b})$$

The nonlocal and local parts have distinct physical interpretations. First, the nonlocal part is non-analytic in k . In particular, the term proportional to $k^{i2\tilde{\nu}}$ gives rise, after Fourier transformation, to a long-range correlation of the form $|\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_2|^{i2\tilde{\nu}}$. By contrast, the local part is independent of k , and its Fourier transform yields a contact term proportional to $\delta^3(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_2)$, as expected for a local contribution. Second, the time dependence of the nonlocal part reflects the accumulated dynamical phase of two propagating particles, whereas the

time dependence of the local part corresponds to the dynamical phase of a single particle propagating from τ_2 to τ_1 (or from τ_1 to τ_2 , with an additional suppression factor $e^{-2\pi\tilde{\nu}}$).

For the inflaton fluctuation, treated as a massless scalar field in the de Sitter spacetime, the mode function takes the form:

$$\delta\phi_k(\tau) = \frac{H}{\sqrt{2k^3}}(1 + ik\tau)e^{-ik\tau}. \quad (\text{D.11})$$

The corresponding bulk-to-bulk propagator is given by

$$G_{\oplus\ominus}(k; \tau_1, \tau_2) = \delta\phi_k(\tau_1)\delta\phi_k^*(\tau_2) = \frac{H^2}{2k^3} [1 + ik(\tau_1 - \tau_2) + k^2\tau_1\tau_2] e^{-ik(\tau_1 - \tau_2)}. \quad (\text{D.12})$$

Since we evaluate the correlator $\langle\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\cdots\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_n)\rangle$ in the late-time limit $\tau \rightarrow 0^-$, we also need the bulk-to-boundary propagators of the inflaton $\delta\phi$, for which one time leg, say τ_2 , is taken to the final time slice, namely, $\tau_2 = \tau_f \rightarrow 0^-$. They are defined as

$$G_a(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1) \equiv \lim_{\tau_f \rightarrow 0} G_{a\oplus}(\mathbf{k}; \tau_1, \tau_f). \quad (\text{D.13})$$

Then, the plus- and minus-type bulk-to-boundary propagators take the following form:

$$G_{\oplus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau) = \lim_{\tau_f \rightarrow 0} \frac{H^2}{2k^3} [1 - ik(\tau - \tau_f) + k^2\tau\tau_f] e^{ik(\tau - \tau_f)} = \frac{H^2}{2k^3} [1 - ik\tau] e^{ik\tau}, \quad (\text{D.14a})$$

$$G_{\ominus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau) = \lim_{\tau_f \rightarrow 0} \frac{H^2}{2k^3} [1 + ik(\tau - \tau_f) + k^2\tau\tau_f] e^{-ik(\tau - \tau_f)} = \frac{H^2}{2k^3} [1 + ik\tau] e^{-ik\tau}. \quad (\text{D.14b})$$

Hence, in the late-time limit, the massive field oscillates as $\tau^{i\tilde{\nu}} \sim e^{-i\tilde{\nu}Ht}$, since in de Sitter spacetime the conformal time and cosmic time are related by $\tau = -H^{-1}e^{-Ht}$, whereas the massless inflaton mode oscillates as $e^{ik\tau}$. During inflation, interactions between the inflaton and the heavy field can give rise to a resonance production or decay of the heavy particle [14, 41]. For computing the correlator induced by such a heavy field, one needs to deal with the following integral:

$$\int d\tau \tau^\alpha e^{ik\tau} \tau^{\pm i\tilde{\nu}} \sim \frac{\sqrt{2\pi\tilde{\nu}}}{k} e^{\pm i\frac{\pi}{4}} \tau_*^\alpha e^{ik\tau_*} \tau_*^{\pm i\tilde{\nu}}, \quad (\text{D.15})$$

where α is a constant, and the dominant contribution comes from the stationary point τ_* satisfying $|k\tau_*| \simeq \tilde{\nu}$. Physically, τ_* corresponds to the resonance time, at which a resonant process takes place, such as the decay of a massive particle into massless inflaton modes, or, conversely the production of a heavy particle from inflaton modes through the interaction. Through this resonance, the oscillatory behavior of the heavy-particle mode function, characterized by $\tau^{i\tilde{\nu}}$, is transferred to the oscillatory behavior of the cosmological collider signal, which then appears as a non-analytic momentum dependence of the form $k^{i\tilde{\nu}}$, as indicated in Eq.(D.4).

As an on-shell effect, the cosmological collider signal may be viewed as the inflationary analog of the mass-pole structure associated with Mandelstam variables in the flat-spacetime scattering amplitudes. One of its key properties, namely the oscillation frequency ω in Eq.(D.4), is insensitive to the detailed form of the couplings between the inflaton and

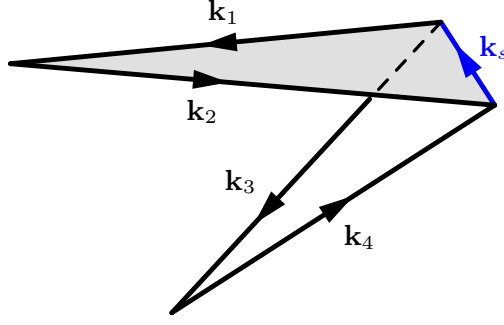


Figure 14: Illustration of the momentum configuration of the four-point correlator in the squeezed limit.

the heavy field, and depends primarily on the heavy-particle mass, $\omega = \tilde{\nu} \sim m/H$. For this reason, the cosmological collider signals provide a nearly model-independent probe of very massive particles in the early universe.

In contrast, the overall size of the signal, namely the coefficient $c_2 f_{\text{CC}}(\mathbf{k})$ in Eq.(D.4), generally does depend on the details of the interaction and thus can carry complementary information about the coupling structure. We will return to this point in the following sections.

D.2 Local and Nonlocal Cosmological Collider Signatures

As discussed in the previous section, the late-time behavior of the propagator for a massive field can be separated into two parts, namely the local and nonlocal contributions, as shown in Eq.(D.10a). Correspondingly, cosmological collider signals can also be classified into two types: local signals and nonlocal signals.

The most commonly studied example is the four-point correlator, $\langle \delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_1)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_2)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_3)\delta\phi(\mathbf{k}_4) \rangle$, with the momentum conservation $\mathbf{k}_1 + \mathbf{k}_2 + \mathbf{k}_3 + \mathbf{k}_4 = 0$. We further define the following:

$$\mathbf{k}_s \equiv \mathbf{k}_1 + \mathbf{k}_2, \quad r_1 \equiv k_s/k_{12}, \quad r_2 \equiv k_s/k_{34}. \quad (\text{D.16})$$

For the four-point correlator, the squeezed limit is given by $k_s \ll k_{12}, k_{34}$, or equivalently, $r_1, r_2 \ll 1$. This squeezed configuration is illustrated in Fig. 14, where the blue momentum vector $\mathbf{k}_s$ is highly compressed.

The local and nonlocal signals exhibit different momentum dependences in the four-point correlator. For the nonlocal signal, the function $\mathbf{P}(\mathbf{k})$ in Eq.(D.4) takes the form of

$$\mathbf{P}(\mathbf{k}) = \frac{k_s^2}{k_{12}k_{34}} = r_1 r_2. \quad (\text{D.17})$$

In contrast, for the local signal we have

$$\mathbf{P}(\mathbf{k}) = \frac{k_{34}}{k_{12}} = \frac{r_1}{r_2}. \quad (\text{D.18})$$

In general, the squeezed-limit behavior of the four-point correlator can be written as follows:

$$\langle \delta\phi^4 \rangle_{\text{squeezed}} \sim A_{\text{NLoc}}(r_1, r_2) (r_1 r_2)^{\pm i\omega} + A_{\text{Loc}}(r_1, r_2) \left(\frac{r_1}{r_2} \right)^{\pm i\omega} + A_{\text{BG}}(r_1, r_2), \quad (\text{D.19})$$

where A_{NLoc} , A_{Loc} , and A_{BG} are analytic functions of r_1 and r_2 .

The local and nonlocal signals have distinctive physical origins. This distinction can be understood most transparently from the resonance picture discussed in Section D.1. In this picture, the nonlocal signal originates from the gravitational production of a pair of massive particles, followed by their resonant decay into inflaton modes at separated interaction vertices. This contribution is associated with the nonlocal part of the massive-field propagator,

$$[D_{\oplus\ominus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{\text{NLoc}} \sim \left(\frac{k_s^2 \tau_1 \tau_2}{4} \right)^{i\tilde{\nu}}. \quad (\text{D.20})$$

After imposing the resonance conditions at the two interaction vertices, this time dependence is mapped into the momentum-space clock signal,

$$\left(\frac{k_s^2}{k_{12} k_{34}} \right)^{i\tilde{\nu}}. \quad (\text{D.21})$$

By contrast, the local signal corresponds to the resonant production and subsequent decay of a single massive particle at interaction vertices. It is associated with the local part of the massive-field propagator,

$$[D_{\oplus\ominus}(\mathbf{k}, \tau_1, \tau_2)]_{\text{Loc}} \sim \left(\frac{\tau_1}{\tau_2} \right)^{i\tilde{\nu}}. \quad (\text{D.22})$$

The resonance conditions then map this time dependence into the local clock signal,

$$\left(\frac{k_{12}}{k_{34}} \right)^{i\tilde{\nu}}. \quad (\text{D.23})$$

Hence, the local and nonlocal signals arise from different bulk histories, and their oscillatory phases track different intervals of massive-particle propagation in the inflationary bulk. Most previous studies have focused on extracting the nonlocal signals in the four-point correlator.

Compared with the four-point case, the structure of the three-point signal is more subtle. A useful way to understand it is to connect the three-point correlator to the folded limit of the four-point correlator by taking $k_4 \rightarrow 0$. In this limit, the momentum ratio $r_2 = k_s/k_{34}$ approaches unity,

$$\lim_{k_4 \rightarrow 0} r_2 = \lim_{k_4 \rightarrow 0} \frac{k_s}{k_{34}} = \lim_{k_4 \rightarrow 0} \frac{|\mathbf{k}_3 + \mathbf{k}_4|}{k_3 + k_4} = 1. \quad (\text{D.24})$$

In consequence, both the local and nonlocal contributions become functions of the same momentum ratio $r_1 = k_3/k_{12}$. In particular, after taking the folded limit, both contributions

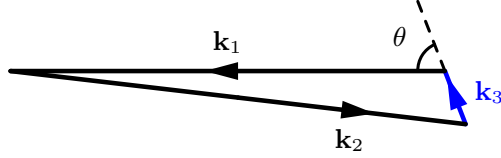


Figure 15: The momentum configuration of the three-point correlator in the squeezed limit.

exhibit the same characteristic non-analytic dependence, $r_1^{\pm i\omega}$. Hence, unlike in the four-point correlator, the local and nonlocal signals in the three-point correlator can no longer be distinguished from their squeezed-limit momentum-dependence alone.

Accordingly, the squeezed-limit behavior of the three-point correlator can be written as

$$\langle \delta\phi^3 \rangle_{\text{squeezed}} \sim B_{\text{L,NL}}(r_1) r_1^{\pm i\omega} + B_{\text{BG}}(r_1) , \quad (\text{D.25})$$

where $B_{\text{loc,NLoc}}$ and B_{BG} are analytic functions of r_1 . In the above, $B_{\text{L,NL}}$ denotes the overall amplitude of the cosmological collider signal, which in general receives contributions from both the local and nonlocal parts. The squeezed limit of the three-point correlator corresponds to

$$r_1 = \frac{k_3}{k_{12}} \rightarrow 0 , \quad (\text{D.26})$$

which is illustrated in Fig. 15.

Nevertheless, the local and nonlocal contributions remain physically and computationally distinct. They may be defined separately by extracting the local or nonlocal part of the massive propagator, or equivalently by taking the folded limit of the corresponding local and nonlocal pieces of the four-point correlator. What is lost in the three-point limit is not the distinction in their physical origins, but only the kinematic distinction in their final momentum-dependence.

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